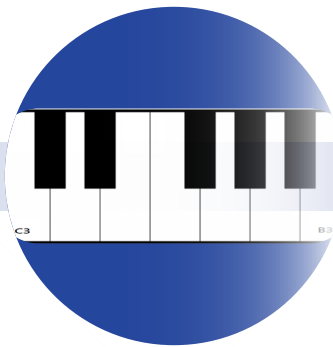


MUSIC, DANCE AND DRAMA



STUDENT'S BOOK

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FOREWORD

Dear Student,

Rwanda Basic Education Board is honored to present to you Music, Dance and Drama book for Senior Two which serves as a guide to competence-based teaching and learning to ensure consistency and coherence in the learning of Music, Dance and Drama subject. The Rwandan educational philosophy is to ensure that you achieve full potential at every level of education which will prepare you to be well integrated in society and exploit employment opportunities.

The government of Rwanda emphasizes the importance of aligning teaching and learning materials with the syllabus to facilitate your learning process. Many factors influence what you learn, how well you learn and the competences you acquire. Those factors include quality instructional materials available, assessment strategies for the learners among others. Special attention was paid to activities that facilitate learning process develop your ideas and make new discoveries during concrete activities carried out individually or with peers.

In competence-based curriculum, learning is considered as a process of active building and developing knowledge and meanings by the learner where concepts are mainly introduced by an activity, a situation or a scenario that helps the learner to construct knowledge, develop skills and acquire positive attitudes and values.

For effective use of this textbook, your role is to: Work on given activities which lead to the development of skills

- ✓ Share relevant information with other learners through presentations, discussions, group work and other active learning techniques such as role play, case studies, investigation and research in the library, from the internet or from your community.
- ✓ Participate and take responsibility for your own learning.
- ✓ Draw conclusions based on the findings from the learning activities.

To facilitate you in doing activities, the content of this book is self-explanatory so that you can easily use it by yourself, acquire and assess your competences. The book is written in units whereby each unit comprises: the key unit competence, followed by introductory activity before the development of Music concepts that are connected to real world situation.

I wish to sincerely extend my appreciation to REB staff who organized the editing process of this textbook. Special gratitude also goes to lecturers, teachers, illustrators and designers who supported the exercise throughout. Any comment or contribution would be welcome to the improvement of this textbook for the next edition.



Dr. MBARUSHIMANA Nelson

Director General, REB

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to extend my sincere appreciation to everyone who contributed to the refinement of the Music, Dance and Drama in Senior Two. This achievement would not have been possible without the active involvement of various stakeholders.

Special thanks go to Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB) staff; subject experts; university lecturers and teachers for their valuable work in the writing of this textbook.

I am also grateful to all our education development partners whose support was instrumental throughout the process.



Ms. MURUNGI Joan,

Head of Curriculum,
Teaching and Learning
Resources Department/REB

TABLE OF CONTENTS

FOREWORD	iii
ACKNOWLEDGEMENT	iii
ACKNOWLEDGEMENT	iv
Introduction.....	vii
Performance	vii
Field work	vii
Materials and tools.....	vii
Marks scored	vii
Best wishes	viii
Activity-based learning	viii
Group work	viii
Research.....	viii
UNIT 1: MAJOR SCALES AND MAJOR KEY SIGNATURE	1
1.1. Accidentals and major scale	3
1.2. Scale Degrees.....	6
UNIT 2: MAJOR SCALES AND MINOR KEY SIGNATURE	23
Introduction.....	24
2.2. Minor key signatures	47
2.2.1. Sharp key signatures	47
2.2.2. Flat Key signatures	48
2.2.3. Key Signatures and corresponding Natural Minor Scales	48
2.4. Parallel Scales and Relative Scales.....	56
UNIT 3: PENTATONIC SCALES.....	60
Introduction.....	62
3.1.1. Concept of Pentatonic scale	63
3.1.2 Types of pentatonic scales.....	64
3.2.1. Sharp relative major & minor pentatonic scales	66
3.2.2. Flat relative major & minor pentatonic scales	67
UNIT 4: PERFORMING SKETCHES IN ENGLISH FOR FRENCH.....	69

Introduction.....	70
4.1 Determinants of theme selection	70
4.1.1. Definition and importance of theme.....	72
4.1.2. Theme selection process	72
4.1.3. Key considerations in theme selection.....	73
4.1.4. Pitfalls to avoid.....	73
4.2.1. Vocal Elements	75
4.2.2. Physical and Body Techniques	75
4.2.3. Use of Space.....	75
4.2.4. Facial Expression	75
3.2.5. Character Development in Drama	75
4.2.6. Stage Techniques	75
4.3.1. Understanding peer review	78
4.3.2. Giving constructive feedback.....	78
4.3.3. Receiving feedback	78
4.3.4. Peer feedback techniques.....	78
4.3.5. Benefits of peer review and feedback	78
UNIT 5: MELODY AND HARMONY	81
Introduction.....	82
1. Melody	83
2.1. Harmony and Chords	85
2.2. Harmony in the Major Scale	85
2.3. Harmony in Singing (Voice Parts)	87
2.4 Consonance and Dissonance.....	87
2.5. Chord Progressions	88
2.7 Harmonizing	89
3.1. Definition	90
3.2. Musical Function	90
3.3. Number of music notes	90
3.4. Role in Musical Texture.....	90
3.5. Emotional Effect	90
3.6. Performance in Ensembles	91
3.7. Briefly:	91

Introduction

The benefits of Music, Dance and Drama education are immense and highly beneficial to students. For Senior Two, Music, Dance and Drama is a fun and practical subject that helps you pupils to learn by doing. It is made to help enjoy the music atmosphere by singing, playing instruments, and enjoying other musical activities. This book has five units that will give you time to practice and grow your talent in music. As you learn, you will become more confident, creative, and ready to begin your journey as a young music performer.

Before you use each unit, always first read and understand what you will be able to learn and do after using the unit. This will help you not to waste your efforts on what is not needed at the time. So, you must keep focused.

Learning by doing (practice)

Music, Dance and Drama is an area of study which is by means of acquiring knowledge and understanding it, skills, values and attitudes. These units, therefore, require you to participate in different activities as much as you can to become a skilled performer, composer and maker of creative arts.

You are advised to be cooperative with fellow students as much as you can in this area to learn and perform entertainingly. Be ready to work in groups with many teammates as much as possible to learn from them as they too learn from you.

Each student is expected to gain a lot from each other as they get involved in discussions. Be prepared to talk freely and respect each other's different ways of thinking and looking at things.

Performance

In every lesson of unit, you will be given a chance to perform Music, Dance and Drama. These sessions should help you to acquire skills to your fullest. Please note that some of these skills sometimes develop slowly by slowly with practice.

Field work

Since music, dance, and drama are cultural products that largely already exist within our communities, you will be required to gather information directly from the community about the types of music practiced. Your teacher will guide you on how to do this using written notes and, where possible, electronic recordings. This can also be done using a mobile phone

Materials and tools

Materials and tools to help you in your learning will include various instruments, computers, and other electronic devices. Always keep them safe from damage. Be a responsible creative artist.

Marks scored

You will compose/make, perform and draw art works. Your classmate and the teacher will be awarding you with the marks you deserve. You therefore must work very hard to be encouraged by good performance.

There will be performances of Music, Dance and Drama by both individuals and

groups of students. For the case of group activities, all participants share the mark or grade. Therefore, you are encouraged to be an active member of the group so that you contribute to the good marks which you will all get.

Best wishes

By the end of this Music, Dance and Drama subject in Senior One, you will have learnt to sing, dance, act and write music, draw and make beautiful and interesting art pieces. We wish you great success.

Activity-based learning

This means that this book has a variety of activities for you to do, as well as information for you to read. These activities present you with material or things to do which will help you to learn by yourself. You already have a lot of knowledge and ideas based on the experiences you have had from your own community. Some of the activities, therefore, ask you to think about the knowledge and ideas you already have.

In using this book, therefore, it is essential that you do all the activities. You will not learn properly unless you do these activities. They are the most important part of your book.

In some ways this makes learning more of a challenge. It is more difficult to think for yourself than to copy what the teacher tells you. But if you take up this challenge you will become a better person and become more successful in your life.

Group work

You can also learn a lot from other people in your class. If you have a problem, it can often be solved by discussing it with others. Many of the activities in the book, therefore, involve discussion or other activities in groups or pairs. Your teacher will help to organize these groups and may arrange the classroom so that you are always sitting in groups facing each other. You cannot discuss properly unless you are facing each other.

Research

One of the objectives of the Competence Based Curriculum is to help you to find things out for yourself. Some activities, therefore, ask you to do research using books in the library, the internet if your school has this, or other sources such as newspapers, magazines, home and the community. This means you will develop the skills of learning for yourself when you leave school.

LESSON 1:
MAJOR SCALES
AND MAJOR KEY
SIGNATURE

LESSON 2:
MINOR SCALES
AND MINOR KEY
SIGNATURES

LESSON 3:
PENTATONIC
SCALES

LESSON 4:
PERFORMING
SKETCHES IN
ENGLISH OR
FRENCH

LESSON 5:
MELODY AND
HARMONY

UNIT 1:

MAJOR SCALES AND MAJOR KEY SIGNATURE

Key unit competence: At the end of this unit, students will be able to perform simple musical compositions on various major scales.

Domain expected learning outcomes

Knowledge	Skills	Attitudes and Values
Explain the meaning of key signatures in music notation.	Use accidentals in building major scales.	Appreciate music as a cultural and artistic discipline.
Describe the use of accidentals in building major scales.	Write key signatures on the staff using sharps and flats.	Demonstrate patience during activities on accidentals and scales.
Determine the key to a musical piece from the key signature.	Compose short melodies in major scales. Sight-sing short melodies in simple keys.	Show creativity in composition and improvisation.
Explain the role order of tones and semi tones in building up a musical key	– Play short melodies in in major scales on piano by respecting the sequence of tones and semi-tones of a major scale.	– Develop confidence through performance. – Maintain collaboration during group activities.

Introduction

Scales are the foundation of Western music. They serve as the building blocks from which melodies are formed, harmonies are developed, and musical ideas take shape.

In this unit, you will study major scales and key signatures in all keys. Major scales are often described as having a bright, happy, and uplifting character.

You will learn how to construct major scales by using accidentals to create the correct pattern of tones and semitones. From these scales, you will be able to identify and notate the corresponding key signatures, as well as transpose melodies from one key to another.

Key Concepts: Major scales, key signatures, tones and semitones pattern, accidentals, transposition, enharmonic keys and melodies, and musical notation.



Introductory activity

1. In groups of three, look at the following section of a piano keyboard from C3 to C4 on the Figure and answer the following questions:

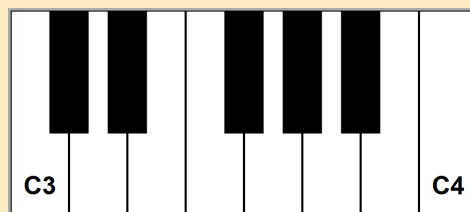


Figure 1.1 A visual representation of a section of a piano keyboard from middle C.

- a. How many white keys are there in the interval C3-C4?
 - b. How many black keys are there in the interval C3-C4?
2. The distance between any two adjacent keys on the keyboard, whether black or white, is called a semitone or half step. The C major scale uses only the white keys, from C3 to C4. Now, consider white keys only:
 - a. How many notes are there in the interval C3-C4 or in the C major scale?
 - b. How many whole steps are there in the interval C3-C4 or in the C major scale?
 - c. Identify the pattern of whole steps and half steps in the C major scale or in the interval C3-C4 on a piano keyboard.

1.1. Accidentals and major scale



Learning activity 1.2

1. Write the musical notes from middle C to the C one octave higher (next C), showing them in both treble clef (G clef) and bass clef (F clef). Then play these notes on the keyboard. By brainstorming answer the following questions:

- a. How many half tones did you notice?
- b. How many whole tones did you notice?

2. Use sharp (s) to write G major scale on a music staff in G clef.

*Hint: Tones and semitones pattern **W-W-H-W-W-W-H** (where W = whole step or tone, H = half step or semi tone).*

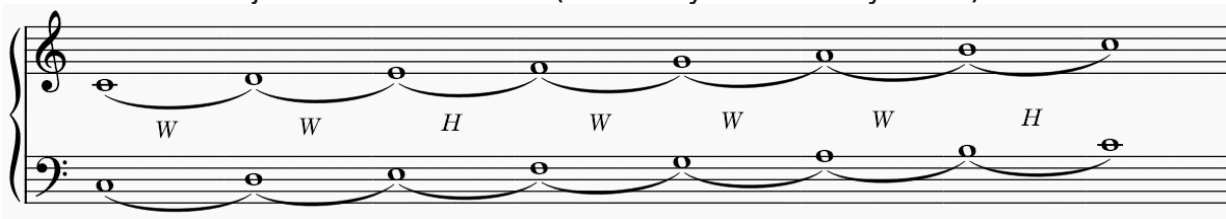
3. Use flat(s) to write B-flat major scale on a music staff in G clef.

*Hint: Tones and semitones pattern **W-W-H-W-W-W-H**.*

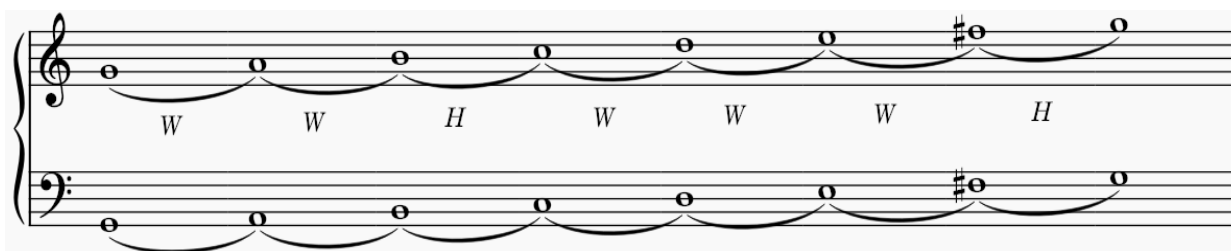
1.1.1. Construction of Major Scales with Sharps

Major scales that use sharps follow the interval pattern whole–whole–half–whole–whole–whole–half (W–W–H–W–W–W–H). Sharps are added in a consistent order: F[#], C[#], G[#], D[#], A[#], E[#], B[#], commonly remembered with the mnemonic “**F**ather **C**harles **G**oes **D**own **A**nd **E**nds **B**attle.”

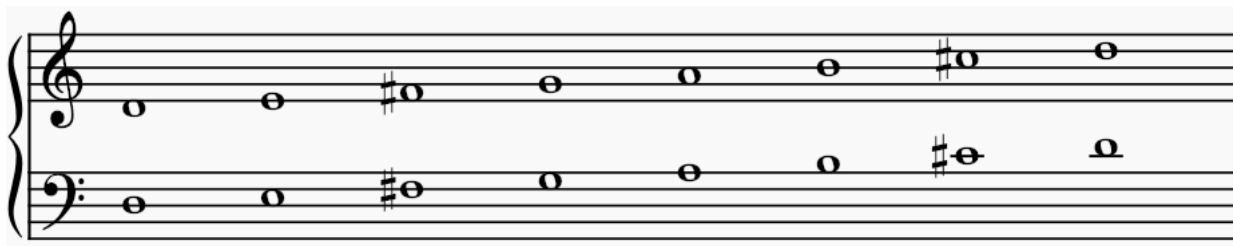
Each new key is formed by moving up a perfect fifth from the previous key, which creates the **Circle of Fifths**. **C Major**: No sharp is required; all notes of C Major scale are natural (white keys on the keyboard).



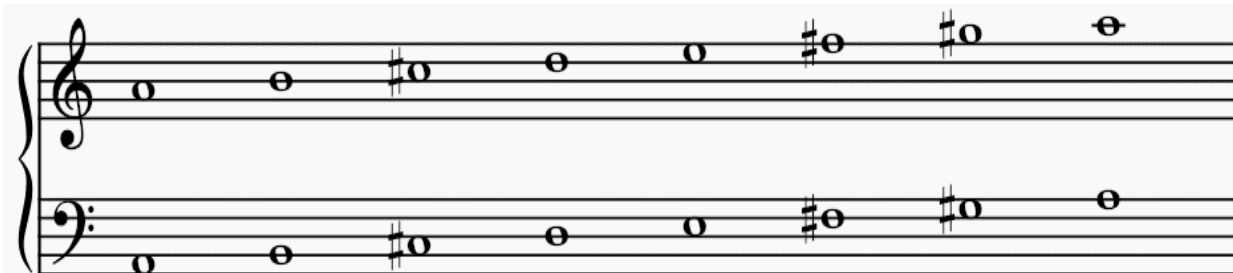
- **G Major**: In the same way, when building the G Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern starting from G, one sharp is required on F.



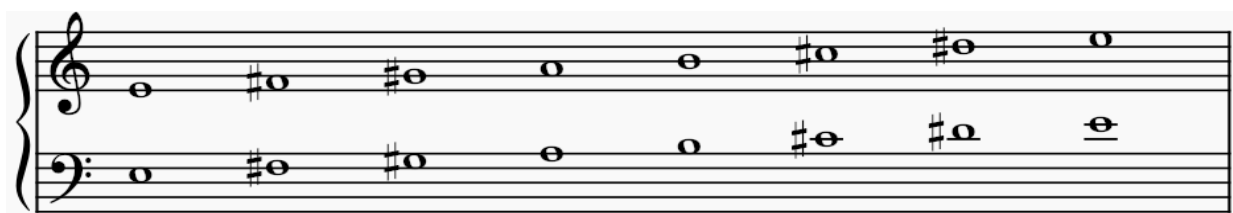
- **D Major**: Just as two previous scales, C and G Major Scale, when building the D Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern starting from D, two sharps are required: F[#] and C[#].



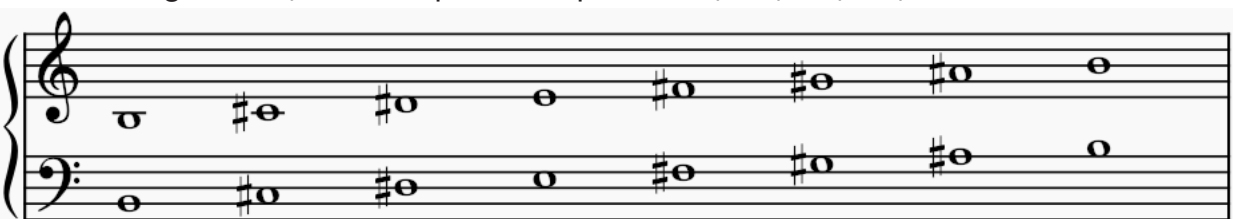
- **A Major:** When building the A Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern starting from A, three sharps are required: F#, C#, and G#.



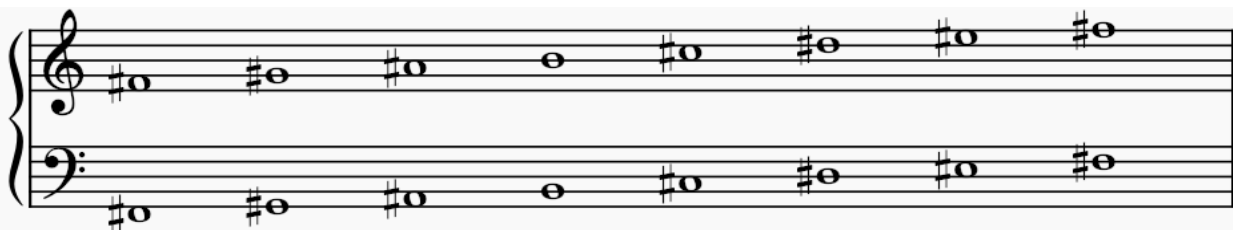
- **E Major:** When building the E Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern starting from E, four sharps are required: F#, C#, G#, and D#.



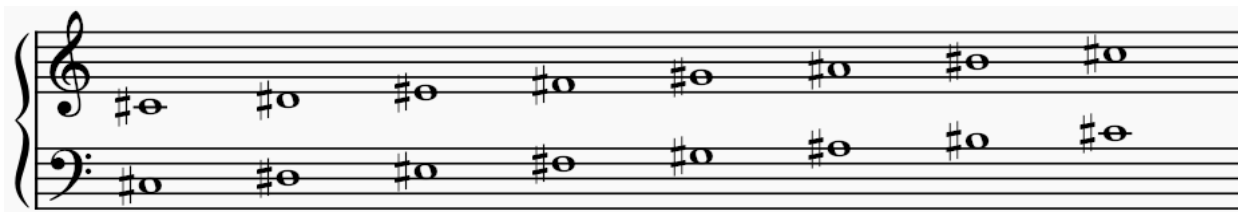
- **B Major:** When building the B Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern starting from B, five sharps are required: F#, C#, G#, D#, and A#.



- **F# Major:** When building the F# Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern starting from F#, six sharps are required: F#, C#, G#, D#, A#, and E#.



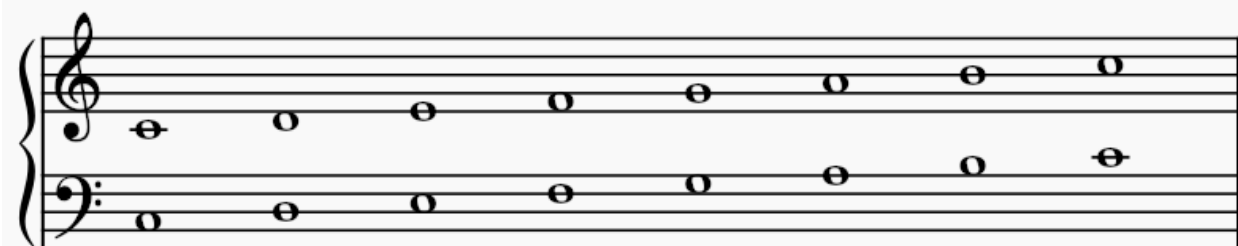
- **C# Major:** When building the C# Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern starting from C#, seven sharps are required: F#, C#, G#, D#, A#, E#, and B#.



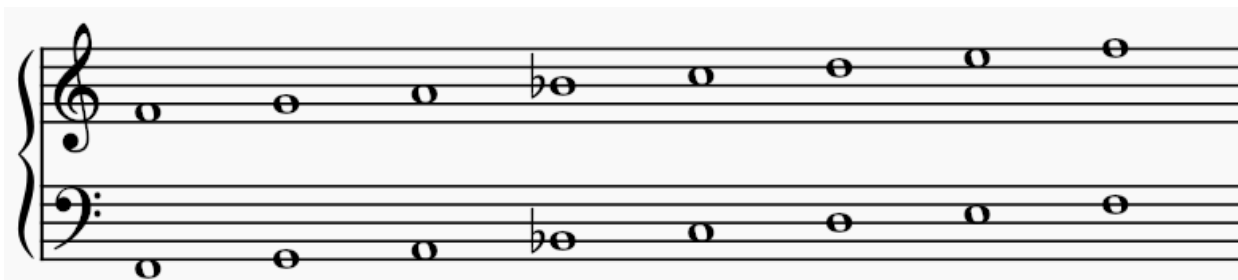
1.1.2. Construction of Major scales with flats

Major scales with flats follow the pattern W-W-H-W-W-W-H (where W = whole step, H = half step). Flats are added in the order B $\sharp$, E $\sharp$, A $\sharp$, D $\sharp$, G $\sharp$, C $\sharp$, F $\sharp$. The order of sharps can be remembered with the mnemonic pattern: "Battle Ends And Down Goes Charles' Father." Notice that the order of flats is the reverse of the order of sharps. Each new flat key is built on the 4th degree (subdominant) of the previous key, moving counterclockwise around the Circle of Fifths.

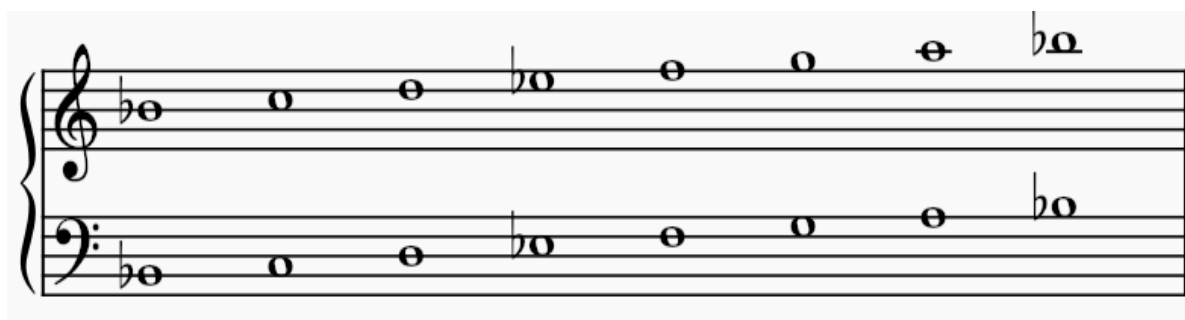
- **C Major:** No flat is required; all notes of C Major scale are natural.



- **F Major:** When building the F Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern starting from F, one flat is required: B $\flat$.

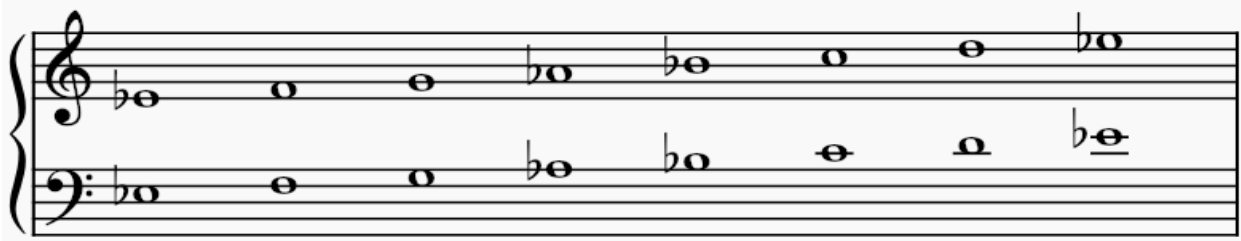


- **B $\flat$ Major:** When building the B $\flat$ Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern starting from B $\flat$, two flats are required: B $\flat$ and E $\flat$.

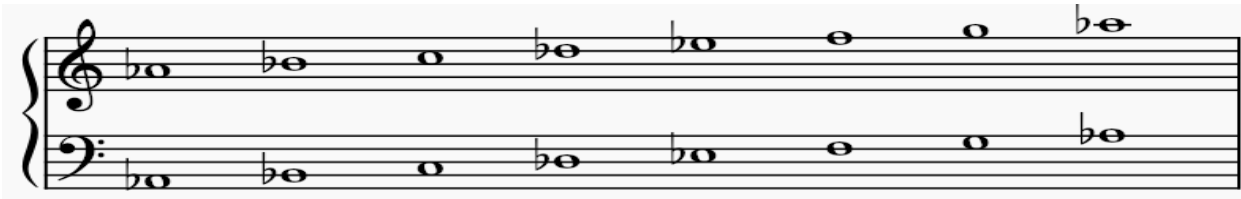


- **E $\flat$ Major:** When building the E $\flat$ Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern

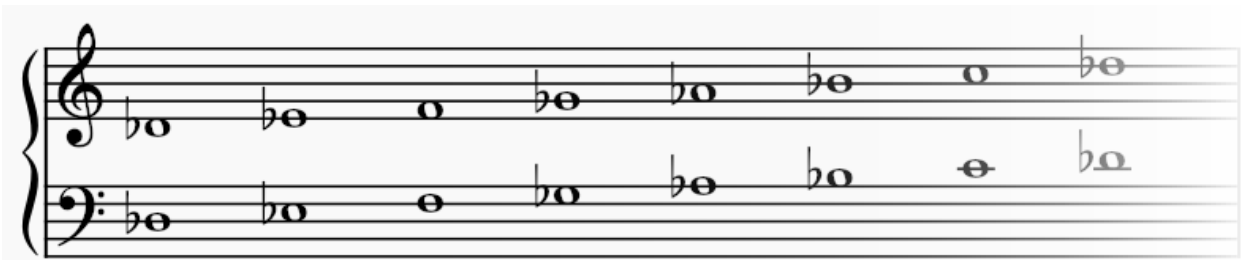
starting from E^b, three flats are required: B^b, E^b, and A^b.



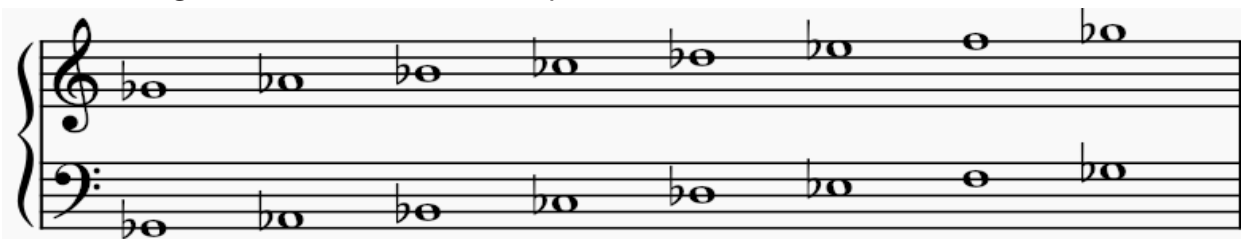
- E^b Major: When building the A^b Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern starting from A^b, four flats are required: B^b, E^b, A^b, and D^b.



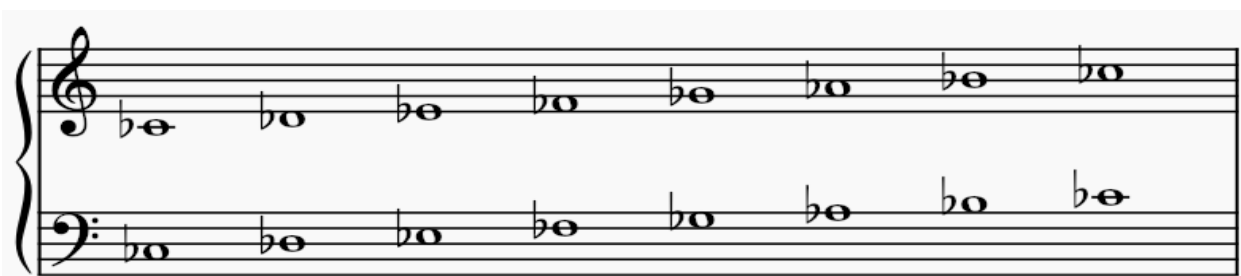
- D^b Major: When building the D^b Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern starting from D^b, five flats are required: B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b, and G^b.



- G^b Major: When building the G^b Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern starting from G^b, six flats are required: B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b, G^b, and C^b.



- C Major: When building the C^b Major scale using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern starting from C^b, seven flats are required: B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b, G^b, C^b, and F^b.



1.2. Scale Degrees

Read carefully the following short story!

Once upon a time, in the Kingdom of Music, **Tonic** was the king. Everything felt stable and at home whenever he was around. One day, **Supertonic** stepped forward, eager to help the king move somewhere new. Right beside him stood **Mediant**, always trying to decide whether to side with happiness or sadness. Nearby, **Subdominant** began stirring trouble, gently pushing the music away from home. Then came **Dominant**, powerful and restless, demanding everyone return to the king at once. Just before the journey ended,

Submediant appeared, sounding emotional and mysterious, offering a moment of reflection. Finally, **Leading Tone** leaned forward, full of tension, whispering, “We must go back to Tonic!” And so, the kingdom returned safely home, where **Tonic** ruled again in perfect peace.

Reflection activity:



1. After reading a short story above:
 - a. Arrange the highlighted words from the first to the last.
 - b. What do you observe about them? How many are they?
 - c. Relate each word to notes in the major scale. Refer to the pattern of tones and semi tones.

Example: C Major Scale with Scale Degrees:

Note Scale	Scale Degree Number	Scale Degree name	Explanation
C	1	Tonic	The home note; the tonal center; the most stable note that feels like “rest”
D	2	Supertonic	The note “super” (above) the tonic; one step above the home note
E	3	Mediant	The “middle” note; mediant means it’s midway between the tonic (C) and dominant (G)
F	4	Subdominant	The note below (“sub”) the dominant; a perfect 5th below the tonic (or perfect 4th above)
G	5	Dominant	The second most important note; creates tension that wants to resolve to the tonic

A	6	Submediant	Below ("sub") the mediant; midway between the subdominant (F) and tonic (C) above. The 6th degree of the scale is a 3rd (mediant) below the tonic.
B	7	Leading Tone	Leads strongly to the tonic; only one half step below C, creating strong pull upward
C	8 (or 1)	Tonic (Octave)	Returns to the home note, one octave higher; completes the scale

1.3. Tones and semitones series in a major scale



Learning activity 2.2

Using a Piano keyboard,

- Play C major scale on the piano and identify the tone and semitone pattern in a major scale.
- Display keyboard diagram showing C–D–E–F–G–A–B–C. Identify the tone and semitone pattern in a major scale.

1. Measure Together

- Count semitones between each two consecutive white keys.
- Write the pattern on the board.

2. Quick Application

- Apply the same pattern you discovered in C Major starting from G.
- Read out the notes.
- Play the G major scale to confirm it sounds "major"
- Why do C major and G major sound similar?

A major scale contains eight notes following the pattern T-T-S-T-T-T-S or W-W-H-W-W-W-H (T stands for Tone, S stands for Semi tones and W stands for Whole notes, H stands for Half-notes). This consistent pattern of tones and semitones creates the bright characteristic sound of major scales and applies to all major scales regardless of sharps or flats.

Example: C Major Scale

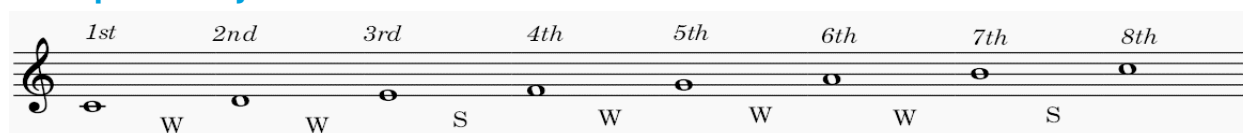


Figure 1.2 gives a visualization of the tones and semitones pattern of a major scale is shown taking C Major Scale as an example.

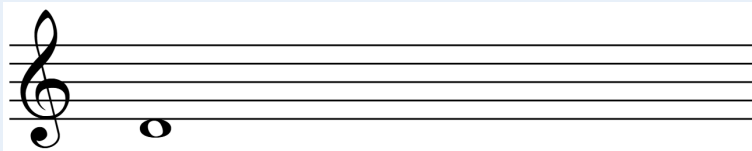


Figure 1.2 Tones and semitones pattern for C Major Scale on a piano keyboard.

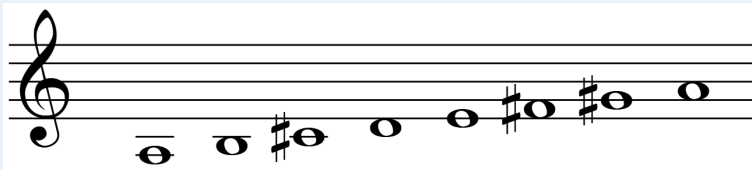


APPLICATION ACTIVITY 1.2

1. State the pattern of tones and semitones that form a major scale, using the W-H abbreviation.
2. Why do all major scales sound similar, even though they start on different notes and may contain different sharps or flats?
3. Construct a D major scale by applying the T-T-S-T-T-T-S pattern.



4. Identify the major scale corresponding to the following:



1.1. Major key signatures



Learning activity 1.3

In groups of four, work as music detectives to crack the code for key signatures.

5. Look at the following scales:

G Major scale: G-A-B-C-D-E-F[#]-G

D Major scale: D-E- **F[#]**-G-A-B-**C[#]**-D

What is the relationship between the **last sharp** in both scales and the **name of the key**?

6. Look at the following scales:

B^b Major scale: B^b-C- D-E^b- F-G-A-B^b

E^b Major scale: E^b-F-G- A^b- B^b- C- D-E^b

Consider the scales above and compare to the other scales with Flats (except F Major that is an exception. What do you observe?

7. What is the name of the key that has

- 4 sharps in the order F[#], C[#], G[#], D[#].
- 4 flats in the order B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b.

A **key signature** appears at the very beginning of a music staff, right after the clef symbol. It indicates which notes are consistently played as sharps or flats throughout the piece. By establishing these alterations in advance, the composer avoids having to write a sharp or flat sign every time the note appears. This makes the music easier to read, cleaner on the page, and more efficient for the performer.

1.1.1. Sharp key signatures and corresponding major scales

Sharp key signatures are key signatures that contain sharps (♯) rather than flats (♭). They indicate which notes should be played a half step higher than their natural state. This applies throughout a piece of music unless otherwise specified by accidentals. Sharp key signatures (ranging from one to seven) adhere to the following sequential order F[#]-C[#]-G[#]-D[#]-A[#]-E[#]-B[#].

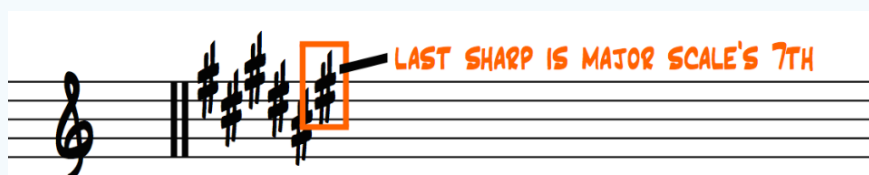
To determine a sharp major key: Ascend a semitone from the final sharp displayed in the key signature or simply take the semitone following the final sharp.

Examples

- **F#** is the last sharp: The key is **G major** (just count a half-step from the last sharp):



- **B#** is the last sharp: The key is C# major (just count a half-step from the last sharp).



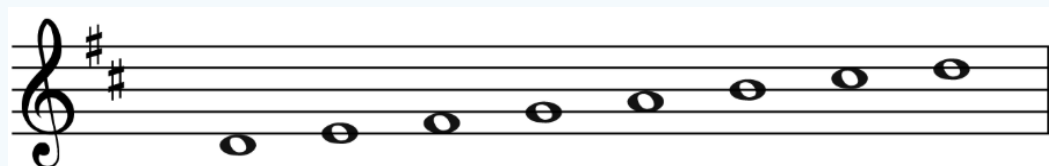
- **C Major Scale:** No sharps are present in the key signature.



- **G Major Scale:** One sharp (F#). The final sharp is F#; ascending a semitone yields G.



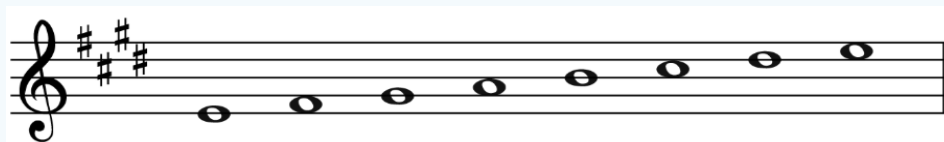
- **D Major Scale:** Two sharps (F#, C#). The final sharp is C#; ascending a semitone yields D.



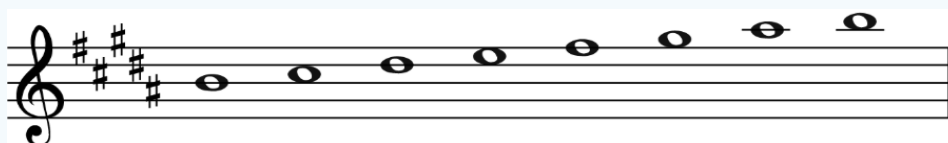
- **A Major Scale:** Three sharps (F#, C#, G#). The final sharp is G#; ascending a semitone yields A.



- **E Major Scale:** Four sharps (F[#], C[#], G[#], D[#]). The final sharp is D[#]; ascending a semitone yields E.



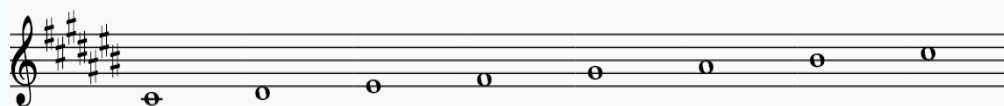
- **B Major Scale:** Five sharps (F[#], C[#], G[#], D[#], A[#]). The final sharp is A[#]; ascending a semitone yields B.



- **F Major Scale:** Six sharps (F[#], C[#], G[#], D[#], A[#], E[#]). The final sharp is E[#]; ascending a semitone yields F[#].



- **C Major Scale:** Seven sharps (F[#], C[#], G[#], D[#], A[#], E[#], B[#]). The final sharp is B[#]; ascending a semitone yields C[#].

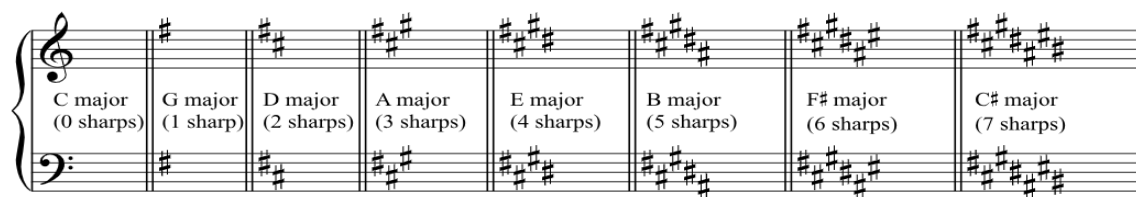


Summary of sharps and their major key signature



Number of Sharps	Sharps in Order	Major Key (Scale)
1 sharp	F [#]	G major
2 sharps	F [#] , C [#]	D major
3 sharps	F [#] , C [#] , G [#]	A major
4 sharps	F [#] , C [#] , G [#] , D [#]	E major
5 sharps	F [#] , C [#] , G [#] , D [#] , A [#]	B major
6 sharps	F [#] , C [#] , G [#] , D [#] , A [#] , E [#]	F [#] major
7 sharps	F [#] , C [#] , G [#] , D [#] , A [#] , E [#] , B [#]	C [#] major

On a grand staff,



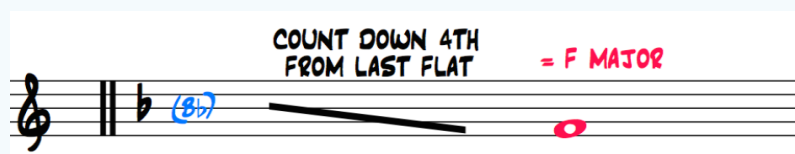
1.1.2. Flat key signatures and corresponding major scales

Flat key signatures work the same way as sharp key signatures, but instead of raising notes, they lower them. A flat key signature appears at the beginning of a music piece, right after the clef, and shows which notes are played as flats throughout the entire piece. This tells the performer to automatically lower those notes by a half step whenever they appear, without needing a flat sign written each time. Flat key signatures, from one to seven flats, follow a consistent order: B^b , E^b , A^b , D^b , G^b , C^b , F^b .

To determine a flat major key: the penultimate (second-to-last) flat displayed in the key signature is the key name. This is equivalent to taking the last flattened note as the major scale's 4th degree:

Examples

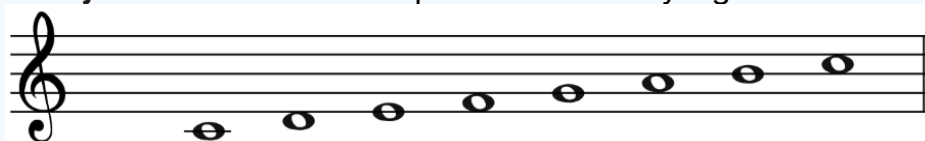
- **B^b is the last flat:** The key is F major. It is found out by just counting down a 4th to find the major scale's root.



- **C^b is the last flat:** The key is G^b major. It is found out by *just counting down a 4th to find the major scale's root*.

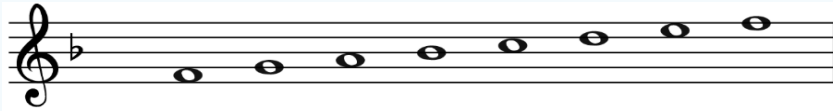


- **C Major Scale:** No flats are present in the key signature.



- **F Major Scale:** One flat (B^b). This must be memorized as F Major, as there is no penultimate flat.

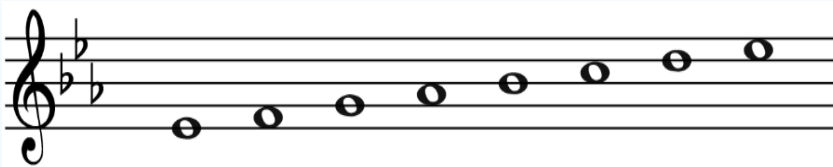
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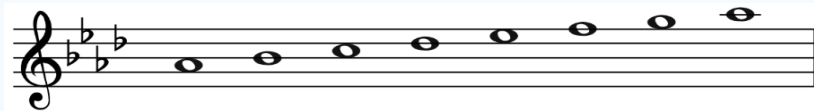
- **B^b Major Scale:** Two flats (B^b and E^b). The penultimate flat is B^b; this is the key name.



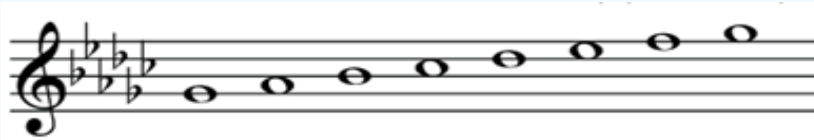
- **E^b Major Scale:** Three flats (B^b, E^b, and A^b). The penultimate flat is E^b; this is the key name.



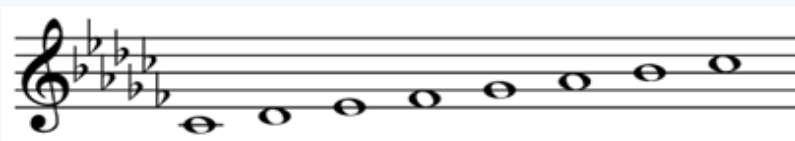
- **A^b Major Scale:** Four flats (B^b, E^b, A^b, and D^b). The penultimate flat is A^b; this is the key name.



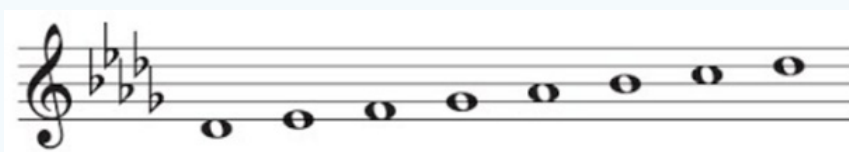
- **G^b Major Scale:** Six flats (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b, G^b and C^b). The penultimate flat is G^b; this is the key name.



- **C^b Major Scale:** Seven flats (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b, G^b, C^b, and F^b). The penultimate flat is C^b; this is the key name.



- **D^b Major Scale:** Five flats (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b and G^b). The penultimate flat is D^b; this is the key name.



Summary of flats and their major key signatures:

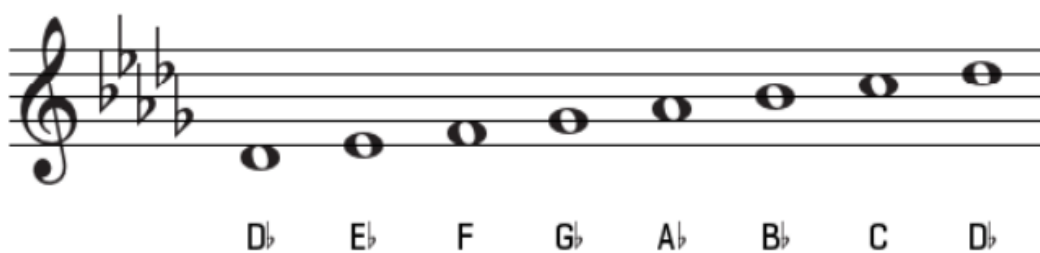
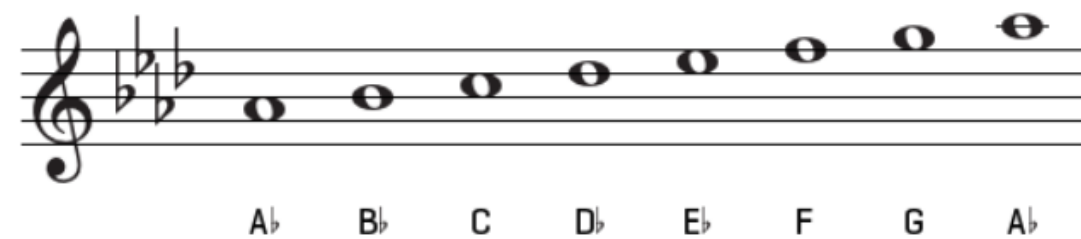
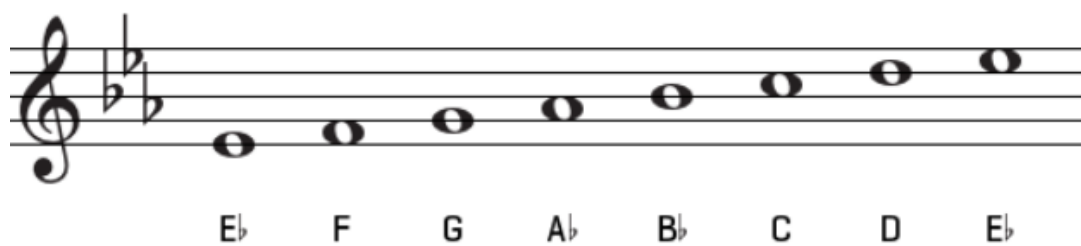


Number of Flats	Flats in Order	Major Key (Scale)
1 flat	B ^b	F major
2 flats	B ^b , E ^b	B ^b major
3 flats	B ^b , E ^b , A ^b	E ^b major
4 flats	B ^b , E ^b , A ^b , D ^b	A ^b major
5 flats	B ^b , E ^b , A ^b , D ^b , G ^b	D ^b major
6 flats	B ^b , E ^b , A ^b , D ^b , G ^b , C ^b	G ^b major
7 flats	B ^b , E ^b , A ^b , D ^b , G ^b , C ^b , F ^b	C ^b major

On a grand staff,

Summary of all sharp key signatures on a grand staff

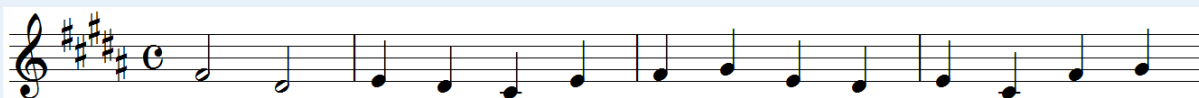
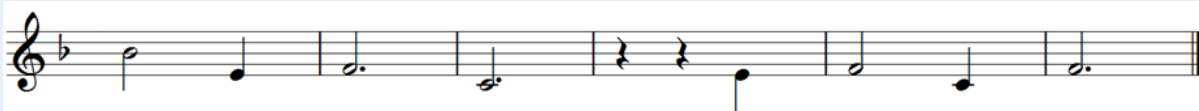
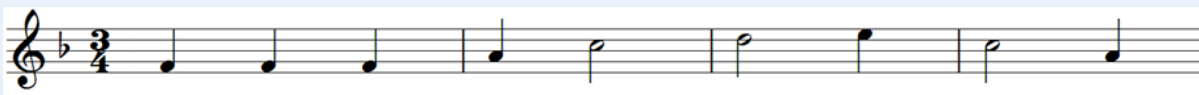
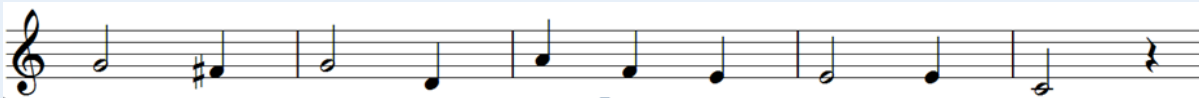
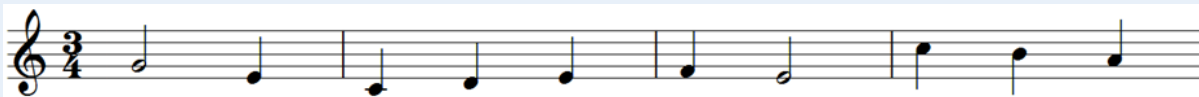






APPLICATION ACTIVITY 1.3

1. State the primary purpose of using key signatures in music notation.
2. Given the sharps $F^\sharp$, $C^\sharp$, $G^\sharp$, $D^\sharp$, $A^\sharp$:
 - a. Name the major key.
 - b. Write its major scale, clearly indicating the T-T-S-T-T-T-S pattern.
3. Given the flats B^b , E^b , A^b :
 - a. Name the major key.
 - b. Write its major scale, clearly indicating the T-T-S-T-T-T-S pattern.
4. For the scale $F-G-A-B^b-C-D-E-F$:
 - a. Verify if it follows the T-T-S-T-T-T-S pattern.
 - b. Identify the required accidental to correct it into a proper major scale.
5. Compose a short, 8-measure melody for a piano that is written in a major key with a key signature.
6. Solfa and perform



TUBANE MU RUKUNDO

U ru ku ndo ni rwo ge re u ru ku
 ndo ni rwo ge re kw'i si ho se ba rwa ma ma ze
 1. Tu ba ne mu ru ku ndo ru zi r'u bu rya rya
 2. Tu ba ne mu ru ku ndo ru du ho re twi shi mye
 tu ru kwi ze ho se ru sa ga mbe
 du fa sha nye twe se du te r'i mbe re

IGIHE

1. I gi h'i yo gi hi se ki ge nda bu ru
 2. Nza ko ra n'u mwe te si nza nda go ze
 ndu ki ka zi mi ra Njye we nza ho ra
 ra nza gi r'i ba kwe
 nde ke re je i gi he nti ki nsi ge
 I'll sing of the Lord's great love for - e - ver with my mouth
 I'll make His name known through all ge - ne - ra - tion

I AM PROUD

I'm proud I'm proud I'm proud of my coun-
try I'm proud 'cause I live in peace



END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

1. State the order of sharps and the order of flats used in key signatures.
2. Using the W-W-H-W-W-W-H pattern, write the specified major scales without using key signatures.

D $\flat$ major scale

A major scale

3. Given the key signature, specify the major key.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

8 9 10 11 12 13 14

4. Write the major key signature for each key given. Be sure to use the correct order for sharps and flats.



1. A major 2. B $\flat$ major 3. F $\sharp$ major 4. D $\flat$ major 5. D major



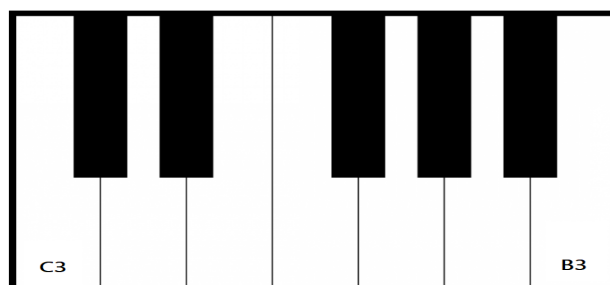
6. C $\flat$ major 7. E $\flat$ major 8. B major 9. F major 10. C $\sharp$ major

5. By using a treble staff, compose **and perform an 8-measure melody in A major scale using the** time signature
6. Compose and perform an 8-measure melody in **E $\flat$ Major using** time signature.

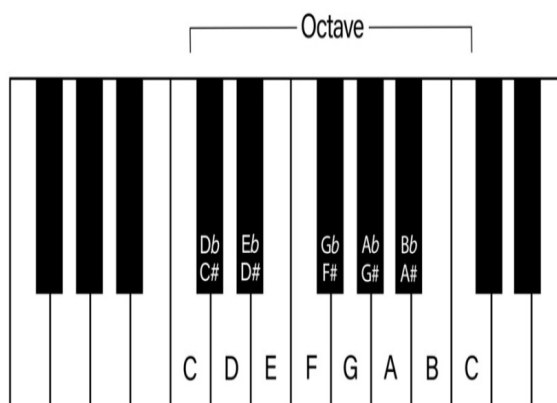


Consolidation Activity

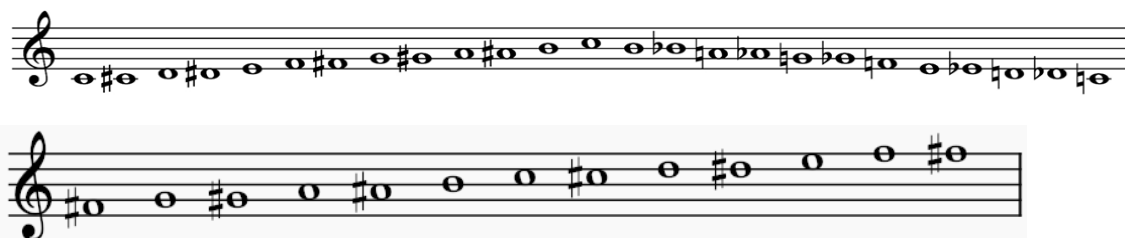
1. In groups of three, look at the following octave of a piano keyboard from C3 to B3 as shown in on this piano keyboard section and answer the following questions:

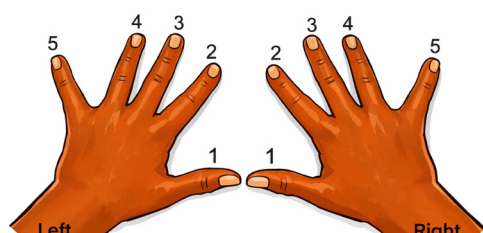


- How many white keys are there on the above keyboard?
 - How many black keys are there on the above keyboard?
3. Referring to the above keyboard, the smallest distance between any two nearest keys is called semitone or half-step, while the distance equivalent to two semitones is called tone or whole step. Now consider the white keys only:
- How many half-steps are there in C scale?
 - How many whole steps are there in C scale?
 - Identify steps and half steps on a piano keyboard
3. For a single piano octave from C up to the next C:



- Determine the number of white keys from one C to the next C note.
- Determine the number of black keys from one C to the next C note.
- Determine the number of semitones from one C to the next C note.
- Indicate which adjacent white keys within the octave make a whole tone interval.
- Indicate which adjacent white keys within the octave make a semi-tone interval.





LESSON 1:
MAJOR SCALES
AND MAJOR KEY
SIGNATURE

LESSON 2:
MINOR SCALES
AND MINOR KEY
SIGNATURES

LESSON 3:
PENTATONIC
SCALES

LESSON 4:
PERFORMING
SKETCHES IN
ENGLISH OR
FRENCH

LESSON 5:
MELODY AND
HARMONY

UNIT 2:

MAJOR SCALES AND MINOR KEY SIGNATURE

Key unit competence: At the end of this unit, students will be able to perform simple musical compositions in various minor scales.

Domain expected learning outcomes

Knowledge	Skills	Attitudes and Values
Explain the meaning of minor key signatures in music notation.	Write minor key signatures on the staff respecting the sequence of tones and semitones.	Appreciate the expressive range and emotional depth of minor tonality.
Describe the use of accidentals in building major scales.	Construct natural, harmonic and melodic minor scales from any tonic.	Demonstrate patience Demonstrate patience in mastering the distinct patterns of minor scales.
Determine the relative minor key from a major key signature	Compose short melodic phrases in minor keys.	Show creativity in using minor scales for expression.
Explain the relationship between a major key and its relative minor.	Sight-sing short melodies in minor keys.	Develop confidence through expressive performance.
Identify minor key signatures and their equivalent major scales	Play short melodies in minor scales on piano or other instruments.	Maintain collaboration during group composition and performance activities.

Introduction

The **minor scale** is a seven-note diatonic scale defined by a specific pattern of whole steps and half steps, giving it a darker, more somber quality than the major scale. Music written in minor keys often conveys emotions such as melancholy, mystery, drama, tension, longing, or introspection.

In this unit, you will explore the expressive world of minor scales, which serves as the foundation for music across classical, folk, film, and popular genres. You will learn about the three forms of the minor scale and understand why each variation developed. You will also examine the relationship between a major key and its relative minor, which shares the same key signature.

Key Terms: Natural minor scale, harmonic minor scale, melodic minor scale, relative minor, parallel minor, minor key signatures.



Introductory activity 2.1

In groups of four, listen to the following Rwandan music artworks:

- Umunsi wandutiye iyindi by Dieudonné Munyanshoza
(https://youtu.be/VnCMMBoy-2g?si=CD4hpC2HOqz4_IR7)
 - Ubalijoro by Karemera Rodrigues
(<https://youtu.be/IPYeOvmMeYw?si=RU5Aey7sXBdWKRb0>)
- a. Do these two songs feel the same or different?
 - b. Describe briefly the feelings you perceived.

2.1. Forms of Minor Scale



Learning activity 2.1

1. Using only white keys on the piano, play a scale from A to A
 - a. Write down the sequence of notes.
 - b. Identify the interval pattern using T (tone) and S (semitone) and name it Pattern 1.
 - c. Compare the interval pattern from A to A to that of C-C in Major scale.
 - d. Are there any differences in the interval pattern? Are there any similarities? State them.
 - e. What do you conclude?
2. Now raise the 7th note (G) to G sharp: A-B-C-D-E-F-G[#]-A.
 - a. What is the interval pattern between F and G[#]?
 - b. Write the interval pattern using T (tone) and S (semitone) for this scale and name it Pattern 2.
 - c. Compare Pattern 1 and Pattern 2. What are the major differences?
3. Raise both 6th and 7th notes: A-B-C-D-E-F[#]-G[#]-A.
 - a. Identify the interval patterns and name it Pattern 3.
 - b. Compare Pattern 1, Pattern 2 and Pattern 3. What did you observe?
 - c. Using a Piano keyboard, play Pattern 1, Pattern 2 and Pattern 3 in both Ascending and descending.
 - d. Rank the three scales (the Pattern 1, Pattern 2 and Pattern 3) from the darkest to the brightest.

2.2. The Natural Minor Scale

The natural minor scale is the most basic form of the minor scale and serves as the starting point for understanding all minor keys. It follows a specific pattern of whole steps and half steps that gives it a darker, more reflective sound compared to the major scale.

The pattern of the natural minor scale is: Whole – Half – Whole – Whole – Half – Whole – Whole

Each natural minor scale is closely related to a major scale, called its relative major. The natural minor and its relative major share the same key signature, but they begin on different starting notes. For example, A minor is the relative minor of C major, meaning they use the same notes but create very different moods.

The natural minor scale is widely used in classical, folk, and popular music, and it provides the foundation from which the harmonic minor and melodic minor scales developed.

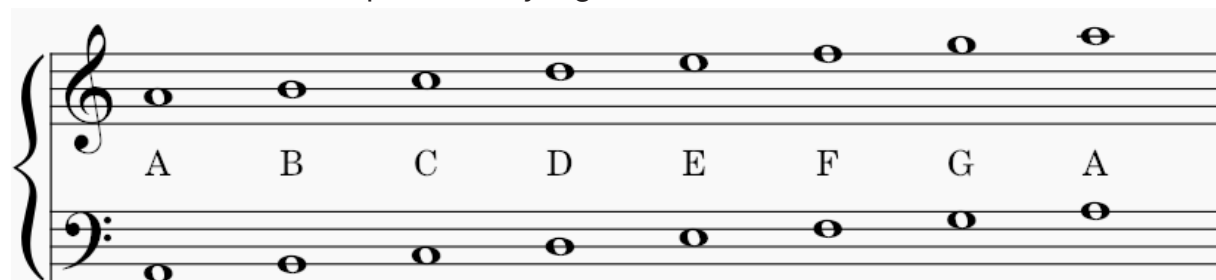
Comparing the Scales: Same Notes, Different Starting Point

Scale	Sequence of notes	Interval Pattern
C Major Scale	C - D - E - F - G - A - B - C	W - W - H - W - W - W - H
A Natural Minor Scale (its relative):	A - B - C - D - E - F - G - A	W - H - W - W - H - W - W

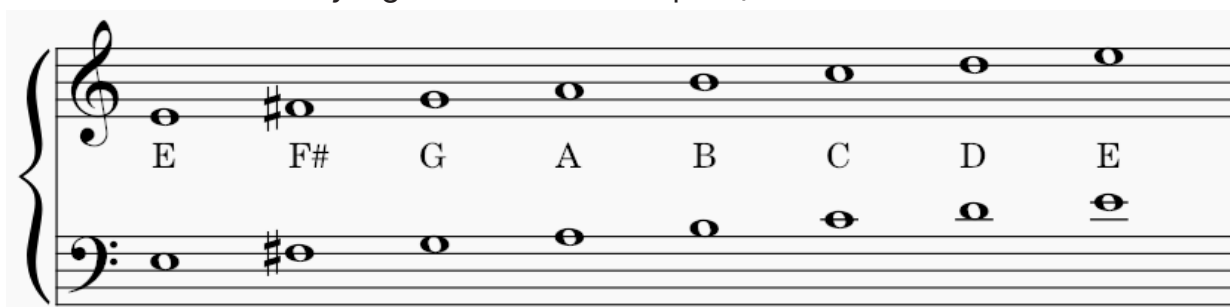
Notice: Both scales use the exact same seven notes (no sharps or flats), but they start and end on different notes. This creates a completely different sound and feeling.

A. Natural Minor Scales with Sharps

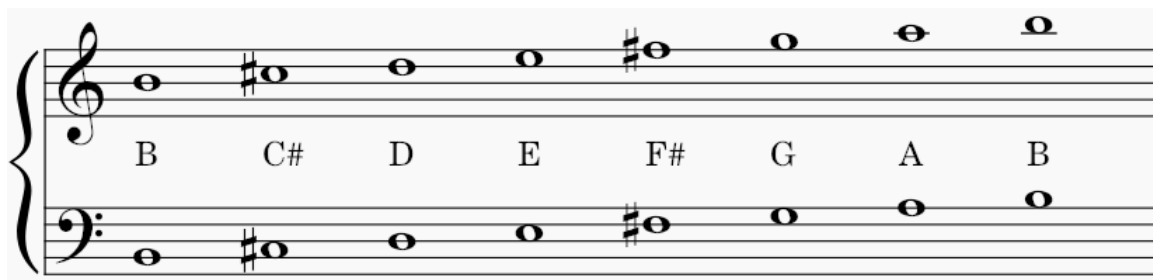
- ❖ **A Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes A, B, C, D, E, F, and G, and is notated with no sharps in its key signature.



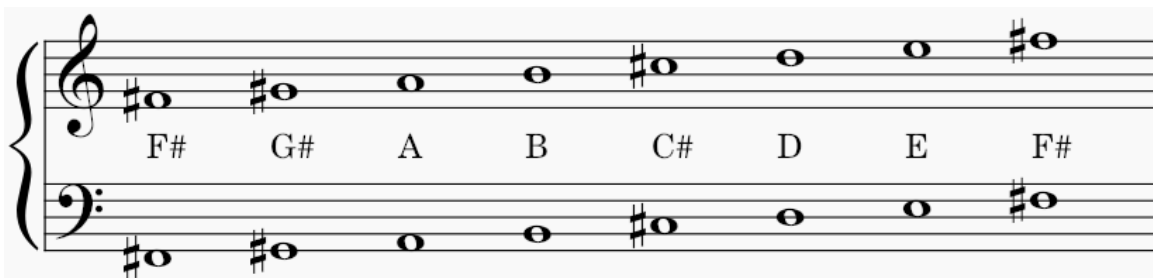
- ❖ **E Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes E, F[#], G, A, B, C, and D, and is notated with a key signature of one sharp (F[#]).



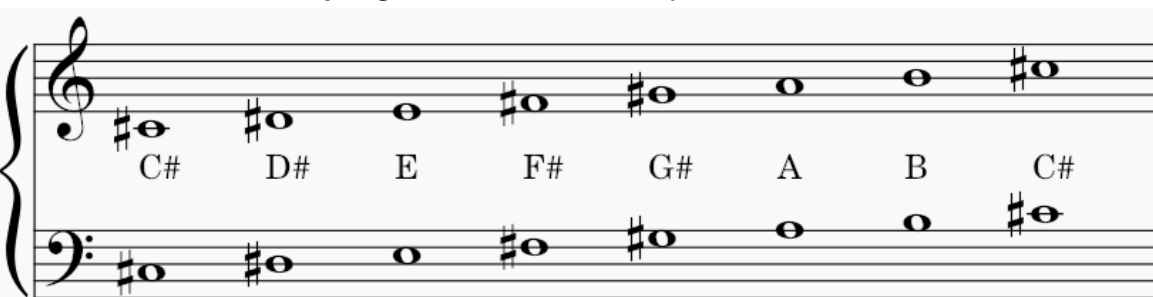
- ❖ **B Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes B, C[#], D, E, F[#], G, and A, and is notated with a key signature of two sharps (F[#] and C[#]).



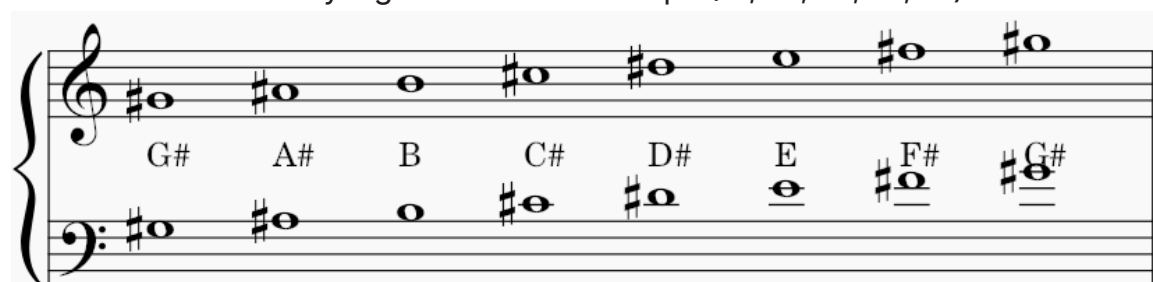
- ❖ **F# Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes F#, G#, A, B, C#, D, and E, and is notated with a key signature of three sharps (F#, C# and G#).



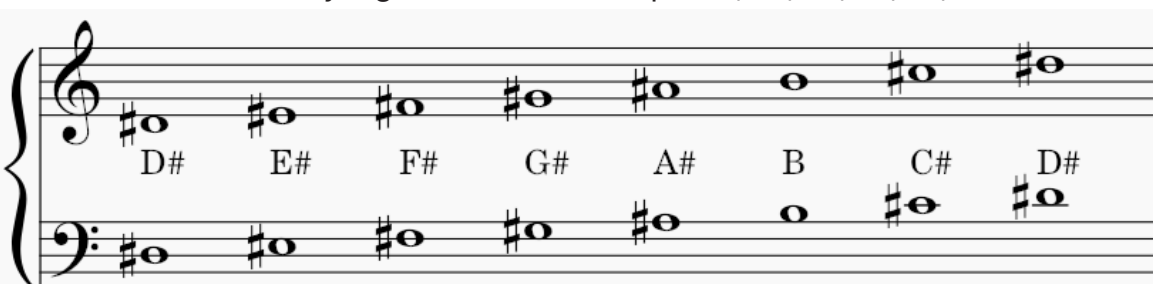
- ❖ **C# Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes C#, D#, E, F#, G#, A, and B, and is notated with a key signature of four sharps (F#, C#, G#, D#).



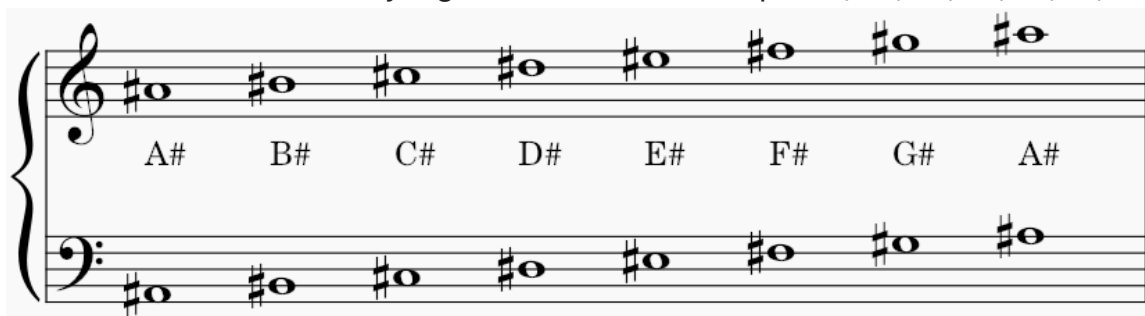
- ❖ **G# Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes G#, A#, B, C#, D#, E, and F#, and is notated with a key signature of five sharps (F#, C#, G#, D#, A#).



- ❖ **D# Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes D#, E#, F#, G#, A#, B, and C#, and is notated with a key signature of six sharps (F#, C#, G#, D#, A#, E#).

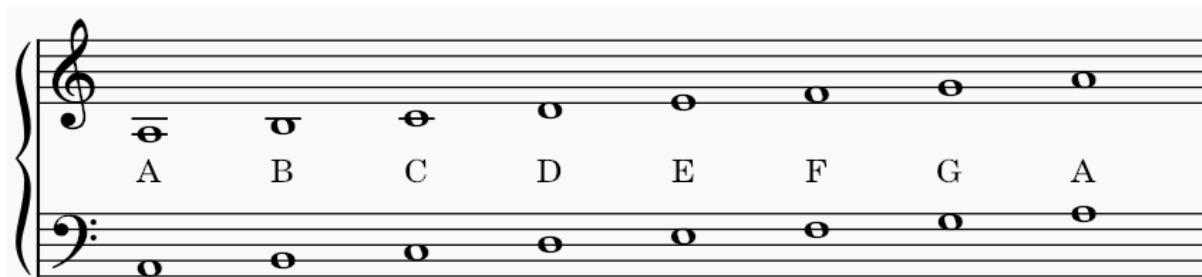


- ❖ **A[#] Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes A[#], B[#], C[#], D[#], E[#], F[#], and G[#], and is notated with a key signature of seven sharps (F[#], C[#], G[#], D[#], A[#], E[#], B[#]).

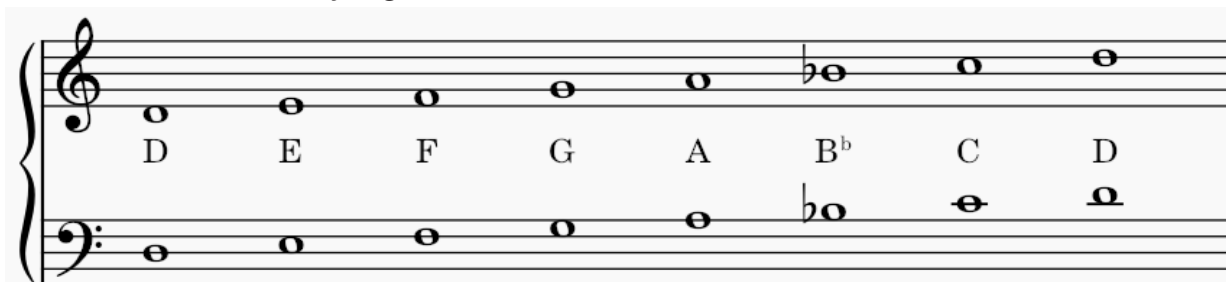


B. Natural Minor Scales with Flats

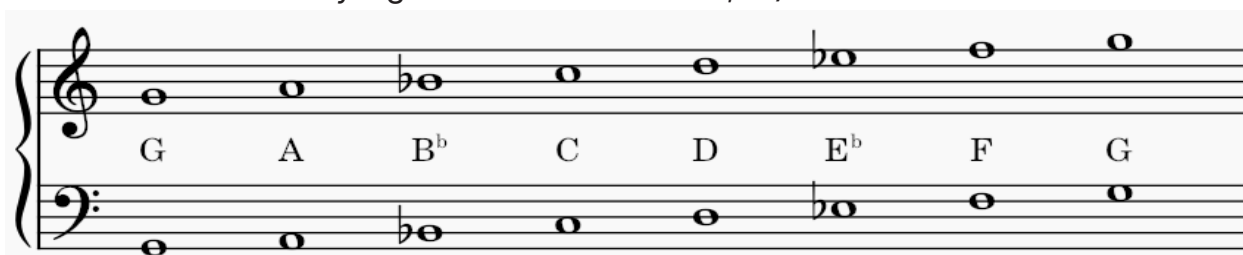
- ❖ **A Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes A, B, C, D, E, F, and G, and is notated with no flats in its key signature.



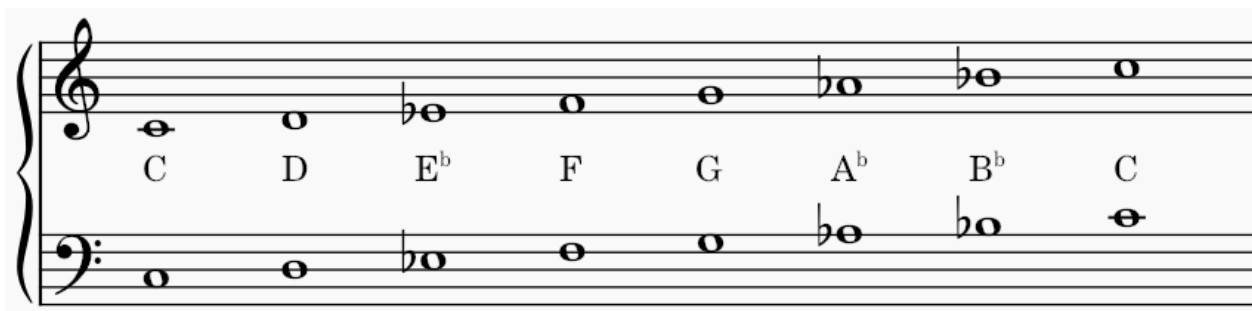
- ❖ **D Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes D, E, F, G, A, B^b, and C, and is notated with a key signature of one flat (B^b).



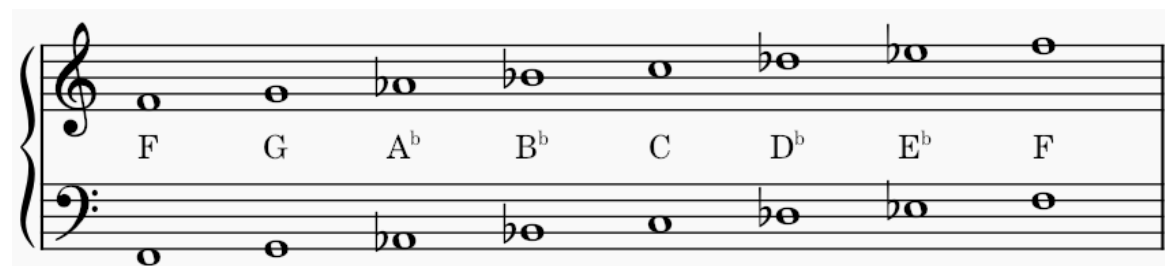
- ❖ **G Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes G, A, B^b, C, D, E^b, and F, and is notated with a key signature of two flats (B^b, E^b).



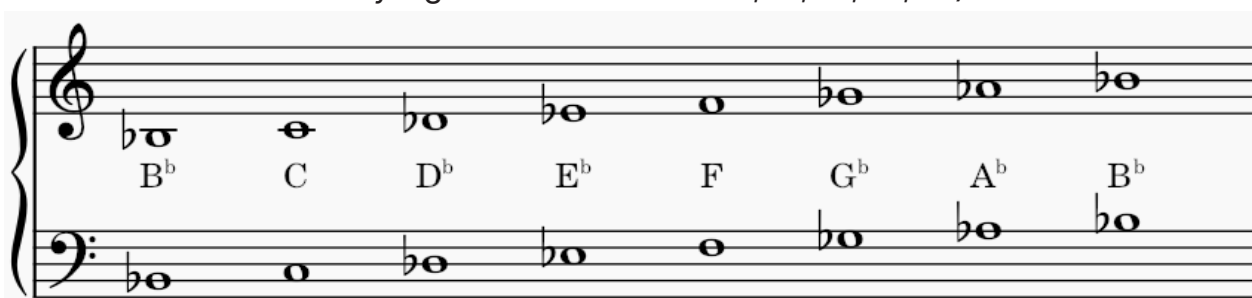
- ❖ **C Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes C, D, E^b, F, G, A^b, and B^b, and is notated with a key signature of three flats (B^b, E^b, A^b).



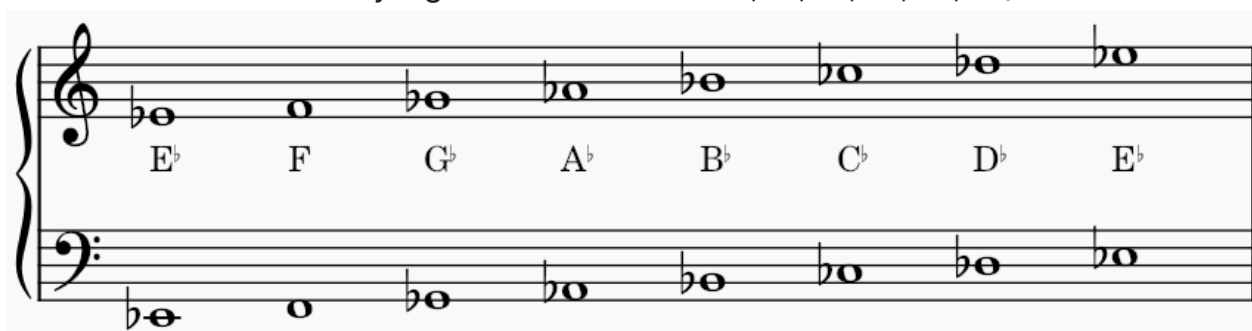
- ❖ **C Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes C, D, E^b, F, G, A^b, B^b, and C, and is notated with a key signature of two flats (B^b, E^b).



- ❖ **F Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes F, G, A^b, B^b, C, D^b, E^b, and F, and is notated with a key signature of three flats (B^b, E^b, A^b).

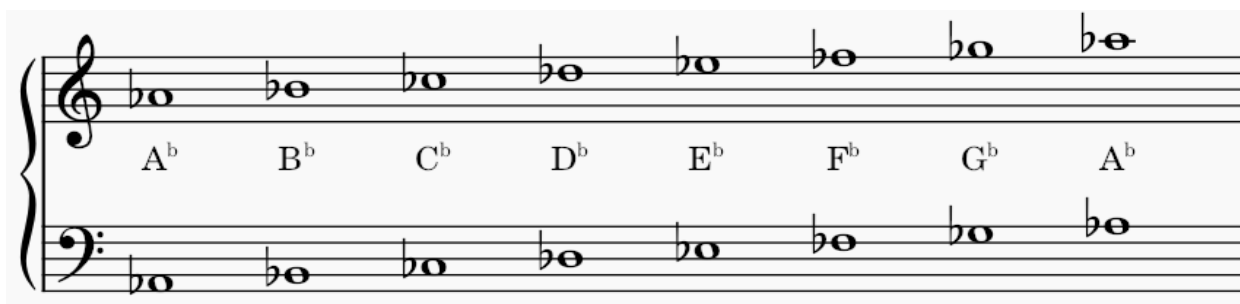


- ❖ **B Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes B^b, C, D^b, E^b, F, G^b, A^b, and B^b, and is notated with a key signature of four flats (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b).



- ❖ **E Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes E^b, F, G^b, A^b, B^b, C^b, D^b, and E^b, and is notated with a key signature of five flats (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b, G^b).

- ❖ **A Natural Minor:** The scale consists of the notes A^b, B^b, C^b, D^b, E^b, F^b, and G^b, and is notated with a key signature of six flats (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b, G^b, C^b).

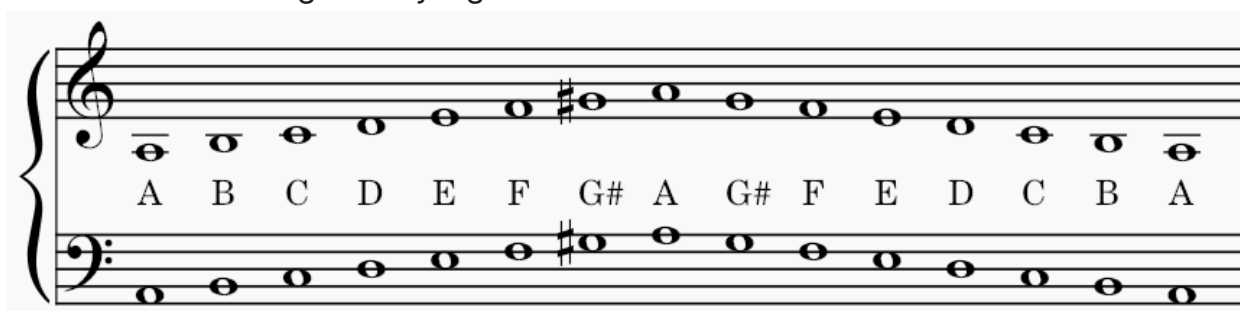


2.3. The Harmonic Minor Scale

The harmonic minor scale is created by raising the 7th note of the natural minor scale by one semitone. This creates a stronger pull toward the tonic note. The interval pattern becomes: **W-H-W-W-H-W+-H** where W+ stands for a whole step increased by a semitone, thus equivalent to three semitones.

A. Sharp Harmonic Minor Scales

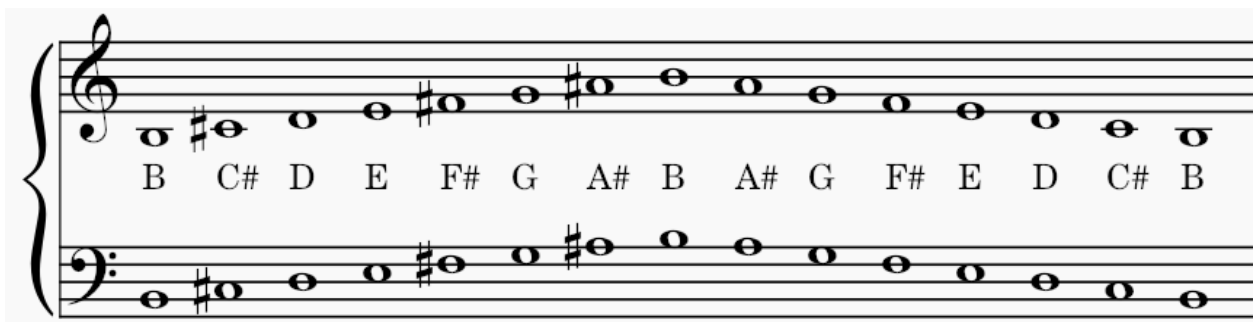
- ❖ **A Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes A, B, C, D, E, F, and G[#], and is notated using the key signature of A minor with the G[#] as an accidental.



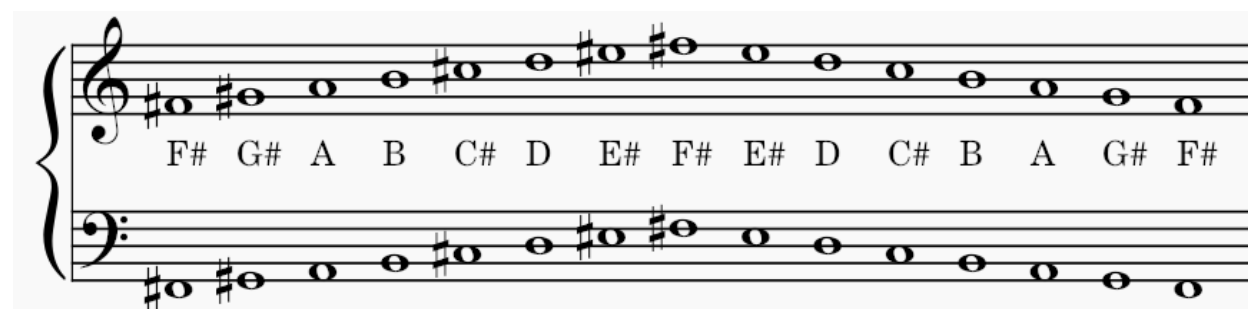
- ❖ **E Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes E, F[#], G, A, B, C, and D[#], and is notated using the key signature of E minor (F[#]), with the D[#] as an accidental.



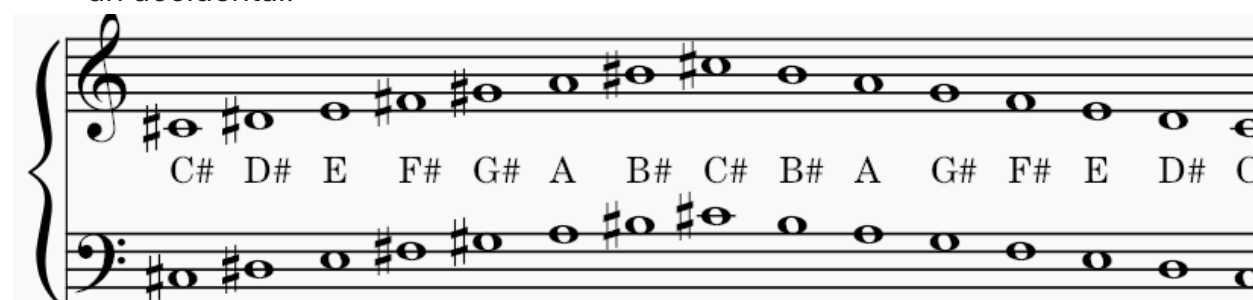
- ❖ **B Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes B, C[#], D, E, F[#], G, and A[#], and is notated using the key signature of B minor (F[#], C[#]), with the A[#] as an accidental.



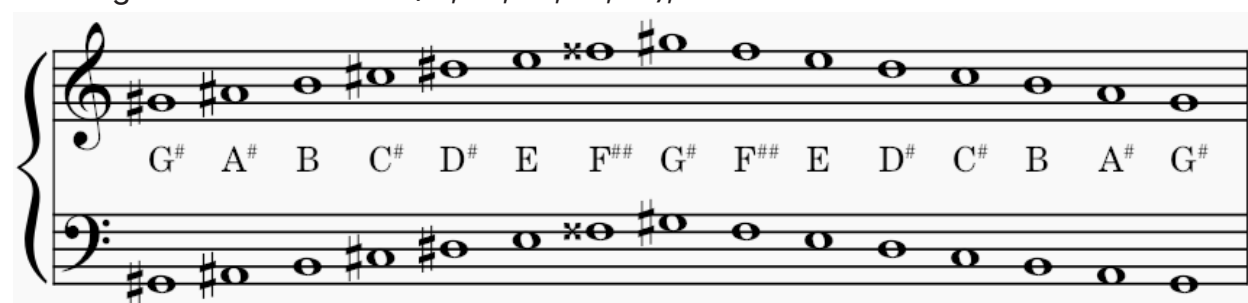
- ❖ **F# Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes F#, G#, A, B, C#, D, and E#, and is notated using the key signature of F# minor (F#, C#, G#), with the E# as an accidental.



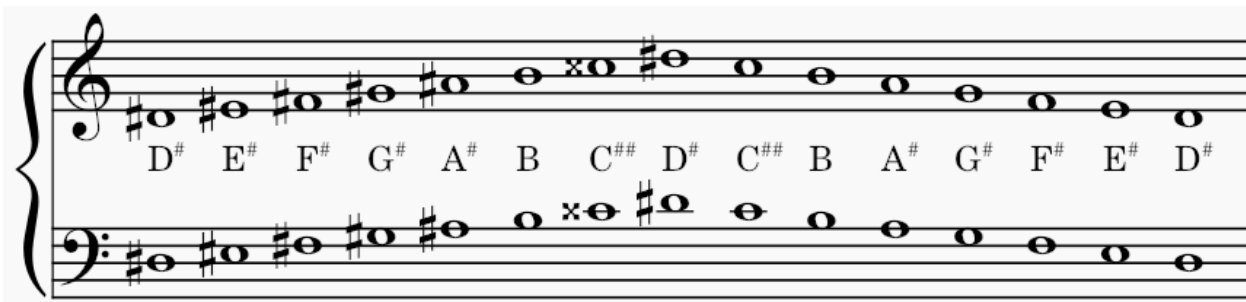
- ❖ **C# Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes C#, D#, E, F#, G#, A, and B#, and is notated using the key signature of C# minor (F#, C#, G#, D#), with the B# as an accidental.



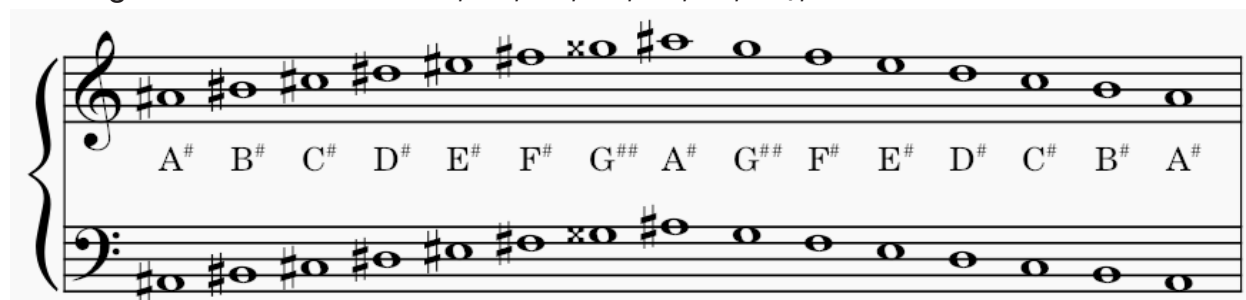
- ❖ **G# Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes G#, A#, B, C#, D#, E, and F## (F double-sharp equivalent to F* in notation), and is notated using the key signature of G# minor (F#, C#, G#, D#, A#), with the F## as an accidental.



- ❖ **D# Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes D#, E#, F#, G#, A#, B, and C## (C double-sharp equivalent to C* in notation), and is notated using the key signature of D# minor (F#, C#, G#, D#, A#, E#), with the C## as an accidental.

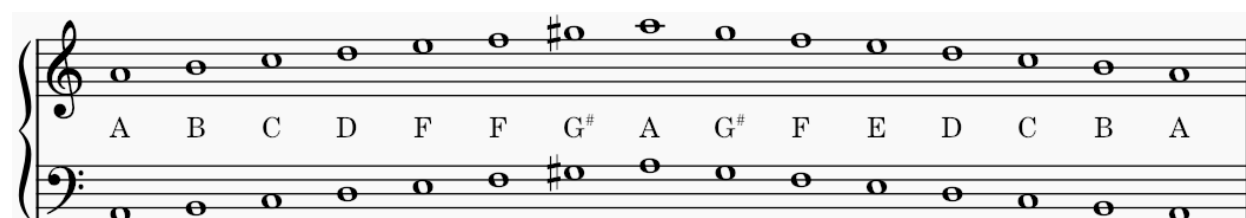


- ❖ **A# Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes A#, B#, C#, D#, E#, F#, and G## (G double-sharp equivalent to G* in notation), and is notated using the key signature of A# minor (F#, C#, G#, D#, A#, E#, B#), with the G# as an accidental.

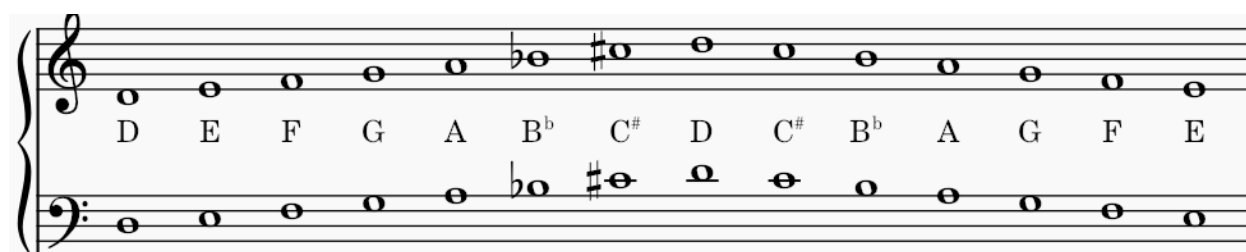


B. Flats harmonic minor scales

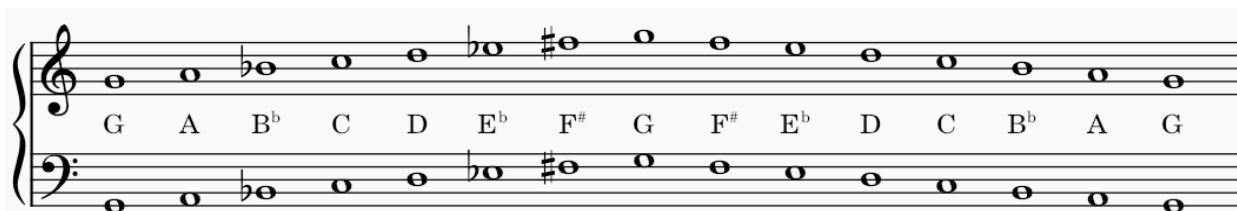
- ❖ **A Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes A, B, C, D, E, F, and G#, and is notated using the key signature of A minor (no sharps or flats), with the G# as an accidental.



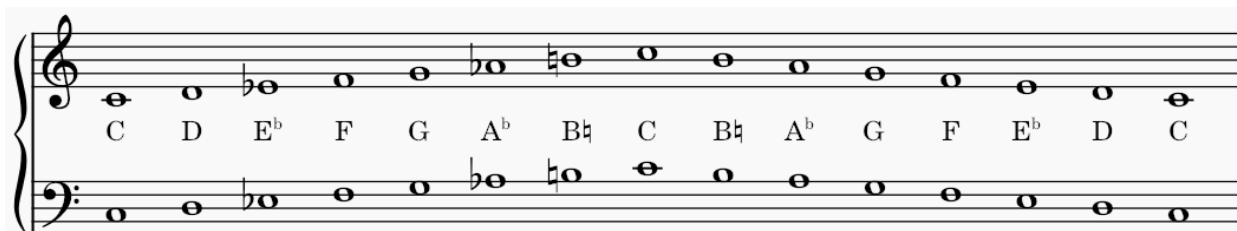
- ❖ **D Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes D, E, F, G, A, Bb, and C#, and is notated using the key signature of D minor (Bb), with the C# as an accidental.



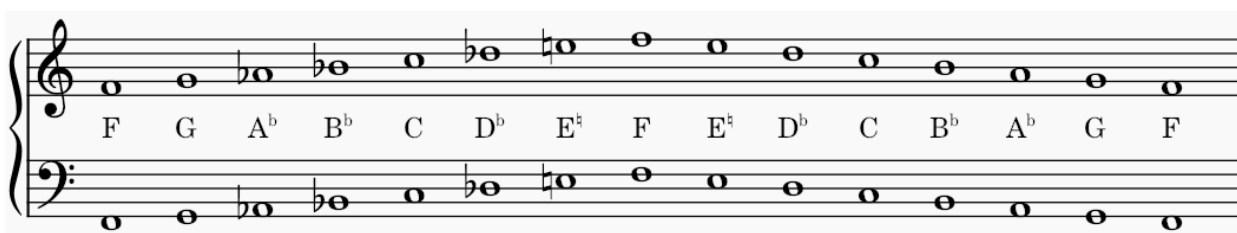
- ❖ **G Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes G, A, Bb, C, D, Eb, and F#, and is notated using the key signature of G minor (Bb, Eb), with the F# as an accidental.



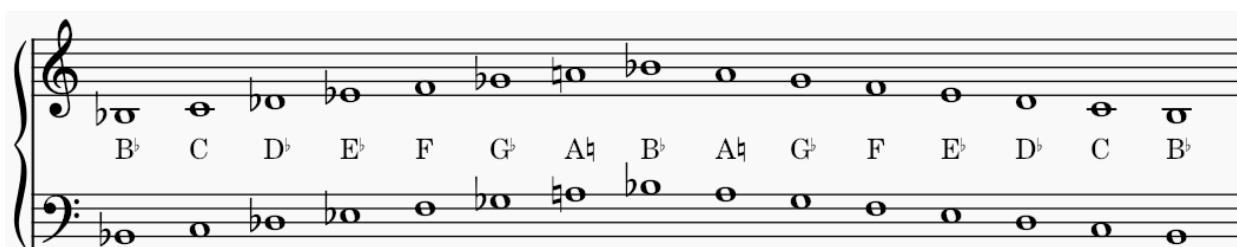
- ❖ **C Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes C, D, E^b, F, G, A^b, and B[#], and is notated using the key signature of C minor (B^b, E^b, A^b), with the B[#] as an accidental.



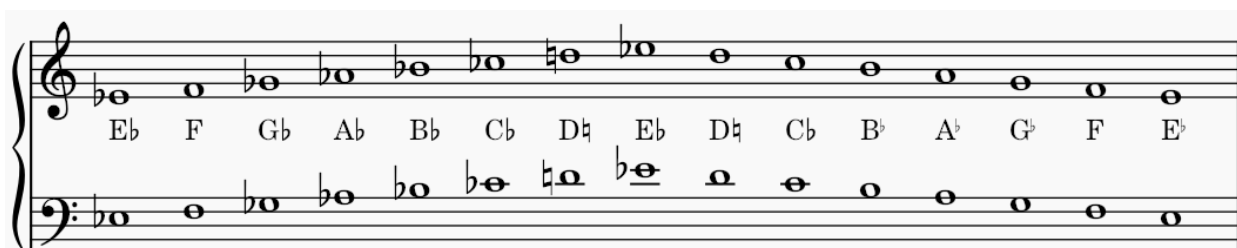
- ❖ **F Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes F, G, A^b, B^b, C, D^b, and E[#], and is notated using the key signature of F minor (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b), with the E[#] as an accidental.



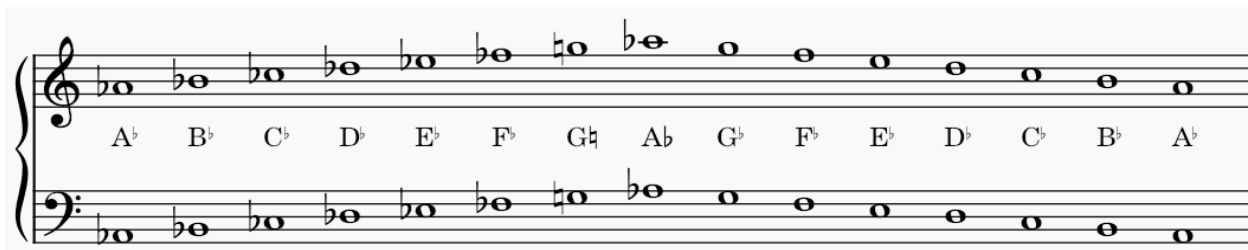
- ❖ **B^b Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes B^b, C, D^b, E^b, F, G^b, and A[#], and is notated using the key signature of B^b minor (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b, G^b), with the A[#] as an accidental.



- ❖ **E^b Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes E^b, F, G^b, A^b, B^b, C^b, and D[#], and is notated using the key signature of E^b minor (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b, G^b, C^b), with the D[#] as an accidental.



- ❖ **A^b Harmonic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes A^b, B^b, C^b, D^b, E^b, F^b, and G[#], and is notated using the key signature of A^b minor (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b, G^b, C^b, F^b), with the G[#] as an accidental.



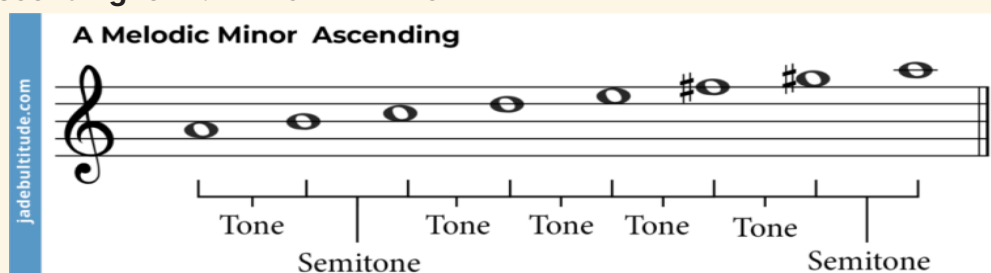
2.4. The Melodic Minor Scale

The melodic minor scale is a type of minor scale that sounds brighter than the natural minor scale. What makes it special is that it can change depending on whether the melody is going up or down.

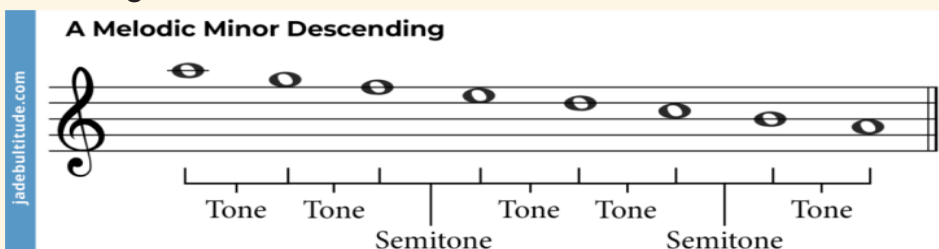
- ▶ When the scale goes up, it raises the 6th and 7th notes to make a smooth sound that leads nicely to the top note.
- ▶ When the scale comes back down in classical music, it uses the same notes as the natural minor scale.

Example of a Melodic Minor Scale

- **Ascending form:** A-B-C-D-E-F[#]-G[#]-A



- **Descending form:** A - G - F - E - D - C - B



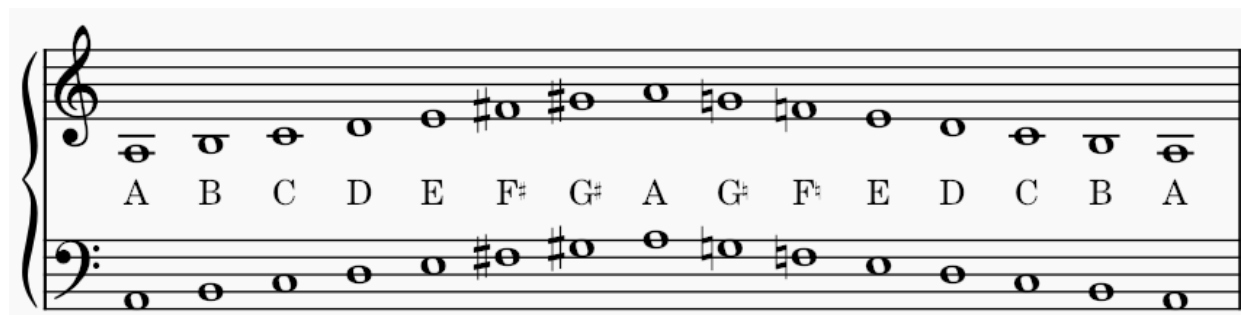
Note:

In jazz music, musicians usually keep the raised 6th and 7th notes going both up and down. Composers created this scale to make melodies sound better. In the natural minor scale, there is a big gap between the 7th note and the top note, which does not pull strongly enough. The melodic minor scale fixes this by raising those notes when going up, making the melody flow more smoothly while keeping that minor sound we

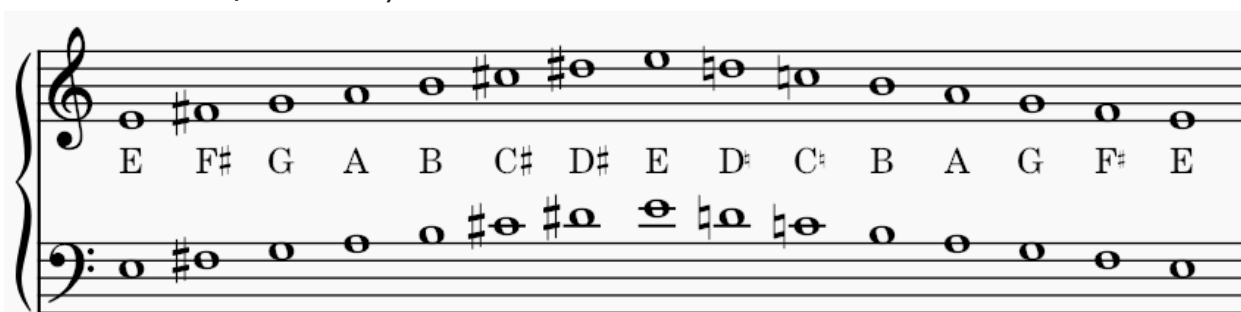
get from the lowered 3rd note.

A. Sharp melodic minor scales

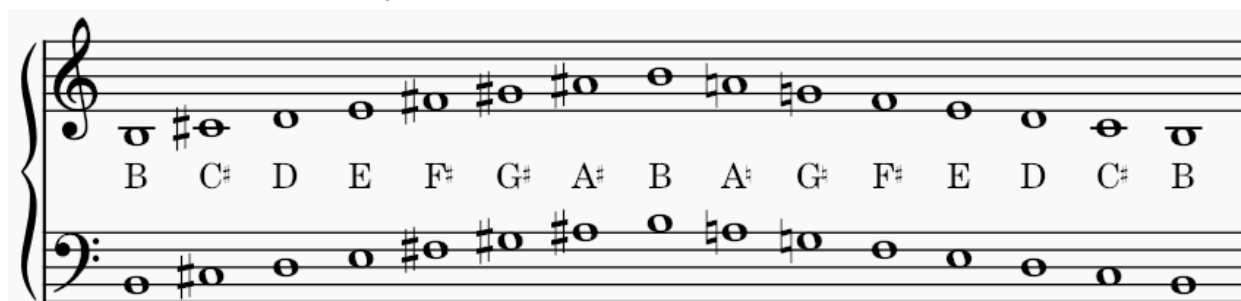
- ❖ **A Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes A, B, C, D, E, F[#], and G[#], and is notated using the key signature of A minor (none), with the F[#] and G[#] as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (G^b and F^b).



- ❖ **E Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes E, F[#], G, A, B, C[#], and D[#], and is notated using the key signature of E minor (F[#]), with the C[#] and D[#] as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (D^b and C^b).

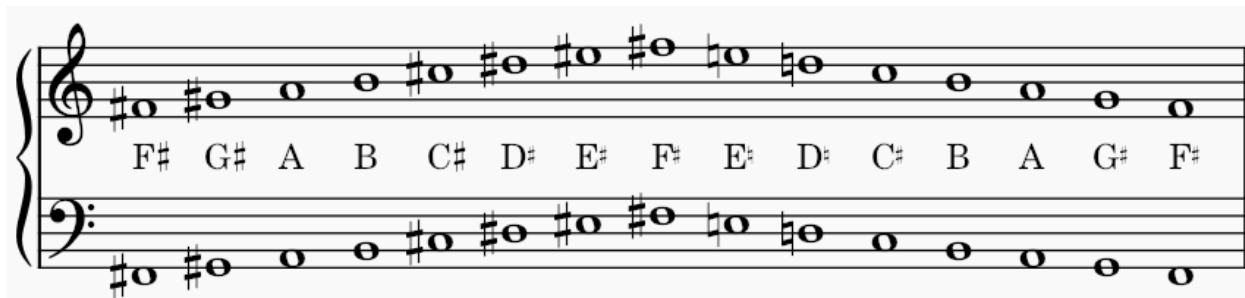


- ❖ **B Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes B, C[#], D, E, F[#], G[#], and A[#], and is notated using the key signature of B minor (F[#], C[#]), with the G[#] and A[#] as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (A^b and G^b).

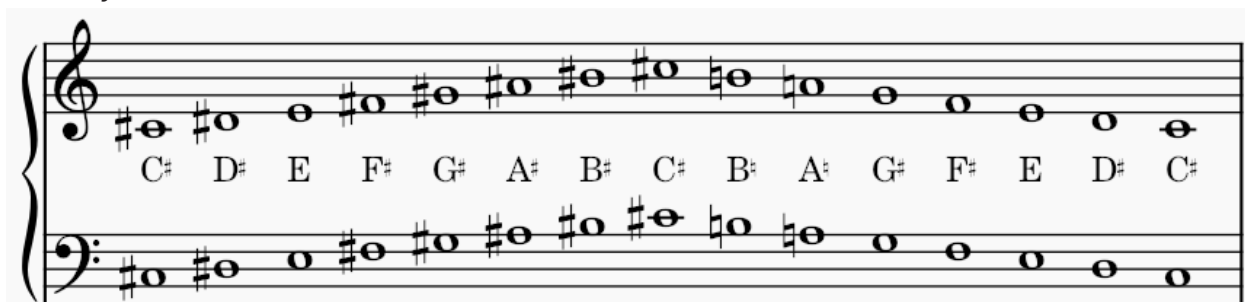


- ❖ **F[#] Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes F[#], G[#], A, B, C[#], D[#], and E[#], and is notated using the key signature of F minor (F[#], C[#], G[#]), with the D[#] and E[#] as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a

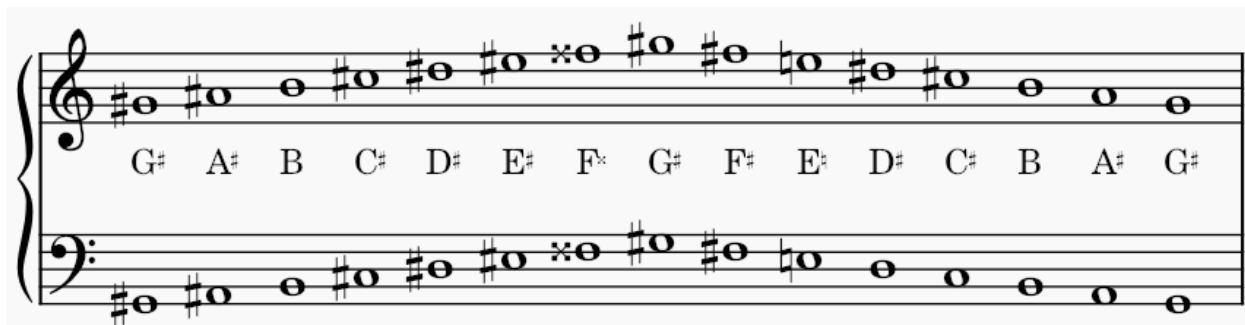
semitone (E $\flat$ and D $\flat$).



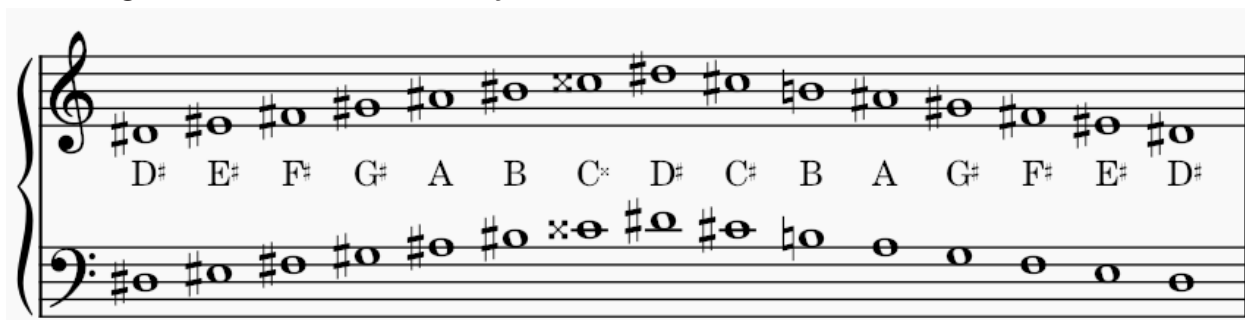
- ❖ **C# Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes C $\sharp$, D $\sharp$, E, F $\sharp$, G $\sharp$, A $\sharp$, and B $\sharp$, and is notated using the key signature of C $\sharp$ minor (F $\sharp$, C $\sharp$, G $\sharp$, D), with the A $\sharp$ and B $\sharp$ as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (B $\flat$ and A $\flat$).



- ❖ **G# Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes G $\sharp$, A $\sharp$, B, C $\sharp$, D $\sharp$, E $\sharp$, and F $\sharp\sharp$ (F double-sharp), and is notated using the key signature of G $\sharp$ minor (F $\sharp$, C $\sharp$, G $\sharp$, D $\sharp$, A $\sharp$), with the E $\sharp$ and F $\sharp\sharp$ as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (F $\sharp$ and E $\flat$).

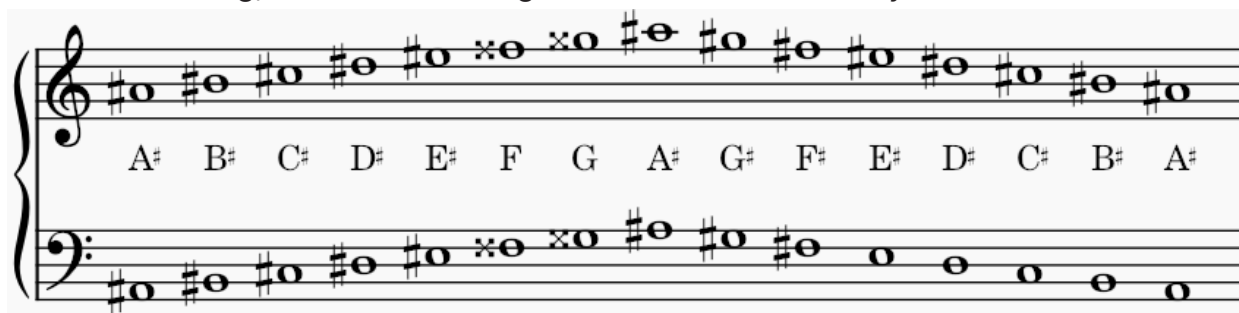


- ❖ **D# Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes D $\sharp$, E $\sharp$, F $\sharp$, G $\sharp$, A $\sharp$, B $\sharp$, and C $\sharp\sharp$ (C double-sharp), and is notated using the key signature of D $\sharp$ minor (F $\sharp$, C $\sharp$, G $\sharp$, D $\sharp$, A $\sharp$, E $\sharp$), with the B $\sharp$ and C $\sharp\sharp$ as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (C $\sharp$ and B $\flat$).



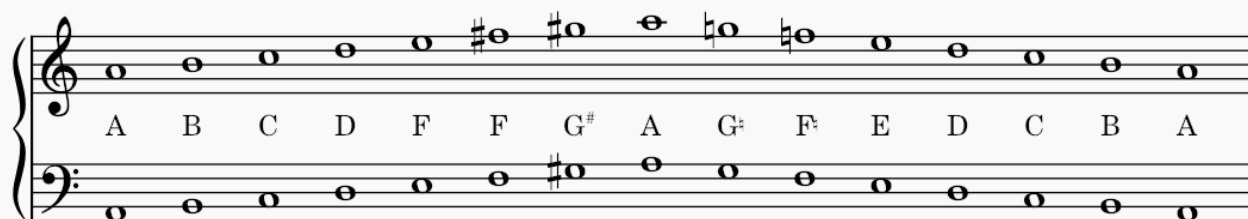
- ❖ **A# Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes A $\sharp$, B $\sharp$, C $\sharp$, D $\sharp$, E $\sharp$, F $\sharp\sharp$ (F

double-sharp), and G^{##} (G double-sharp), and is notated using the key signature of A[#] minor (F[#], C[#], G[#], D[#], A[#], E[#], B[#]), with the F^{##} and G^{##} as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (G[#] and F[#]).

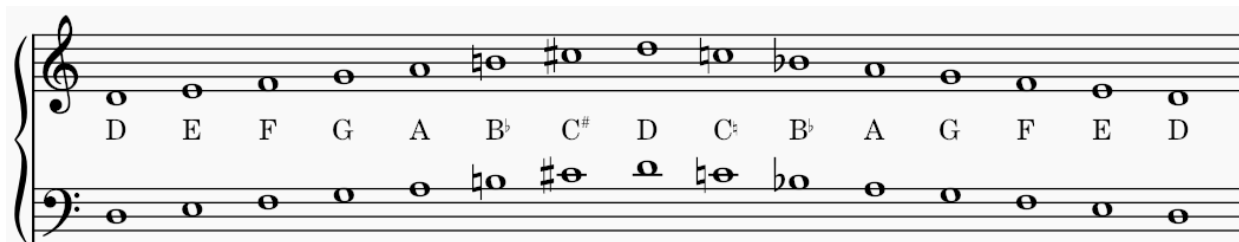


B. Melodic Minor Scales with Flats

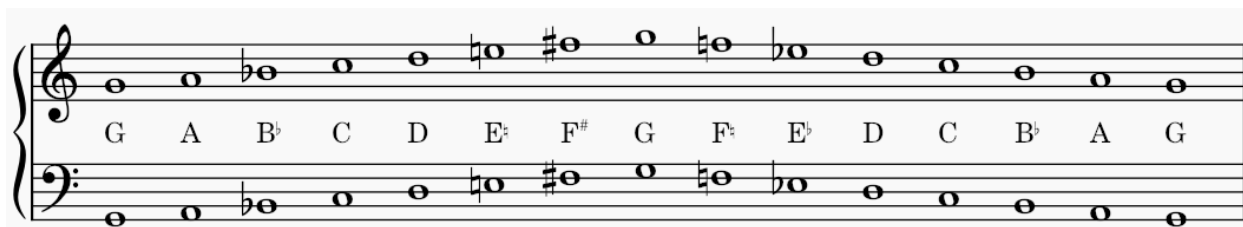
- ❖ **A Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes A, B, C, D, E, F[#], and G[#], and is notated using the key signature of A minor (none), with the F[#] and G[#] as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (G[♮] and F[♮]).



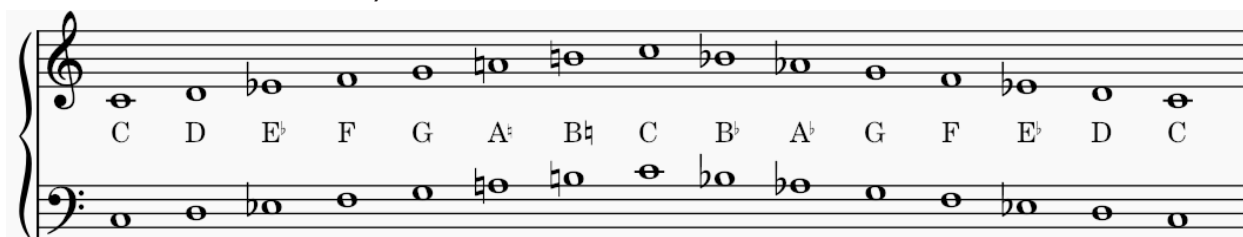
- ❖ **D Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes D, E, F, G, A, B, and C[#], and is notated using the key signature of D minor (B^b), with the B[♮] and C[#] as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (C[♮] and B^b).



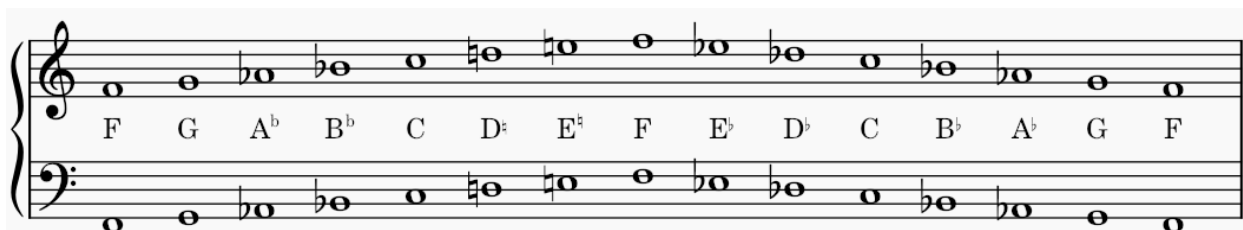
- ❖ **G Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes G, A, B^b, C, D, E, and F[#], and is notated using the key signature of G minor (B^b, E^b), with the E[♮] and F[#] as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (F[♮] and E^b).



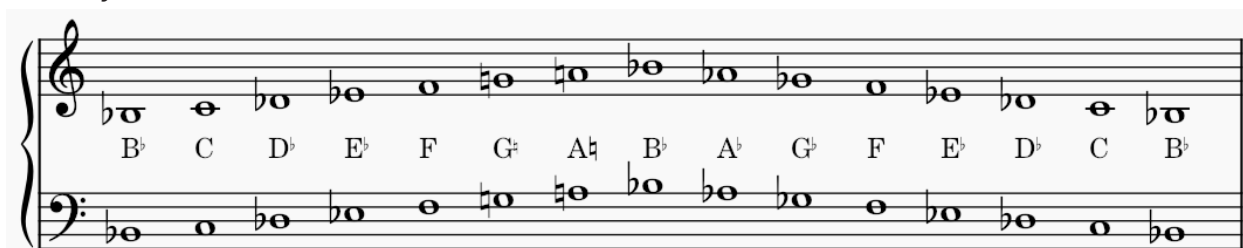
- ❖ **C Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes C, D, E^b, F, G, A, and B, and is notated using the key signature of C minor (B^b, E^b, A^b), with the A[#] and B[#] as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (B^b and A^b).



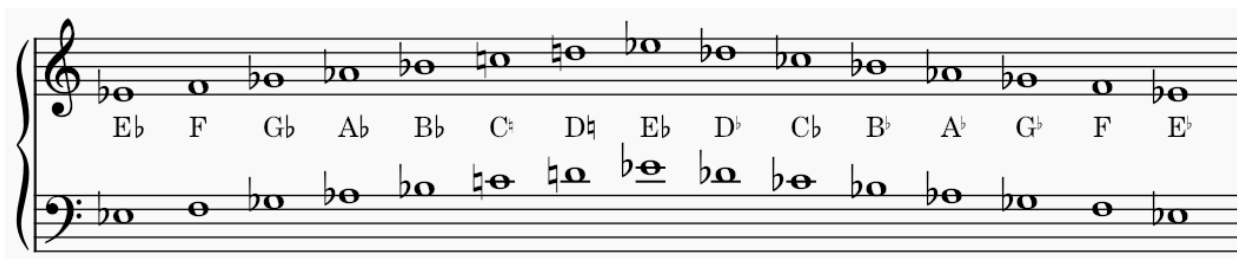
- ❖ **F Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes F, G, A^b, B^b, C, D, and E, and is notated using the key signature of F minor (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b), with the D[#] and E[#] as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (E^b and D^b).



- ❖ **B^b Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes B^b, C, D^b, E^b, F, G, and A, and is notated using the key signature of B^b minor (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b, G^b), with the G[#] and A[#] as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (A^b and G^b).



- ❖ **E^b Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes E^b, F, G^b, A^b, B^b, C, and D, and is notated using the key signature of E^b minor (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b, G^b, C^b), with the C[#] and D[#] as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (D^b and C^b).



- ❖ **A^b Melodic Minor:** The scale consists of the notes A^b, B^b, C^b, D^b, E^b, F, and G, and is notated using the key signature of A^b minor (B^b, E^b, A^b, D^b, G^b, C^b, F^b), with the F[♯] and G[♯] as accidentals. When descending, the 7th and 6th degrees are lowered each by a semitone (G^b and F^b).

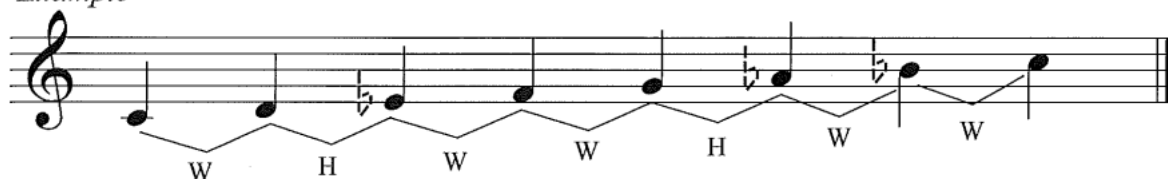




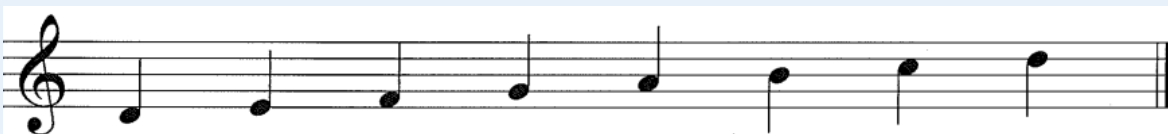
APPLICATION ACTIVITY 2.2

1. Starting from E, construct all three forms of the minor scale on a grand staff:
 - a. Natural minor
 - b. Harmonic minor
 - c. Melodic minor (Ascending and descending form)
2. Add sharps or flats to the exercises below to create Natural Minor scales. Use the pattern of whole and half steps to determine which accidentals you will need to add.

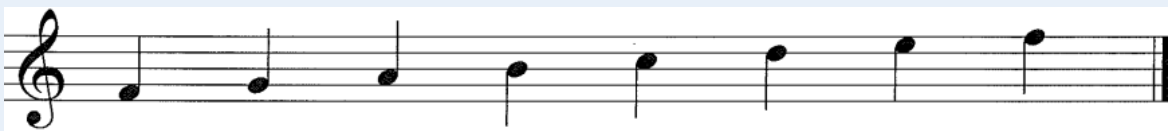
Example



a. D natural minor

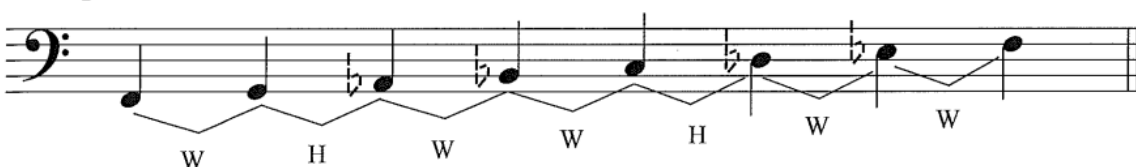


b. F natural minor

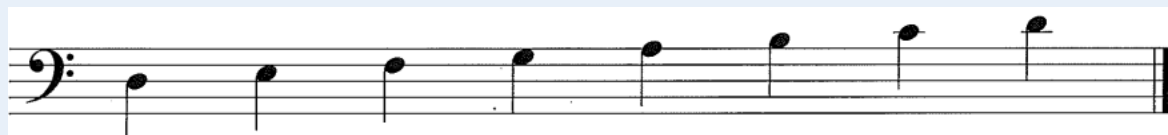


3. Add sharps or flats to the exercises below to create Natural Minor scales. Use the pattern of whole and half steps to determine which accidentals you will need to add.

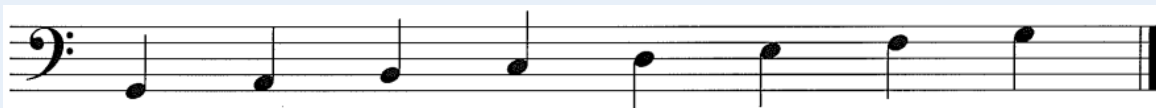
Example



a. D natural minor



b. G natural minor

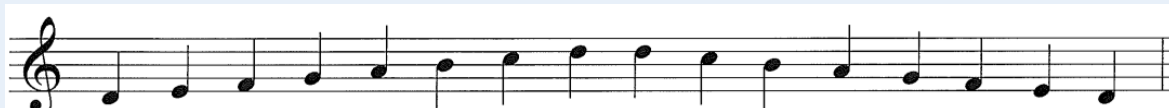


4. Add sharps or flats to the exercises below to create Melodic Minor scales. Use the pattern of whole and half steps to determine which accidentals you will need to add.

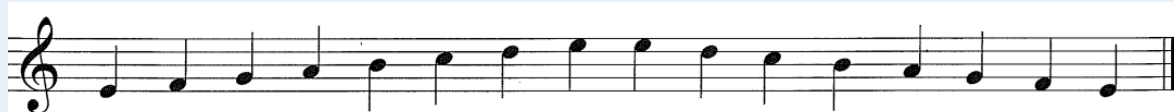
Example



a. D melodic minor



b. G melodic minor



5. Add sharps or flats to the exercises below to create Melodic Minor scales. Use the pattern of whole and half steps to determine which accidentals you will need to add.

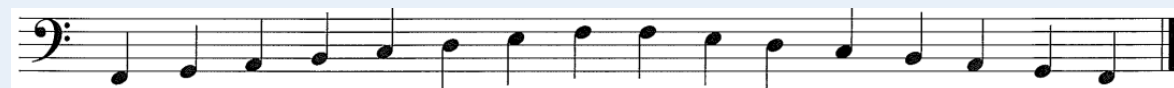
Example



a. A melodic minor

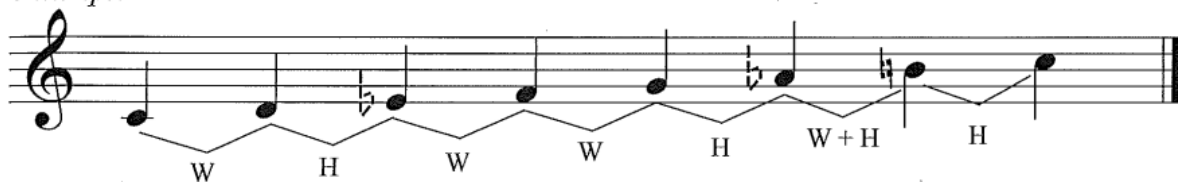


b. F melodic minor

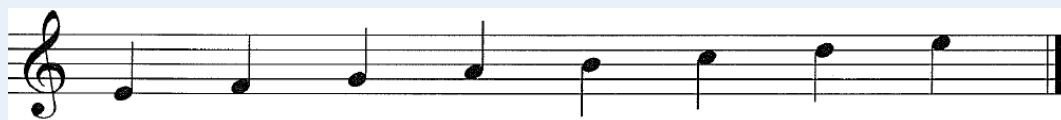


6. Add sharps or flats to the exercises below to create Harmonic Minor scales. Use the pattern of whole and half steps to determine which accidentals you will need to add.

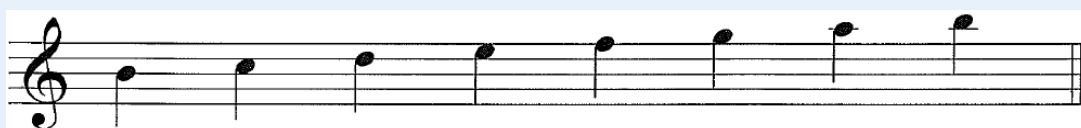
Example



a. E Harmonic minor

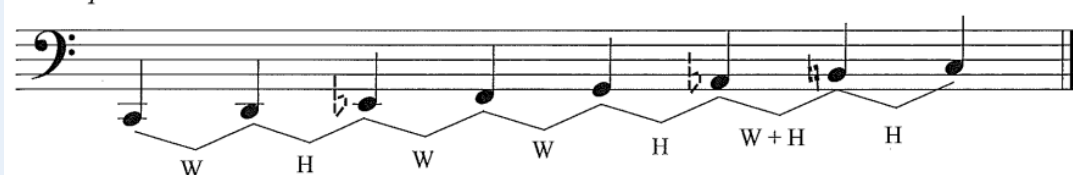


b. B Harmonic minor

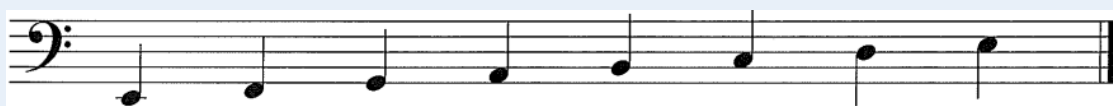


7. Add sharps or flats to the exercises below to create Harmonic Minor scales. Use the pattern of whole and half steps to determine which accidentals you will need to add.

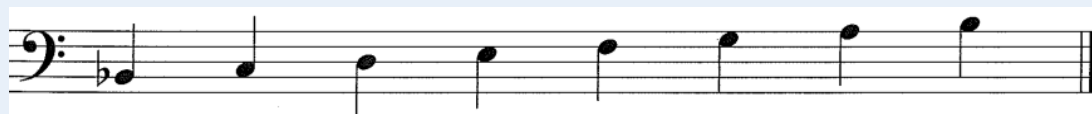
Example



a. E Harmonic minor

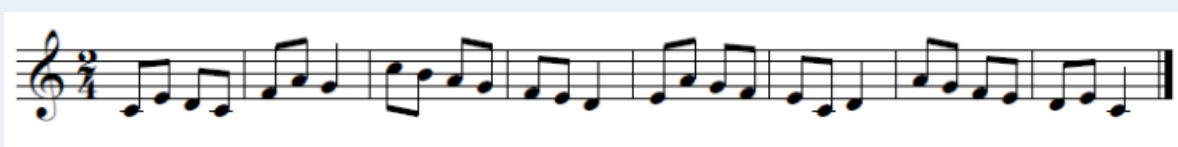


b. B-flat Harmonic minor



8. Practice the solfa of the following scores:

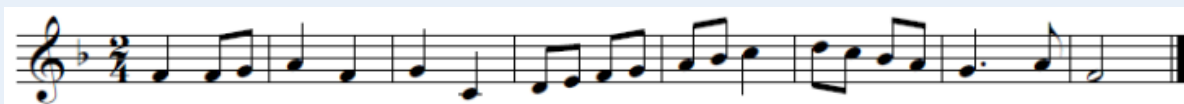
a.



b.



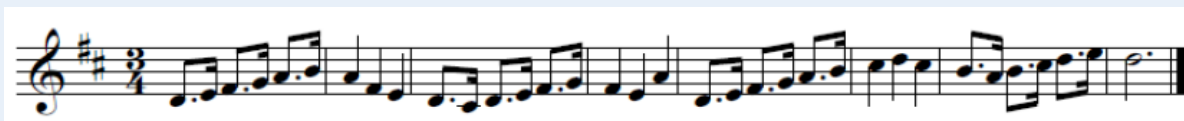
c.



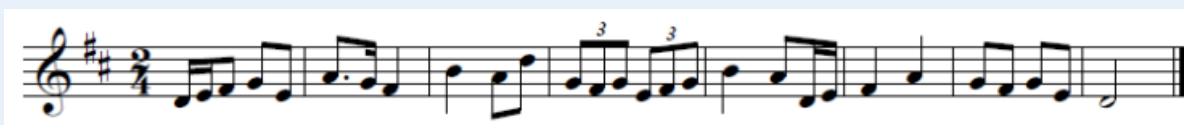
d.



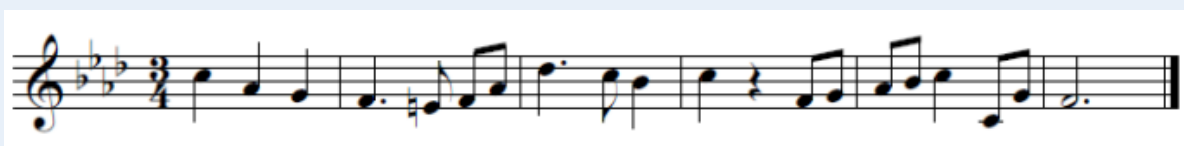
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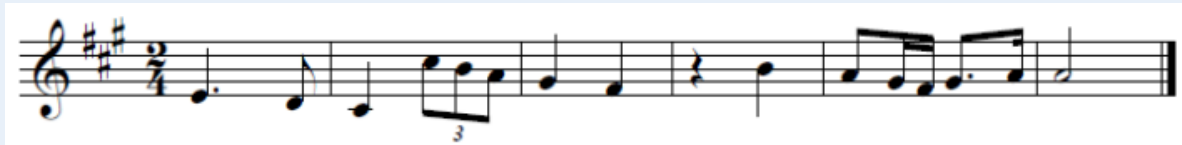
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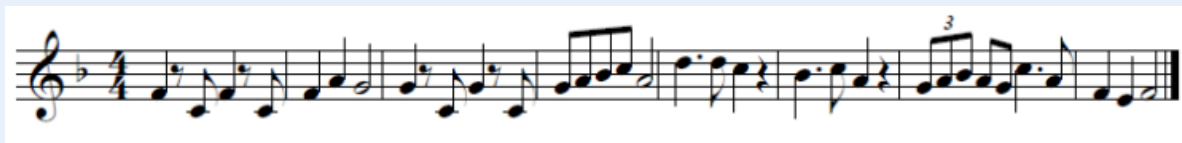
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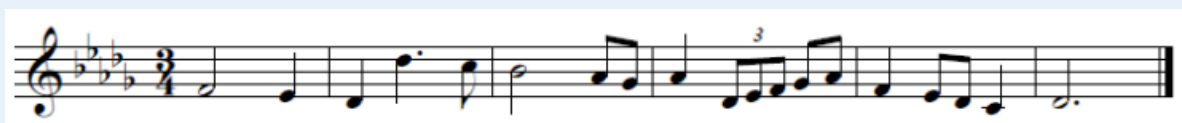
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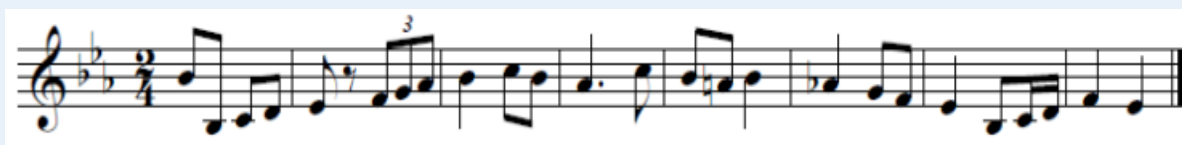
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k.



l.



m.

Turate Rwanda yacu



1. Tu - ra - te Rwa - nda ya - c'i - ta-ts'i-ne - ma, Rwa - nda ya-cu nzi-za
2. U - fi - t'i - bi - ru-nga nka Mu-ha-bu - ra, ni cyo gi - ku - ru mu
3. Twa - vu - gi - ki se ku ma - zi ma-ga - ri: nka Ki-vu na Mu-ha -
4. Ha - r'u-bwo se mwa-ge - ze mu mu-ke - nke, ngo mu-ro - r'i - mpa-ra



1. ga - ho - ra - n'i - shy'a, Gi - te - go cya - ta-tsw'u - bwi - za na Ru - re - ma,
2. bi - ru-nga by'i - no, Ni wo mu - na - ra w'u - ru Rwa-nda rwa - cu,
3. zi ya Bu-ga - nza? Bu - re - ra na Ru - ho - ndo by'i-Mu-re - ra,
4. n'i - mpa-ra - ge se? Ha - r'u-bwo se mwa-ge - ze mu ma-shya - mba,



1. ho - se ba-ra - gu - ha - ra - ni - ra.
2. a - h'u-ri ho - s'u-b'u - ki - te-ge-ye! R/ Rwa-nda nzi - za, ntute-ze ku-za - hi -
3. Cyo-ho-h'i-ne - te-sha Bu - ge-se-ra?
4. ngo mu-ro-r'i - ngwe n'u - ru - samagwe?



- nyu-ka mu ma-ha - nga, Rwa - nda nzi - za, a - ba-we ba-gu - ha - y'i - mpu-ndu!

Hymne à la nuit.

Édouard Sciortino (1893-1979)

Hippolyte et Aricie.

Jean-Philippe Rameau (1683-1764)

Soprano

Ô Nuit! Viens ap - por - - ter sur la ter - re le calme en - chan - te - ment de
Nuit! Ô laisse en - - core à la ter - re le calme en - chan - te - ment de

Alto

Ô Nuit! Viens ap - por - - ter sur la ter - re le calme en - chan - te - ment de
Nuit! Ô laisse en - - core à la ter - re le calme en - chan - te - ment de

Tenor

Ô Nuit! Viens ap - por - - ter sur la ter - re le calme en - chan - te - ment de
Nuit! Ô laisse en - - core à la ter - re le calme en - chan - te - ment de

Bass

Ô Nuit! Viens ap - por - - ter sur la ter - re le calme en - chan - te - ment de
Nuit! Ô laisse en - - core à la ter - re le calme en - chan - te - ment de

Piano

7

ton mys-tè - - re. l'om - bre qui t'es - corte est si dou - ce, si doux est le con - cert de tes
ton mys-tè - - re. L'om - bre qui t'es - corte est si dou - ce, Est - il u - ne beau - té aus-si

ton mys-tè - - re. l'om - bre qui t'es - corte est si dou - ce, si doux est le con - cert de tes
ton mys-tè - - re. L'om - bre qui t'es - corte est si dou - ce, Est - il u - ne beau - té aus-si

ton mys-tè - - re. l'om - bre qui t'es - corte est si dou - ce, si doux est le con - cert de tes
ton mys-tè - - re. L'om - bre qui t'es - corte est si dou - ce, Est - il u - ne beau - té aus-si

ton mys-tè - - re.
ton mys-tè - - re.

2.2. Minor key signatures



Learning activity 2.2

In groups of four, work as music detectives to crack the code for minor key signatures.

1. Look at the following scales below:

E minor scale: E -F[#]- G- A- B- C- D- E

B minor scale: B- C[#]- D- E- F[#]- G- A- B

Figure out the major key that uses the same sharps as these minor scales?

Hint: Think of key a half step above the last key with sharp.

2. Look at the following scales:

D minor scale: D- E- F- G- A- B^b- C- D

G minor scale: G-A- B^b- C- D- E^b- F- G.

Figure out the major key that uses the same sharps as these minor scales?

Hint: Think of the last but one last key with a flat.

2.2.1. Sharp key signatures

A key signature is a set of sharp ([#]) or flat (^b) symbols placed at the beginning of each staff line, immediately after the clef. Key signatures with sharps indicate which notes should be raised by a semitone throughout the piece unless otherwise specified by accidentals. Sharp key signatures range from one sharp to seven sharps. Each additional sharp follows a specific order, known as the order of sharps: F[#] – C[#] – G[#] – D[#] – A[#] – E[#] – B[#].

Memory Aid: The mnemonic “**F**ather **C**harles **G**oes **D**own **A**nd **E**nds **B**attle” helps recall the order of sharps.

Sharp Key Signatures

Number of Sharps	Sharps in Order	Minor Key
1 sharp	F [#]	E minor
2 sharps	F [#] , C [#]	B minor
3 sharps	F [#] , C [#] , G [#]	F [#] minor
4 sharps	F [#] , C [#] , G [#] , D [#]	C [#] minor
5 sharps	F [#] , C [#] , G [#] , D [#] , A [#]	G [#] minor

6 sharps	F [#] , C [#] , G [#] , D [#] , A [#] , E [#]	D [#] minor
7 sharps	F [#] , C [#] , G [#] , D [#] , A [#] , E [#] , B [#]	A [#] minor

2.2.2. Flat Key signatures

Key signatures with flats indicate which notes should be lowered by a semitone throughout the piece. Flat key signatures range from one flat to seven flats. Each additional flat follows the order of flats:

B^b-E^bA-D-G^b-C^b-F^b. The mnemonic **"Battle Ends And Down Goes Charles' Father"** helps recall the order of flats. Notice this is the reverse of the order of sharps.

Flat Key Signatures

Number of Flats	Flats in Order	Minor Key
1 flat	B ^b	D minor
2 flats	B ^b , E ^b	G minor
3 flats	B ^b , E ^b , A ^b	C minor
4 flats	B ^b , E ^b , A ^b , D ^b	F minor
5 flats	B ^b , E ^b , A ^b , D ^b , G ^b	B ^b minor
6 flats	B ^b , E ^b , A ^b , D ^b , G ^b , C ^b	E ^b minor
7 flats	B ^b , E ^b , A ^b , D ^b , G ^b , C ^b , F ^b	A ^b minor

2.2.3. Key Signatures and corresponding Natural Minor Scales

A. Sharp Key signatures and corresponding natural minor scales

Each key signature corresponds to a specific natural minor scale. The key signature indicates which notes are automatically sharpened or flattened to maintain the natural minor scale pattern (T-S-T-T-S-T-T). Instead of writing sharp or flat symbols before every note throughout a piece, the key signature places them at the beginning of each staff line. This makes music easier to read and write.

Note: The minor key is two semitones (a whole step) above the last sharp in the key signature.

Example 2: B Minor

The B natural minor scale (B-C[#]-D-E-F[#]-G-A-B) requires F[#] and C[#] to maintain the W-H-W-W-H-W-W pattern. The key signature for B minor therefore shows two sharps (F[#] and C[#]) at the beginning of the staff, which means every F and C in the piece is automatically played as F[#] and C[#] unless a natural sign (♮) appears.

B. Flat Key signatures and corresponding natural minor scales

Each key signature corresponds to a specific natural minor scale. The key signature indicates which notes are automatically sharpened or flattened to maintain the natural minor scale pattern (W-H-W-W-H-W-W). Instead of writing sharp or flat symbols before every note throughout a piece, the key signature places them at the beginning of each staff line. This makes music easier to read and write.

Note: The minor key is the fourth flat (counting from the beginning) in the key signature. However, D minor (with one flat) is an exception and must be memorized.

Example 1: D Minor (Special CWase)

The D natural minor scale (D-E-F-G-A-B^b-C-D) requires B^b to maintain the W-H-W-W-H-W-W pattern. The key signature for D minor therefore shows one flat (B^b) at the beginning of the staff, which means every B in the piece is automatically played as B^b unless a natural sign (#) appears. Since there is only one flat, there is no fourth flat to identify, so D minor must be memorized as the key with one flat.

Example 2: G

The G natural minor scale (G-A-B^b-C-D-E^b-F-G) requires B^b and E^b to maintain the W-H-W-W-H-W-W pattern. The key signature for G minor therefore shows two flats (B^b and E^b) at the beginning of the staff, which means every B and E in the piece is automatically played as B^b and E^b unless a natural sign (#) appears.



APPLICATION ACTIVITY 2.2

1. List the complete order of sharps and the complete order of flats used in key signatures.
2. Explain why musicians use key signatures instead of writing sharps or flats before every note in a piece.
3. What is the rule for finding?
 - a. The minor key from sharp key signatures?
 - b. The minor key from flat key signatures?
4. Specify the minor key for each key signature given.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

8 9 10 11 12 13 14

5. Write the minor key signature and specified minor scale in each example.

				
1. D minor	2. F [#] minor	3. F minor	4. D [#] minor	5. A ^b minor
				
6. B minor	7. C minor	8. G [#] minor	9. B ^b minor	10. E minor

6. Specify the key from the scale degree name.

- Minor: A[#] is the mediant
- minor: D[#] is the subtonic
- Major: B is the dominant
- Major: C is the submediant
- minor: D[#] is the subdominant
- Major: B[#] is the leading tone
- minor: E[#] is the supertonic

2.2.4. Relative keys and cycle of fifths



Learning activity 2.3

You have learned the major scales and their key signatures. You have also learned the minor scales and their key signatures. Now, let's connect these two areas of knowledge by identifying major and minor relatives through the following activity:

- Look at the key signature with 1 sharp (F[#]).
 - Which major key uses this signature?
 - Build the scale starting 3 semitones below G, using only the notes allowed by this accidental (F[#]).
 - Play both scales on piano and note any similarity and difference noticed.
- Look at the key signature with 2 flats (B^b, E^b).
 - Which major key uses this signature?
 - Build the scale starting 3 semitones below B^b, using only the notes allowed by these accidentals (B^b, E^b).
 - Play both scales on piano and note any similarity and difference noticed.

Method 1: Count down three semitones from the major key.

- **Example 1:** The note that is 3 semitones down C is A. So the relative minor key of C Major is A minor.
- **Example 2:** The note that is 3 semitones down G is E. So the relative minor key of G Major is E minor.

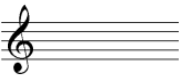
Method 2: Find the 6th degree of the major scale.

- **Example 1:** The 6th degree of C major scale is A. So, the relative minor of C Major is A minor.
- **Example 2:** The 6th degree of G major scale is E. So, the relative minor of G Major is E minor.

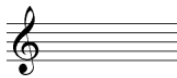
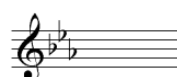
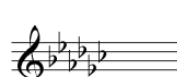
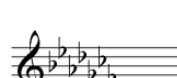
Below is a summary of all the major keys and their relative minor keys, including sharp keys and flat keys.

Major and Relative Minor Key Signature Chart

KEY SIGNATURES – Sharp keys

C Major / A minor	
G Major / E minor	
D Major / B minor	
A Major / F# minor	
E Major / C# minor	
B Major / G# minor	
F# Major / D# minor	
C# Major / A# minor	

KEY SIGNATURES – Flat keys

C Major / A minor	
F Major / D minor	
Bb Major / G minor	
Eb Major / C minor	
Ab Major / F minor	
Db Major / Bb minor	
Gb Major / Eb minor	
Cb Major / Bb minor	



APPLICATION ACTIVITY 2.3

- For each major key below, identify its relative minor key.
 - F Major (1 flat)
 - B^b Major (2 flats)
 - A Major (3 sharps)
- For each minor key below, identify its relative major key and write its key signature.
 - G[#] Minor
 - F Minor
 - B Minor
- MUGENZI argue that the key signature of four flats (B^b, E^b, A^b, and D^b) represent A^b Major while INEZA says that it represents either A^b Major or F Minor. Who is right? Justify your answer.
- Perform the following solfa exercises:
 - Ding dong merrily on high

Ding Dong Merrily On High

B. Alleluia sing to Jesus (Credits: Words: William Chatterton Dix, 1867. Music: HyFrydol Rowland H. Prichard, 1830)



1. Al - le - lu - ia! sing to Je - sus! His the scep - ter, His the throne.
 2. Al - le - lu - ia! not as or - phans are we left in sor - row now;
 3. Al - le - lu - ia! bread of an - gels, Thou on earth our food, our stay;
 4. Al - le - lu - ia! King e - ter - nal, Thee the Lord of lords we own;

Al - le - lu - ia! His the tri - umph, His the vic - to - ry a - lone.
 Al - le - lu - ia! He is near us, faith be - lieves, nor ques - tions how;
 Al - le - lu - ia! here the sin - ful flee to Thee from day to day;
 Al - le - lu - ia! born of Mar - y, Earth Thy foot - stool, Hea - ven Thy throne:

Hark! the songs of peace - ful Zi - on thun - der like a might - y flood.
 Though the cloud from sight re - ceived Him when the for - ty days were o'er
 Int - er - ces - sor, Friend of sin - ners, Earth's Re - deem - er, plead for me,
 Thou with - in the veil hast en - tered, robed in flesh our great High Priest;

Je - sus out of ev - ery na - tion has re - deemed us by His blood.
 Shall our hearts for - get His pro - mise, "I am with you ev - er - more"?
 Where the songs of all the sin - less sweep ac - ross the crys - tal sea.
 Thou on earth both priest and vic - tim in the Eu - char - ist - ic feast.

C. Children at the heart of Peace and security

When children speak, the world must listen. This anthem amplifies the voices of children trapped in war zones. Prevention is possible, and it starts now. Rooted in the Dallaire Institute for Children, Peace and Security's vision, the song transforms child protection principles into urgent action. Rwanda's children bring this global movement home, pledging commitment to peace education and resilience against online radicalization. This song is more than music. It is a blueprint for change.

INTRO

We, the children on Earth, need care and joy
Let us play, learn, and dream, not hold weapons.
Together, we can build a safer world.
Our future depends on your actions now.

VERSE 1

War inflicts deep wounds upon the children.
No child should ever be used in fighting.
Let us stop violence before it starts here.
Keep families united, safe, and whole.

PRE-CHORUS

No child should carry messages of war.
Let us watch for risks early and with care.
Prevention brings peace to every child.
Together we can shield them from all harm.

CHORUS

Peace is possible for every child, everywhere,
Violence can be prevented when we act together,
A better world begins with making children safe,
Children must always be at the heart of peace and security.

VERSE 2

End the recruitment and use of children
in armed conflict and violence right now
Protect their freedom and uphold
their rights every single day in every place.
Children are never spies in any conflict.
Protect every child from dangerous roles.
Report all threats quickly to keep us safe now.
Vigilance can save our lives and our future.

PRE-CHORUS

No child should ever serve as porters in war.
Plan and act early to prevent recruitment.
We belong to schools and homes, not war zones.
Show care, keep us safe and free from any harm.

CHORUS

Peace is possible for every child, everywhere,
Violence can be prevented when we act together,
A better world begins with making children safe,
Children must always be at the heart of peace and security.

BRIDGE

No child should suffer sexual violence
in armed conflict or in violent zones.
Bring us home with love to help them heal, grow strong.
with dignity and all the care we need.
No forced marriages for any child.
Listen to our voices, hear our pain, our fears.
Guide us through the healing with gentle care.
Restore our hope and help us dream again.
Children are never bodyguards for leaders
of armed groups in conflict anywhere at all.
We deserve safety, our rights, and a bright future
free from exploitation, harm, and fear.

FINAL CHORUS

Peace is possible for every child, everywhere,
Violence can be prevented when we act together,
A better world begins with making children safe,
Children must always be at the heart of peace and security.

OUTRO

We, children of Rwanda choose peace every day,
We say no to guns and to war in every way,
We learn, we play, we grow, keep hope strong together,
We avoid harmful ideas and resist tricks online
Hate speech on social media will not lead us astray.
No child on the frontlines, no human shields.
End war and violence in every place.
So every child can grow up safe in peace.
Protected, valued, free to live and thrive.

(The music score is near completion)

2.4. Parallel Scales and Relative Scales



Learning activity 2.4

In groups of four attempt the following activities:

1. Activity 1

- Write the C Major scale on a treble staff.
- Write the C natural minor scale on a treble staff.

2. Activity 2

- Write the G Major scale on a treble staff.
- Write the G natural minor scale on a treble staff.

3. Activity 3

- Identify the relationship in each pair of scales in both activities.
- Formulate the rule for converting a major scale to its parallel natural minor.

4. Activity 4

- Write the C Major Scale and E minor scale
- What are the differences and similarities do you observe in those two scales?

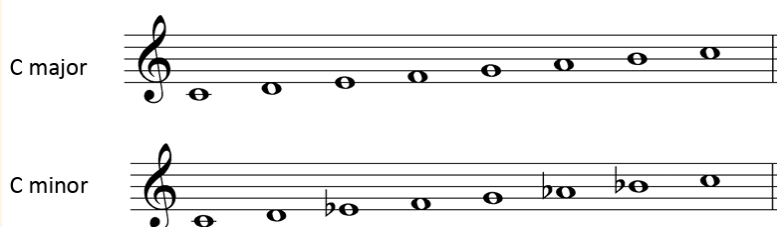


1. Parallel Scales

Each Major Scale has a corresponding minor scale which begins by the same tonic note, but they differ by the series of tones and semitones. Those are called parallel scale.

Example (C):

- C Major Scale: C – D – E – F – G – A – B – C
- C minor (natural): C – D – E $\flat$ – F – G – A $\flat$ – B $\flat$ – C



2. Relative scales

Relative scales share the same notes but have different tonics. As we learned in previous lessons, you can find the relative minor by counting down a minor third from the tonic of the major scale. For this reason, even though their tone patterns differ, relative scales always share the same accidentals.

Example:

- **C major:** C – D – E – F – G – A – B
- **A minor:** A – B – C – D – E – F – G

Same pitch collection, different "center of gravity."

Your ear hears a different key because a different note feels like "home."

Classic relatives:

- G major ↔ E minor
- E $\flat$ major ↔ C minor



APPLICATION ACTIVITY 2.4

1. Reading Activity

- Write A major scale and A natural minor scale on a treble clef.
- Which notes are different in both scales?

2. Listening Activity

Listen to the songs at the following YouTube links:

- "Chiquitita" by ABBA: https://youtu.be/p9Y3N_2xUsw?si=zveUuvdUBBfMVmeP
 - "Tajabone" by Ismaël Lô: <https://youtu.be/jo7TdbR18xQ?si=EYQnN7Y2aqcOMgxX>
- Which song is in a major scale and which one is in a minor scale.
 - Use the word couples "*bright and joyful, dark and melancholic*" to describe the feeling you had while listening to each song.

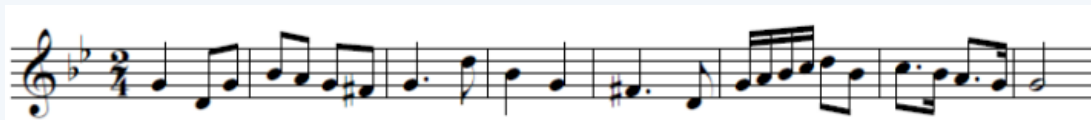


END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

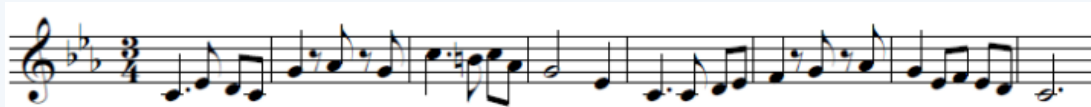
- What is the interval pattern (in tones and semitones) for a natural minor scale?
- What specific alteration is made to the natural minor scale to create the harmonic minor form?
- How is a natural minor scale related to its relative major scale?
- Construct the E natural minor scale, starting from the given tonic note E.
- Construct the C natural minor scale, starting from C major scale.
- Transform D natural minor (D-E-F-G-A-B^b-C-D) into D harmonic minor by making the appropriate alteration.
- Compare the interval structure of C major (T-T-S-T-T-T-S) with its relative minor, A natural minor. What specific interval changes create the "minor" sound?
- Compose a 4-bar melody that clearly establishes the tonality of G natural minor. Use at least 4 different pitches from the scale.
- Compose an 8-note melody that demonstrates the characteristic sound of the melodic minor scale by using both the raised 6th and 7th degrees in an ascending context.
- Solfa the following pieces

11.

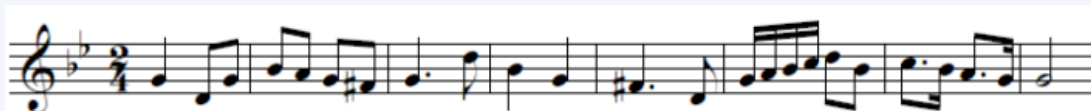
a.



b.



c.



LESSON 1:
MAJOR SCALES
AND MAJOR KEY
SIGNATURE

LESSON 2:
MINOR SCALES
AND MINOR KEY
SIGNATURES

LESSON 3:
PENTATONIC
SCALES

LESSON 4:
PERFORMING
SKETCHES IN
ENGLISH OR
FRENCH

LESSON 5:
MELODY AND
HARMONY

UNIT 3:

PENTATONIC SCALES

Key Unit Competence:

At the end of this unit, students will be able to perform musical compositions in major and minor pentatonic scales.

Domain Expected Learning Outcomes

Knowledge	Skills	Attitudes and Values
Describe the structure of pentatonic scales.	Use pentatonic scale notes correctly on the musical staff and on musical instruments.	Appreciate the use of pentatonic scales in Rwandan traditional music and other world traditions.
Explain the interval patterns of major and minor pentatonic scales.	Construct major pentatonic scales starting from any tonic note. Construct minor pentatonic scales starting from any tonic note.	Demonstrate confidence as a result of music performance.
Compare the interval structures and tonal qualities of major and minor pentatonic scales.	Distinguish major and minor pentatonic scales by vision and audition.	Show happiness and cooperation when singing and performing with others.

Explain the transposition of pentatonic scales into different keys.	Accompany a pentatonic melody using piano, recorder, or voice. Transpose a simple pentatonic melody from one key to another.	Strive for accuracy and success when writing and performing scales.
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Introduction

Pentatonic scales, which consist of five notes, are found in musical traditions around the world, including Chinese, Japanese, Scottish, African, blues, jazz, rock, and pop music. They play a central role in many traditional African styles, particularly in Rwanda, where they are deeply embedded in Intore songs and genres such as ibyivugo, amahamba, and ibihozo. These musical forms are often performed a cappella or accompanied by traditional instruments like the Inanga, Umuduri, Ikembe, and Amadinda. By avoiding semitones, pentatonic scales produce smooth, consonant harmonies, which makes them especially suitable for melodic expression and improvisation, particularly in solo performances.

In this unit, you will explore major and minor pentatonic scales through singing, playing, listening, and composing, while discovering meaningful connections between Rwandan music and musical traditions from around the world.

Key Words: Pentatonic scale, major pentatonic, minor pentatonic, interval pattern, traditional music.



Introductory activity 3.1

In groups of 3-5, Listen to "Nyirabisabo", one of Sebatunzi Joseph's masterpieces. You can find the YouTube link below: https://youtu.be/XEpllwOc42Q?si=42_8AltHYZCZBlp8

- Identify the key in which Nyirabisabo is written as major or minor.
 - Which degrees are not there in the scale Nyirabisabo is in?
 - Identify the interval pattern in the 5-note scale.
- In small groups of 3-5, Listen to the song "Mbega ngo biraha byiza" one of the folks Rwandan songs by Mgr Dominique Ngirabanyiginya on <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V2y84W0DBGc>, solfa it on the score below and answer questions:



- Sing the song in your group.
- List down all notes in this piece of music starting from the lowest.
- Using whole notes in a music staff, write down from the lowest to the highest and tell how many they are.

3.1. Major Pentatonic Scale and Minor Pentatonic Scale



Learning activity 3.1

1. Consider an excerpt of the song Nyirabisabo by Sebatunzi, as shown on the staff below:
 - a. Identify music notes comprised in the song.
 - b. Write the order of music notes you notice starting from the lowest.
 - c. How many notes are remaining so that the key of G is complete. What is your impression?



2. What is the name of a scale made only by five music notes?
3. Play the C Major scale ascending and descending on your keyboard:
C – D – E – F – G – A – B – C
 - a. Remove the upper note of each semitone interval you identified.
 - b. What is the new interval pattern you get?
4. Play the A Natural Minor scale ascending and descending on your keyboard:
A – B – C – D – E – F – G – A
 - a. Remove the upper note of each semitone interval you identified.
 - b. What is the new interval pattern you get?

3.1.1. Concept of Pentatonic scale

Pentatonic scales are five-note musical scales used widely across various traditions and genres. They offer a unique melodic and harmonic character that differs from the more common seven-note diatonic scales. Understanding pentatonic scales is essential for musicians, as they provide a foundation for exploring diverse musical styles and improvisational techniques.

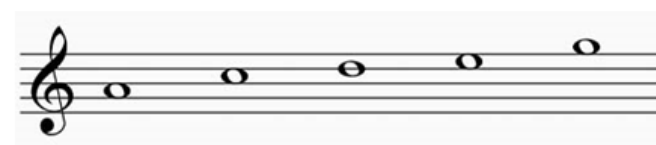
Pentatonic scales have been prevalent in folk music traditions worldwide, including African, Asian, and Native American cultures. These scales often serve as the basis for traditional melodies, chants, and instrumental pieces. The simplicity and adaptability of pentatonic scales make them well-suited for oral transmission and improvisation within folk music contexts. Evidence of pentatonic scales can be traced back to ancient civilizations, such as those in China, Greece, and Mesopotamia. Ancient instruments, such as the Chinese guqin, the Greek lyre, the Ugandan Amadinda, the Cameroonian Balafon and the Rwandan Inanga and Ikembe were often tuned in the pentatonic scales. The use of pentatonic scales in ancient cultures suggests their deep-rooted significance in human musical expression and cultural heritage.

3.1.2 Types of pentatonic scales

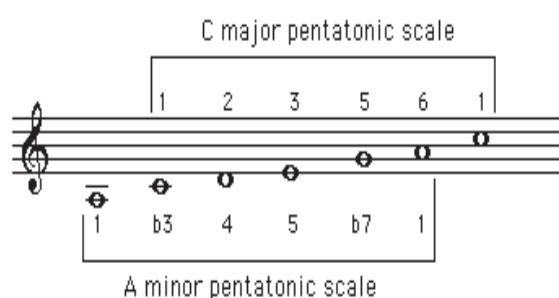
The **major pentatonic scale** is created by **removing the fourth and seventh notes from a major scale**, leaving only the first, second, third, fifth, and sixth notes. For example, in C major, this results in the notes C, D, E, G, and A. Its interval pattern follows a sequence of whole step, whole step, minor third, whole step, and minor third, giving it a bright and uplifting sound often used in pop, folk, and rock music.



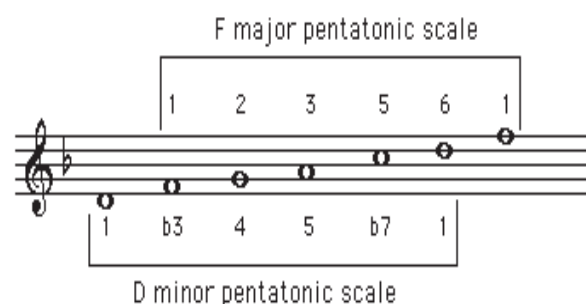
The **minor pentatonic scale** is formed by **removing the second and sixth notes from a natural minor scale**, keeping the first, lowered third, fourth, fifth, and lowered seventh notes. In A minor, the notes are A, C, D, E, and G. The scale follows a pattern of minor third, whole step, whole step, minor third, and whole step, producing a soulful, bluesy character ideal for rock, blues, and jazz improvisation.



The minor pentatonic scale uses the same notes as the major pentatonic scale but has a different tonic note. The C major pentatonic becomes the A minor pentatonic, simply by starting the scale on the A instead of on the C.



Likewise, by starting the F major pentatonic scale on the note **D** it becomes the D minor pentatonic scale.



Ba-ntu mwe-se du-ku-nd'u-mu-ri-mo,
 ni-yo nzi-ra nzi-za y'a-ma-jya-mbe-re, tu-
 ra-ngwe n'u-mwe-te n'u-bu-fa-ta-nye mu-ri-byo-se, tu
 gi-r'e-jo ha-za-za ha-be-re-y'u Rwa-nda.

- Unlike the natural minor scale, there are no half steps, just two gaps (minor 3rds) where notes are missing.

3.2.1. Sharp relative major & minor pentatonic scales

Example :

- **G Major Pentatonic** (1 sharp: F#): G - A - B - D - E
E Minor Pentatonic (Relative): E - G - A - B - D
- **D Major Pentatonic** (2 sharps: F#, C#): D - E - F# - A - B
B Minor Pentatonic (relative): B - D - E - F# - A

Key Point: To find the relative minor pentatonic from a major pentatonic, start on the 6th note. To find the relative major from a minor pentatonic, start on the 3rd note.

The image displays 12 pentatonic scales arranged in two columns. The left column contains major scales: F# Major, B Major, E Major, A Major, D Major, and G Major. The right column contains their relative minor scales: D# Minor, G# Minor, C# Minor, F# Minor, B Minor, and E Minor. Each scale is written on a treble clef staff with five notes and fingerings 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 1.

3.2.2. Flat relative major & minor pentatonic scales

Flat relative major and minor pentatonic scales share the same notes (which include flats) but start on different pitches. The relative minor pentatonic begins on the 6th degree of its major counterpart.

Example :

- **F Major Pentatonic** (1 flat: B^b): F - G - A - C - D
D Minor Pentatonic (relative): D - F - G - A - C
- **B^b Major Pentatonic** (2 flats: B^b, E^b): B^b - C - D - F - G
G Minor Pentatonic (relative): G - B^b - C - D - F

Key Point: To find the relative minor pentatonic from a major pentatonic, start on the 6th note. To find the relative major from a minor pentatonic, start on the 3rd note.



Learning activity 3.2

Observe the following relative pentatonic scales, sing and memorize them



END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

Answer the following questions:

1. Do you think the song "Mbega ngo biraba byiza" uses pentatonic scale? If yes, why?
2. What is a pentatonic scale?
3. How do we construct a pentatonic scale?
4. Do you think the song "Mbega ngo biraba byiza" uses major pentatonic scale? Why?
5. Explain how a major pentatonic scale is formed from a major scale.
6. Write a major pentatonic scale starting on D on the musical staff.
7. Distinguish a major pentatonic scale from a minor pentatonic scale by listening.
8. Justify the importance of pentatonic scales in Rwandan traditional music.
9. Perform or compose a short pentatonic melody using voice or an instrument.

LESSON 1:
MAJOR SCALES
AND MAJOR KEY
SIGNATURE

LESSON 2:
MINOR SCALES
AND MINOR KEY
SIGNATURES

LESSON 3:
PENTATONIC
SCALES

LESSON 4:
PERFORMING
SKETCHES IN
ENGLISH OR
FRENCH

LESSON 5:
MELODY AND
HARMONY

UNIT 4:

PERFORMING SKETCHES IN ENGLISH FOR FRENCH

Key unit competence:

At the end of this unit, students will be able to perform sketches in English or French.

Domain expected learning outcomes

Knowledge	Skills	Attitudes and Values
Describe characters and dialogue that convey emotions, ideas, and social messages.	Create a short sketch script in English or French on a chosen theme.	Appreciate cultural diversity reflected in various languages. Demonstrate confidence during performance.
Explain dramatic techniques (voice modulation, gestures, and stage movement) to enhance performance.	Use voice, body movement and expression effectively while performing a sketch.	Show teamwork and cooperation through group works. Show empathy as a result of socializing with characters in a sketch. Promote unity through working with others.

Introduction

This unit explores performance as powerful communication. Through collaborative sketch writing and acting, you'll bring characters to life, create dialogue, and convey important social messages. Working in groups, you'll choose a theme like equality or the environment and develop it into a theatrical sketch in English or French. You will build performance skills and bilingual confidence. The unit ends with peer performances and feedback sessions to discuss each sketch's message.

Key concepts: Script writing, performance techniques, character development, dialogue, peer review, collaboration, bilingual communication, and empathy.

4.1 Determinants of theme selection



Introductory activity 4.1

1. Imagine a child who finds it hard to feel confident at school because someone at home, a parent or caretaker, is unwell. Create a kind and respectful story about this child, without using the names of classmates or any unkind language. In your story, show how encouragement and support help the child take part in lessons and continue trying at school. Write your story and present it as a short drama sketch.
 - a. How might the child feel at school when someone is at home sick?
 - b. What challenges could the child face during lessons or activities?
 - c. Who in the school could support or encourage the child? (For example, a teacher or a friend.)
 - d. What kind words or actions could help the child feel more confident?
 - e. How can the child show effort, even when things feel difficult?
 - f. What moment in your story shows the child being brave or trying again?
 - g. How does encouragement change the child's feelings by the end of the story?
 - h. What message do you want the audience to learn from your drama?
2. Observe the following images showing a dialogue between MANZI and Mrs. MUKASINE.



1. What do you think the lady (Mrs. MUKASINE) told the young boy (MANZI)?
2. Does the boy's facial expression change or remain the same? Describe briefly.



Learning activity 4.1

Read the story in your group. Then, answer these three question.



A dove came to the brook to drink,
When, leaning o'er its crumbling brink,
An ant fell in, and vainly tried,
In this, to her, an ocean tide,
To reach the land; whereat the dove,
With every living thing in love,
Was prompt a spire of grass to throw her,
By which the ant regained the shore.

A barefoot scamp, both mean and sly,
Soon after, chanced this dove to spy;
And, being armed with bow and arrow,
The hungry codger doubted not
The bird of Venus in his pot,
Would make a soup before the morrow.
Just as his deadly bow he drew,
Our ant just bit his heel.
Roused by the villain's squeal,
The dove took timely hint, and flew
Far from the rascal's coop.

Questions:

1. Question: What is the main theme of this story?
2. What is the specific moral lesson?

4.1.1. Definition and importance of theme

Theme is the main idea or message in a story, poem, or play. It is what the writer wants to teach us about life, people, or the world around us. Different readers may understand a story in different ways, but the theme is the important truth or lesson the writer wants to share.

Theme is like the glue that holds a story together. It connects all the events, characters, and actions to give the story a deeper meaning. For example, a theme might tell us something important about friendship, courage, honesty, or how people treat each other.

Theme is important because it makes a story more than just a series of events. It helps us think about big questions and learn valuable lessons that we can apply to our own lives. A good theme makes us connect with the story on a deeper level and remember it long after we finish reading or watching it.

4.1.2. Theme selection process

A play's thematic development progresses through four essential stages. It begins with inspiration, as a core idea emerges from curiosity or experience. This idea is then clarified into a precise, debatable theme. Through integration, the theme is embedded within the characters, plot, and dramatic structure. Finally, refinement ensures that every element of the play works cohesively to support the central theme.

1. **Inspiration:** The initial spark for the play's theme, arising from personal experience, question, observation, or curiosity. This stage is about discovery rather than certainty.
2. **Clarification:** The process of shaping the initial idea into a focused, specific, and arguable theme. The playwright determines what the play is *saying* about the idea, not just what it is about.
3. **Integration:** The deliberate embedding of the theme into all aspects of the play, including character motivations, conflict, plot progression, dialogue, and dramatic structure.
4. **Refinement:** The revision stage in which the playwright evaluates and adjusts the play to ensure consistency and unity, removing or reshaping elements that do not clearly support the central theme.

4.1.3. Key considerations in theme selection

A successful theatrical theme should satisfy four essential criteria:

1. **Relevance and Resonance:** The theme should engage audiences by addressing universal human concerns—such as justice, identity, or power—while remaining meaningful within a specific context.
2. **Dramatic Potential:** An effective theme naturally generates conflict, stakes, and emotional tension, providing a strong foundation for character action and narrative momentum.
3. **Original Perspective:** While themes may be timeless, they should be approached from a distinctive angle that offers fresh insight and avoids predictable or clichéd treatment.
4. **Manageability:** The theme must be sufficiently focused and contained to allow for thorough and coherent exploration within the scope and structure of the play.

4.1.4. Pitfalls to avoid

The key thematic mistakes to avoid when choosing a theme include:

1. **Vagueness and Overbreadth:** Avoid themes that are too broad, such as “life” as they lack focus and fail to guide the story.
2. **Cliché and Superficiality:** Overused or simplistic themes, like “love conquers all” feel predictable unless approached with a fresh, meaningful perspective.
3. **Thematic Overload:** Trying to explore too many major ideas at once dilutes the story's impact and weakens dramatic coherence.
4. **Didacticism:** Avoid making the play feel like a message-driven essay; the story should never lose its emotional authenticity to serve a moral argument.



APPLICATION ACTIVITY 4.1

1. What are the four phases of the theme selection process?
2. In your own words, explain the difference between a theme and a moral lesson.
3. Imagine you are writing a play about a family secret. Describe what you would take into ensure your theme has a dramatic potential.
4. A common pitfall in theme selection is Thematic Overload. Analyze why this weakens the impact of the play.
5. A playwright is considering two thematic statements for a new play.

Option A: "Technology isolates people."

Option B: "Technology creates the illusion of connection, deepening real-world loneliness."

Using the key considerations for Theme Selection, determine which theme (**A** or **B**) is dramatically stronger and justify your choice.

1. Propose a theme for a short play about a conflict at a school awards ceremony.
2. Follow the steps' theme selection process to build a focused and dramatic theme.

4.2. Performance Techniques



Learning activity 4.2

Looking attentively at the picture above,

expressions.

1. Which team won the match: the green and yellow team or the red and white striped team? List three things you see in their bodies and faces that prove your answer.
2. How is the red and white team showing their feelings differently from the green and yellow team? Name three specific differences in their body positions or facial



Performance techniques are the skills actors use to communicate a character's thoughts, feelings, and relationships clearly to an audience. In drama, these techniques mainly involve the controlled use of **voice, body, face, and space** on stage.

4.2.1. Vocal Elements

Actors portray character through key vocal techniques. Pitch suggests age and mood, while pace and pauses create tension. Tone conveys emotion and volume reflects confidence or fear. Accent hints at origin, emphasis shapes meaning, and intonation clarifies questions or feelings. Together, these elements form a believable performance.

4.2.2. Physical and Body Techniques

Actors physically portray character through posture, gestures, movement, and blocking. Posture shows confidence or low status. Gestures and mannerisms express meaning and emotion. Movement, including gait and speed, reveals urgency, mood, or injury. Blocking clarifies relationships and focuses on stage. Together, these elements create believable and expressive characters.

4.2.3. Use of Space

Actors use space to define relationships and power. Distance between performers shows closeness or conflict. Levels like standing or kneeling indicate dominance or vulnerability. Effective awareness of stage space and other actors ensures clear storytelling and smooth interaction.

4.2.4. Facial Expression

Facial expressions powerfully communicate emotion. The eyes show honesty with a direct gaze or fear when looking away. Eyebrows signal surprise if raised, and anger if furrowed. The mouth reveals happiness in a smile or anger in tight lips. Features like nose wrinkling, flared nostrils, and cheek movement add detail. All parts of the face must work together, with head position supporting the emotion, for a believable performance.

3.2.5. Character Development in Drama

Character development is the creation of believable individuals. Actors study the script to understand the character's situation, desires, and obstacles. They imagine the character's inner life, including past experiences and hidden emotions. This is then expressed through physical choices like posture and movement, and vocal choices like tone and accent. Finally, actors practice interacting with others through improvisation to ensure natural, truthful reactions in performance.

4.2.6. Stage Techniques

Stage techniques help actors communicate meaning clearly and effectively to an audience. Positioning, or blocking, shows relationships, status, and importance. Levels create visual interest and indicate dominance, vulnerability, or status. Focus directs the audience's attention through movement, stillness, voice, and eye-line. Audience awareness ensures that actors project their voices, adjust their positioning,

and remain visible without breaking character, keeping the performance clear and engaging.



APPLICATION ACTIVITY 4.2

1. Name the four main performance techniques actors use on stage.
2. How can an actor use voice to show fear?
3. You play a confident teacher. Describe two performance techniques you would use.
4. Look at the farmers working in the field.



- a. If you were the leader of farmers speaking to the group, would you use a loud or a quiet voice? Why?
- b. If you were the farmers' leader, what would you look for in the farmers' bodies and faces to know they are tired and need a break?

4.3. Peer Review and Feedback



Learning activity 1.4

Observe the images and read their scripts and answer the reflection questions.

1. Performing "Confused"

Ishimwe acts out a **"confused"** emotion for 10 seconds using only his facial expressions and body language.



2. Giving Feedback

Mugeni gives **specific feedback** by using two parts only:

"I saw..."

"Try..."

"I saw your eyebrows lift and your head tilt. **Try stepping back** to show hesitation."



Giving Feedback

3. Trying Again

Ishimwe adjusts his confused expression and steps back, as Mugeni suggested.



Trying Again

4. Switching Roles

Ishimwe and **Mugeni** switch roles, and now Ishimwe will observe and give **feedback** as Mugeni performs a new emotion.



Switching Roles

Questions

- MUGENI watches carefully as ISHIMWE performs an emotion. When MUGENI said "I saw..." to ISHIMWE, which element was she observing?
 - ISHIMWE's costume
 - ISHIMWE's script
 - ISHIMWE's voice
 - ISHIMWE's facial expressions or body language
- ISHIMWE performs the emotion again, using MUGENI's suggestion. When ISHIMWE performed the second time using MUGENI's suggestion, he was mainly:
 - Giving feedback
 - Receiving feedback
 - Ignoring feedback
 - Writing feedback

Peer review and feedback are essential skills in drama that help actors improve their performances through constructive observation and reflection. By evaluating each other's work, students develop critical thinking, communication, and self-awareness, while also learning to support their peers positively.

4.3.1. Understanding peer review

Peer review is the observation of a classmate's performance to identify strengths, areas for improvement, and specific techniques used. Actors focus on vocal clarity, body language, facial expression, spatial awareness, and character consistency. This approach allows for meaningful feedback that helps refine the work. It is important to always be respectful and constructive, focusing on the performance itself. Using positive language builds confidence, while specific suggestions give the performer clear direction for improvement.

4.3.2. Giving constructive feedback

When giving feedback, actors should start by identifying specific strengths. Next, they should provide clear suggestions for improvement. This advice should be practical and specific rather than general. Actors should also comment on the performance's effect on the audience, noting if the emotions, character portrayal, and story were clear and engaging. Connecting all feedback directly to the performance goals makes it purposeful and useful.

4.3.3. Receiving feedback

Receiving feedback is essential for growth. Actors should listen thoughtfully without defensiveness, considering both strengths and areas for improvement to understand their impact. Asking, clarifying questions and testing suggestions in rehearsal turns feedback into practical skill development.

4.3.4. Peer feedback techniques

Effective feedback techniques are structured and supportive, balancing encouragement with constructive suggestions to aid learning. The main method is two stars and a wish, which highlights two strengths and one area for improvement.

- Observation notes are used to record key details during a performance.
- Guided checklists provide a clear framework for feedback on specific criteria.
- Group discussions allow for collaborative sharing of different perspectives.

4.3.5. Benefits of peer review and feedback

Engaging in peer review helps actors develop critical analysis, self-reflection, and communication skills, while also fostering empathy and teamwork. By observing and evaluating others, students become more aware of their own strengths and areas to develop. Feedback cycles encourage continuous improvement, build confidence, and help create performances that are clear, engaging, and emotionally authentic.



APPLICATION ACTIVITY 4.3

1. According to the content, what are the two parts of a "Star" in the "Two stars and a wish" feedback method?
2. Based on the content, why should feedback be "actionable"?
3. Using the "Two Stars and a Wish" method, which of the following is a correctly formatted "Wish"?
 - A. "You were okay."
 - B. "Try pausing after the key line to build suspense."
 - C. "I did not like it."
 - D. "You missed it."
4. Which statement is an example of giving feedback and which is an example of receiving feedback?
 - A. "Thank you. I will try turning my body more toward the audience in my next rehearsal."
 - B. "Your character's voice was very expressive in the happy scene."
5. Which feedback statement is more constructive?
 - A. "If I were you ..."
 - B. "Your gestures were clear, but you could try using the whole stage"
 - C. "Your movement was bad ..."
 - D. "Never proceed that way ..."
6. To create constructive feedback, which sentence starter follows the content's guidelines?
 - A. "You always ..."
 - B. "You should have not ..."
 - C. "I suggest trying to ..."
 - D. "You should have ..."



END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

1. List the four stages of thematic development for a play in the correct order.
2. What are the five main vocal elements actors use to portray character in performance?
3. Explain the difference between a theme and a moral lesson using your own words and provide one example of each.
4. Describe how actors use space and levels on stage to show relationships and power between characters.
5. Using the "Two Stars and a Wish" method, provide constructive feedback for the following performance: An actor playing a nervous student speaks too quickly and keeps their arms crossed throughout the scene.
6. You are directing a play about friendship and betrayal. Apply the four key criteria for theme selection to determine if this theme is suitable for a short school play.
7. Compare vocal techniques and physical techniques in drama performance. How do they work together to create a believable character?
8. A playwright wants to explore three major themes: climate change, teenage identity, and family conflict in one 15-minute play. Analyze why this approach would weaken the dramatic impact using evidence from the content on pitfalls to avoid.
9. Evaluate which thematic statement is stronger for a school play:

Option A: "Bullying is wrong."

Option B: "Silence in the face of bullying makes bystanders complicit in harm."

Justify your choice using at least two key considerations for theme selection

10. A classmate gives you this feedback: "You were bad. Everything needs to change." Evaluate the quality of this feedback and explain what makes it unconstructive. Then rewrite it using proper feedback techniques.
11. Create a focused theme for a short play about a student who discovers their best friend cheated on an important exam. Follow these steps:
 - a. State your theme as a complete sentence
 - b. Explain how it demonstrates dramatic potential
 - c. Identify one pitfall you avoided
12. Design a brief scene where a confident student confronts a shy student about a rumor.
13. Describe the specific performance techniques you would use for each character, including at least one vocal technique, one physical technique, and one use of space or levels.

LESSON 1:
MAJOR SCALES
AND MAJOR KEY
SIGNATURE

LESSON 2:
MINOR SCALES
AND MINOR KEY
SIGNATURES

LESSON 3:
PENTATONIC
SCALES

LESSON 4:
PERFORMING
SKETCHES IN
ENGLISH OR
FRENCH

LESSON 5:
MELODY AND
HARMONY

UNIT 5:

MELODY AND HARMONY

Key Unit Competence:

At the end of this unit, students will be able to perform different melodies in harmony.

Domain Expected Learning Outcomes

Knowledge	Skills	Attitudes and Values
Understand the meaning of melody and harmony.	Solfa simple melodies and harmonies in groups..	Appreciate teamwork and cooperation through singing in groups Demonstrate quality and exactitude performing melodies Demonstrate confidence during performance.
Understand simple chords progression and harmony	Use voice, body movement and expression effectively while performing a sketch.	Demonstrate creativity while making harmony of songs Show teamwork and cooperation through group works.

Introduction

This unit explores the concept of melody and harmony as fundamental elements of music. Melodies are the sequence of notes from one to the next in a horizontal pattern, just one voice or performed by one or more people; while the melody combines different voices or sounds of melodies to make richer and fuller music. The choir form developed with time and variation in cultures in the western music SATB (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) developed gradually as European church music moved from single-line chant to multi-voice polyphony. In the Middle Ages, centers like the Notre Dame School expanded music to two and three parts, though voices were labeled by function rather than range. During the Renaissance, composers such as Johannes Ockeghem and Giovanni Pierluigi da Palestrina helped standardize four balanced voice parts. By the Baroque period, especially in the chorales of Johann Sebastian Bach, SATB became the standard structure for Western choral harmony because four voices provided fullness, balance, and complete triadic harmony.

In Rwanda, for many centuries ballets were accompanied by a choir singing, children were lulled to rest by songs called ibihozo, usually in polyphony emblematic of the Rwandan culture.

Key concepts: Melody, harmony, harmonization, chord progression, roman numerals, polyphony.



Introductory activity 5.1. Follow the story

The Village of Singing Voices

Once upon a time, there was a village where everyone loved to sing. One day, a young girl named Pendo walked through the marketplace singing a beautiful tune all by herself. Her voice rose and fell like a bird flying in the sky. This was **melody**; one clear musical line that everyone could follow.

As she sang, her friend Dukuze joined her. Instead of copying Pendo exactly, he sang different notes that blended smoothly with hers. Their voices sounded richer together than alone. Soon, more villagers joined in; some sang higher, some sang lower, and the song became full and powerful. This was **harmony**; different notes sung while work together to support the melody.

But before the villagers could sing together beautifully, they had to learn a few things. They learned the names of notes so they knew what to sing. They practiced clapping rhythms so they could stay together. They trained their ears to hear when they were too high or too low. They learned scales so they knew which notes belonged in their song. And they practiced singing different parts without getting distracted by others. At the end of the day,

, the village realized something important: A melody is like one storyteller. Harmony is like many storytellers speaking together in agreement.

Activity:

1. Do you think Harmony is good in life?
2. Describe the music when Pendo was singing and after Dukuze joined her?
3. Match:

Singing one voice	Melody
Singing many voices	Harmony

1. Melody

A melody is a sequence of notes arranged in a meaningful and musical way. It is the main tune of a song the part we usually sing, hum, played or remember most easily. Melody is one of the most important elements of music. It gives a song its identity and emotional expression. When we listen to music, our ears naturally try to follow a line of notes that move up and down. This line is called the melodic line.

A good melody is not just random notes. It has shape, direction, and structure. Some notes are more important because they give the melody direction, while others decorate or connect these important notes. Melodies often move step by step, but sometimes they include leaps to create excitement or contrast. For example, look at the song "Happy Birthday" in harmony with other notes and then look at it just as a melody:

Joyfully

The musical score for "Happy Birthday" is presented in two systems. The first system shows the piano accompaniment in 3/4 time, with the right hand playing a simple melody and the left hand providing a harmonic base. The lyrics "Hap py birth day to you hap py birth day to you hap py" are written below the notes. The second system continues the melody, showing a more complex melodic line with a fermata over the word "you" and a final cadence. The piano accompaniment continues to provide a harmonic background.

The main melody of this song is the sequence of notes usually sang as follows:

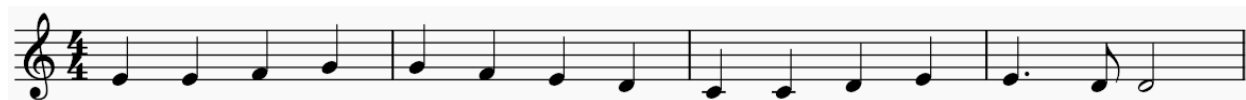
The main melody of "Happy Birthday" is shown on a single staff in 3/4 time. The melody is a simple, stepwise sequence of notes that is easy to remember and sing. The lyrics "Hap py birth day to you hap py birth day to you hap py" are written below the notes.



Melodies are usually organized into short musical ideas called phrases, like sentences in language. They often build toward a high point, called the climax, and then resolve to make a final note that feels complete. Look at the excerpt of Beethoven's Ode to Joy and see how the melody is built. Just as a sentence expresses one complete thought in language, this musical phrase expresses one complete musical idea. It usually has a clear beginning, develops in the middle, and ends with a sense of pause or resolution.



Phrase 1



Phrase 2



Understanding melody helps us:

- Sing and play music more accurately
- Recognize patterns and structure
- Express music with feeling
- Creating our own musical ideas

In short, melody is the musical story told through notes.



Learning activity 5.1: Understanding Melody

Short Questions

1. Define melody in your own words.
2. Why is melody considered the most memorable part of a song?
3. What is a musical phrase?
4. What is the climax of a melody?

Melody Shape Drawing

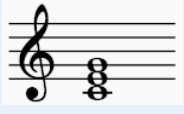
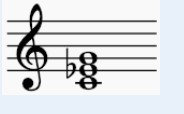
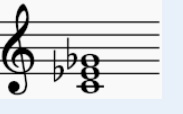
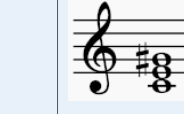
1. Draw a melodic line that begins low, moves stepwise upward, includes one leap, and ends on a stable note.
2. Sing the melody of the song "Turate Rwanda". And write its melody down with music notes.

2. Harmony

Harmony in music is the combination of **two or more notes played or sung at the same time to create a richer or fuller sound**. While melody is the main tune we sing and usually the most noticeable part of a song, harmony supports the melody and helps to create a fuller and richer musical sound. Without harmony, music can feel empty or incomplete. Harmony adds beauty, emotion, and depth, making the listener feel calm, joyful, sad, or excited depending on how the notes are combined. We can hear harmony clearly in church singing with different voice parts, in choir music, in piano or guitar chords, and in bands or orchestras where many instruments play together.

2.1. Harmony and Chords

A **chord** is a group of notes played or sung together at the same time. The most common basic chord contains **three different notes**, and this is called a **triad**. Chords are the foundation of harmony because they provide the background sound that supports the melody. In the key of C major, for example, the notes **C-E-G** form a C major chord. Musicians classify triads into three main types according to how they sound. A **major triad** sounds happy, bright, and strong. A **minor triad** sounds sad, serious, or gentle. A **diminished triad** sounds tense, unstable, and often needs to resolve to another chord. Learning to recognize these sounds helps students understand emotional expression in music.

			
Major triad	Minor triad	Diminished triad	Augmented triad

2.2. Harmony in the Major Scale

Harmony is closely connected to the major scale, because chords are built from the notes of the scale. In the C major scale (C–D–E–F–G–A–B–C), we can build a different triad starting on each note. These are called diatonic chords, meaning they belong naturally to the scale. Each chord has a special role in music. Some chords feel stable and restful, while others create movement and lead the music forward. Understanding these relationships helps students see how composers organize music and why certain chords sound correct together.

Scale de- gree	Chord type	Example
I	Major	C–E–G
ii	Minor	D–F–A
iii	Minor	E–G–B
IV	Major	F–A–C
V	Major	G–B–D
vi	Minor	A–C–E
vii°	Diminished	B–D–F

The image displays the seven diatonic triads of the C major scale on a grand staff. The top staff shows the triads: C (I), Dm (ii), Em (iii), F (IV), G (V), Am (vi), and Bdim (vii°). The bottom staff shows the corresponding scale degrees: I, ii, iii, IV, V, vi, and vii°.

The degrees of the scale (and the triads built upon them) are designated by the Roman numerals I–VII.

- In major: I, IV, and V are major triads; II, III, and VI are minor triads; VII is a diminished triad.
- In natural minor: I, IV, V are minor triads; III, VI and VII are major triads; II is a diminished triad.
- In harmonic minor: I and IV are minor triads; V and VI are major triads; II and VII are diminished triads; III is an augmented triad.

1. C Major scale

The image shows the C Major scale with the triads: C (I), Dm (ii), Em (iii), F (IV), G (V), Am (vi), and Bdim (vii°).

2. A natural minor

The image shows the A natural minor scale with the triads: A (I), Bm (ii), C (iii), D (IV), E (V), F#m (vi), and G#dim (vii°).

3. Harmonic minor

The image shows the A harmonic minor scale with the triads: A (I), Bm (ii), C (iii), D (IV), E (V), F#m (vi), and G#dim (vii°).

2.3. Harmony in Singing (Voice Parts)

In choral music, harmony is created when **different groups of singers perform different notes at the same time**. These groups are called **voice parts**, and each part has its own range of high or low notes. The **soprano** usually sings the highest notes and often carries the melody. The **alto** sings slightly lower notes that support the soprano. The **tenor** provides middlelow tones, and the **bass** sings the lowest notes that give strength and foundation to the harmony. When all the four parts soprano, alto, tenor and base (SATB) sing together in balance, the result is a rich and beautiful choral sound. Learning to sing in harmony also teaches students teamwork, listening skills, and musical discipline. Try to sing the Amen part of the song "Isi Yose" by Mgr Dominique Ngirabanyiginya (also extracted from Angelus by Beethoven) as follows.

The image shows a musical score for the 'Amen' part of the song 'Isi Yose' by Mgr Dominique Ngirabanyiginya. The score is written for four voice parts: Soprano, Alto, Tenor, and Bass. The tempo is marked as $\text{♩} = 80$. The key signature has two flats (B-flat and E-flat), and the time signature is 4/4. The Soprano part starts with a half note G4, followed by quarter notes A4, B4, and A4, then a half note G4. The Alto part starts with a half note E4, followed by quarter notes F4, G4, and F4, then a half note E4. The Tenor part starts with a half note C4, followed by quarter notes D4, E4, and D4, then a half note C4. The Bass part starts with a half note G3, followed by quarter notes A3, B3, and A3, then a half note G3. The lyrics 'A men' are written under each part. The score includes first and second endings, indicated by '1.' and '2.' above the final measures.

2.4 Consonance and Dissonance

Not all harmony sounds the same. Some combinations of notes sound smooth, peaceful, and stable; this is called **consonance**. Other combinations sound tense, sharp, or uncomfortable; this is called **dissonance**. Dissonance is not bad in music. Instead, composers use it to create interest, emotion, and movement before returning to a calm consonant sound. This change from tension to relaxation is an important part of musical expression and storytelling. By learning to hear the difference between consonance and dissonance, students become better listeners and performers. Usually, adjacent notes with only a semitone or a tone apart are dissonant.



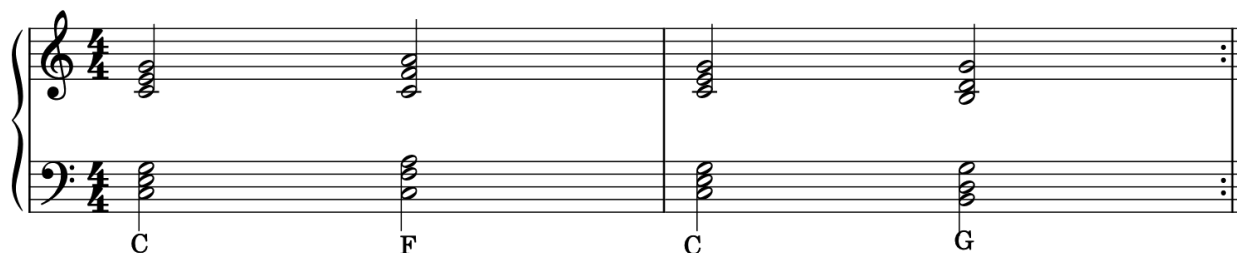
Consonant



Dissonant

2.5. Chord Progressions

A **chord progression** is the order in which chords appear in a piece of music. Progressions give direction and structure to a song, helping it feel complete. One of the most common progressions in many styles of music is **I – IV – V – I**. In the key of C major, this becomes **C → F → G → C**. This pattern is widely used in church music, folk songs, and popular music because it sounds natural and satisfying to the ear. Understanding chord progressions allows students to accompany songs, compose simple music, and recognize patterns in the music they hear every day.



The above chords are C, F, C and G. Note that F and G are inversions. At the end of staff there are two dots that represent repetition. Even if music says to repeat from the beginning only once, you are required to repeat the same warmup for five times. You can even do more.

Application Activity: Play the following song with proper chord progression

2.6. Harmony on Instruments

Harmony can also be produced on musical instruments. On the **piano**, the left hand often plays chords that provide harmonic support, while the right hand plays the melody. On the **guitar**, harmony is created by strumming or plucking chord shapes. In a **band or orchestra**, different instruments share the notes of a chord, working together to build a complete harmonic texture. Learning how harmony works on instruments helps students become more confident performers and prepares them for ensemble playing.

The first thing to check when more than one instruments play together, is the key in which each instrument is tuned in. For example, most trumpets are in Bb while Alto Saxophone is in Eb, while piano is in C. Now playing them together if a song is in C Major scale, we will need to raise the Trumpet by one whole step (tone) to put it in D Major scale, to sound in the same key as the piano, while for the Alto saxophone, we will put it three semitones down to be together with other instruments, it means we

will play it in A major scale. Look closely at the following notes. They sound the same even if they seem to be at different pitches and in different keys. This is the effect of the instruments' key.

The image shows a musical score for three instruments: Alto Saxophone, Trumpet in Bb, and Piano. The key signature is A major (two sharps: F# and C#) and the time signature is 4/4. The Alto Saxophone and Trumpet in Bb parts are written in treble clef. The Piano part is written in grand staff (treble and bass clef). The notes for each instrument are as follows:

Instrument	Measure 1	Measure 2	Measure 3
Alto Saxophone	A4	B4	C5
Trumpet in Bb	A3	B3	C4
Piano (Treble)	A4	B4	C5
Piano (Bass)	A2	B2	C3

2.7 Harmonizing

Harmonizing in music is the process of adding chords or additional notes to a melody to create depth, texture, and emotional impact. While a melody is a single line of musical notes, harmony supports it by providing a framework of complementary sounds that enrich and shape the overall piece. By selecting chords that fit within a key and match important melody notes, composers and musicians create movement, tension, and resolution. Harmonizing is a fundamental skill in composition, arranging, and performance, forming the basis of styles ranging from classical and choral music to pop, jazz, and gospel.

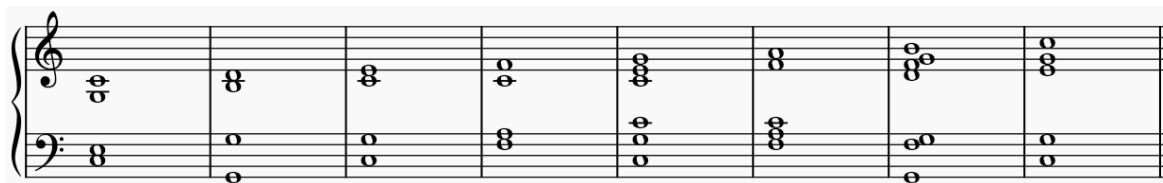
There are various ways of producing the harmony. We can first refer to scale degrees from the first to the eighth and add notes to each scale degrees to form triads and each one is noted with Roman Numerals. Capital letters indicate major chords while small letters indicate minors or diminished chords.

The image shows a musical score for a piano, illustrating the triads for each scale degree in A major. The key signature is A major (two sharps: F# and C#) and the time signature is 4/4. The notes for each triad are as follows:

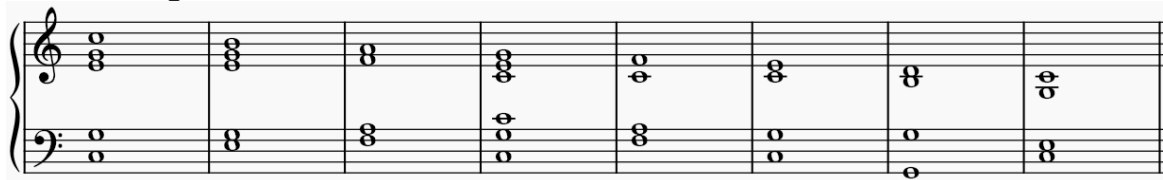
Scale Degree	Triad Name	Notes
I	C	A4, C5, E5
ii	Dm	B4, D5, F#5
iii	Em	C5, E5, G#5
IV	F	D5, F#5, A5
V	G	E5, G#5, B5
vi	Am	C5, E5, G5
vii°	Bdim	D5, F#5, A5

The classic harmonization follows almost the similar rule, but notes are not as aligned and consonant as for the triads. They show 7th chords and uses four and more notes to make the harmony richer and fuller. In the ascending direction the second chord is major (G Major) while in the descending direction it is E minor as shown below:

a. Ascending



b. Descending



3. Melody versus Harmony

3.1. Definition

Melody is the main musical line made of single notes arranged in a meaningful and expressive sequence. It is usually the part that listeners remember and can sing easily.

Harmony, on the other hand, is created when two or more notes sound together to support the melody and give fullness and depth to the music. Harmony enriches the musical sound and provides emotional color to the melody.

3.2. Musical Function

The function of melody is to carry the musical idea or message. It is the central element that attracts attention and expresses the mood of the song.

Harmony functions as accompaniment. It supports and strengthens the melody by providing background chords and tonal structure. Musical sound in orchestration depends on how vibrations combine and interact, whether through strings, air columns, or percussion, showing how harmony builds richness from multiple tones sounding together. Harmony can also create emotions and depth of music depending on which notes the composer decides to use.

3.3. Number of music notes

Melody uses one note at a time in a linear sequence, while harmony uses several notes at the same time, forming chords or harmonic textures that create a fuller sound. For this reason, melody is said to be horizontal while harmony is vertical.

3.4. Role in Musical Texture

Melody creates the **foreground** of music, the part that stands out clearly. Harmony forms the background or foundation, shaping the musical atmosphere and supporting the melodic line.

3.5. Emotional Effect

Melody expresses emotion directly through pitch movement, rhythm, and phrasing. Harmony influences emotion indirectly by changing chords, tonal color, and tension or relaxation in the music.

3.6. Performance in Ensembles

In singing or instrumental music, a solo voice or instrument often performs the melody.

Harmony is commonly performed by accompaniment instruments, choirs singing in parts, or multiple orchestral instruments playing together, demonstrating how different sound-producing systems combine to create richer musical sound.

3.7. Briefly:

Aspect	Melody	Harmony
Meaning	Main tune of the music	Combination of supporting notes
Notes sounding	One at a time	Two or more together
Role	Foreground, memorable part	Background support and richness
Emotional effect	Direct expression	Color, tension, and depth
Performance	Solo voice/instrument	Choirs, chords, accompaniment

END UNIT ASSESSMENT



END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

Activity 1: Identify the Triads

a. Identify whether the following are Major, Minor, Diminished, or Augmented:

1. C-E-G
2. A-C-E
3. B-D-F
4. C-E-G $\sharp$

Harmony in the C Major Scale

b. Fill in the chord types for the following scale degrees in C Major:

I ii iii IV V vi vii $^{\circ}$

Voice Parts (SATB)

c. Match the voice part with its description:

Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass

1. Lowest voice
2. Highest voice
3. Middle-low male voice
4. Middle-high female voice

Consonance or Dissonance

d. State whether the following intervals are Consonant or Dissonant:

1. C and G
2. C and C
3. C and B
4. C and F $\sharp$

Chord Progressions and Application

Activity 2: I – IV – V – I Progressio

5. Write the chords for I – IV – V – I in C major.
6. Why is this progression popular?

Activity 3: Composition Task

Compose a 4-measure melody in C major and add the chord progression I – IV – V – I.

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3. <https://www.musicca.com/accidentals>
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6. https://thedramateacher.com/dramatic-elements/#google_vignette
7. <https://www.themusicalear.com/how-to-identify-key-signatures/>

Recommendations:

Access to professional writing software such as: Sibelius, Finale, Dorico

ANNEX:

1. SOLFA EXERCISES

The musical score consists of six systems, each with two staves. The first system is in 4/4 time with a tempo of 80-90 and a dynamic of *mp*. The second system is in 4/4 time with a dynamic of *mf*. The third system is in 4/4 time with a dynamic of *mp*. The fourth system is in 4/4 time with a dynamic of *mp*. The fifth system is in 4/4 time with a dynamic of *mf*. The sixth system is in 3/4 time with a tempo of 80. The seventh system is in 2/4 time with a tempo of 70. The eighth system is in 2/4 time with a tempo of 70. The score includes various musical notations such as notes, rests, and dynamic markings.

Andante

mp

mf

Moderato

p

mp

f

mp

$\text{♩} = 120$

mf

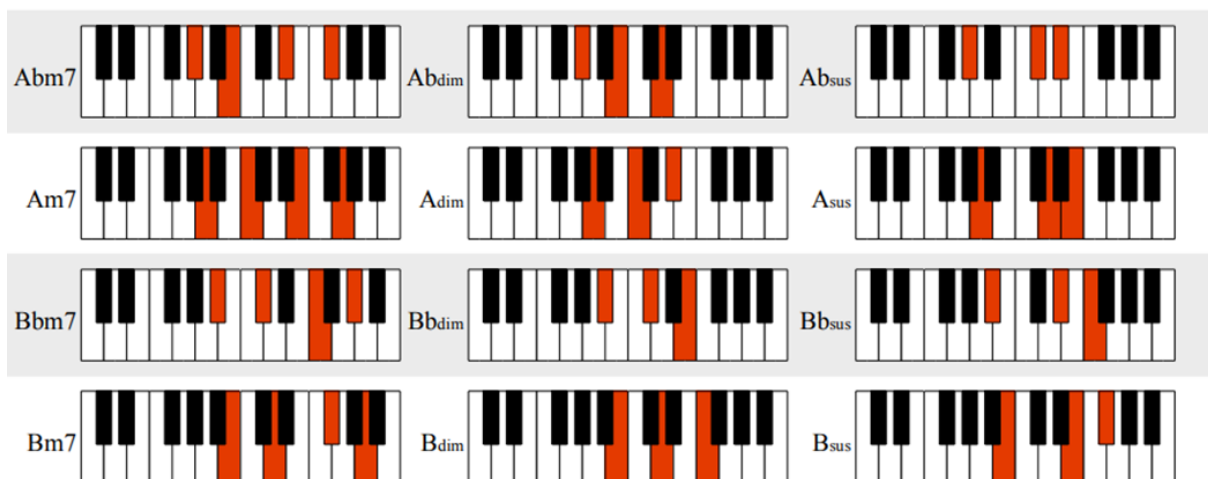
Andante

2. PIANO CHORDS CHARTS

C	Cm	C7
Db	Dbm	Db7
D	Dm	D7
Eb	Ebm	Eb7
E	Em	E7
F	Fm	F7
Gb	Gbm	Gb7

E	Em	E7
F	Fm	F7
Gb	Gbm	Gb7

G	Gm	G7
Ab	Abm	Ab7
A	Am	A7
Bb	Bbm	Bb7
B	Bm	B7
Cm7	Cdim	Csus
Dbm7	Dbdim	Db _{sus}
Dm7	Ddim	D _{sus}
Ebm7	Ebdim	Eb _{sus}
Em7	Edim	E _{sus}
Fm7	Fdim	F _{sus}
Gbm7	Gbdim	Gb _{sus}
Gm7	Gdim	G _{sus}



MUSIC VOCABULARY

TEMPO (Speed)

Adagio – Slow and expressive.

Adagissimo – Extremely slow; slower than adagio.

Allegro – Fast, lively, and cheerful.

Allegrissimo – Very fast; faster than allegro.

Allegretto – Moderately fast; slightly slower than allegro.

Andante – At a walking pace; moderately slow.

Andantino – Slightly faster (sometimes slightly slower) than andante.

Grave – Very slow and solemn.

Largo – Broad and very slow.

Larghissimo – Extremely slow and very broad.

Larghetto – Rather slow; not as slow as largo.

Lento – Slow.

Moderato – Moderate speed.

Moderatissimo – Very moderate tempo.

Molto – Very (used with another term, e.g., molto allegro).

Non troppo – Not too much (e.g., not too fast).

Poco a poco – Little by little; gradually.

Presto – Very fast.

Prestissimo – Extremely fast.

Tempo primo – Return to the original tempo.

Tempo ordinario – In the usual or ordinary tempo.

Tempo giusto – In strict or exact time.

Ritardando – Gradually slowing down.

Ritenuto – Suddenly holding back the tempo.

Rallentando – Gradually becoming slower.

Slentando – Gradually slowing down (similar to rallentando).

Accelerando – Gradually speeding up.

Stringendo – Pressing forward; gradually increasing speed.

DYNAMICS (Volume)

Piano – Soft.

Pianissimo – Very soft.

Forte – Loud.

Fortissimo – Very loud.

Mezzo piano – Moderately soft.

Mezzo forte – Moderately loud.

Crescendo – Gradually getting louder.

Decrescendo – Gradually getting softer.

Diminuendo – Gradually decreasing in volume.

Sforzando – Sudden strong emphasis on a note.

Rinforzando – Reinforcing a sound with added emphasis.

Smorzando – Gradually dying away in tone.

Morendo – Dying away in both tone and sometimes tempo.

Tutta forza – With all possible force; as loud as possible.

Sotto voce – In a soft, subdued tone.

EXPRESSION & CHARACTER

Affettuoso – Tender and affectionate.

Agitato – Agitated and restless.

Amabile – Lovely and pleasant.

Amoroso – Loving and tender.

Animato – With spirit and animation.

Appassionato – Passionate and intense.

Ardito – Bold and daring.

Audace – Fearless and daring.

Brillante – Brilliant and sparkling.

Brioso – Lively and spirited.

Burlesco – Comic or humorous in style.

Cantabile – In a smooth, singing style.

Dolce – Sweetly and gently.

Doloroso – Sorrowful.

Energico – Energetic and forceful.

Espressivo – Expressively; with feeling.

Furioso – Furious and wild.

Giocoso – Playful and merry.

Grandioso – Grand and majestic.

Grazioso – Graceful and elegant.

Gravemente – Seriously and solemnly.

Impetuoso – Impetuous and passionate.

Lagrimoso – Tearful and mournful.

Lamentoso – Mournful and lamenting.

Leggiero – Light and delicate.

Maestoso – Majestic and dignified.

Marcato – Marked and emphasized.

Mesto – Sad and mournful.

Nobile – Noble and dignified.

Passionato – Passionate.

Placido – Calm and peaceful.

Pomposo – Pompous and grand.

Religioso – Reverent and solemn.

Risoluto – Bold and resolute.

Scherzando – Playful and joking.

Serioso – Serious in character.

Soave – Sweet and gentle.

Solenne – Solemn and formal.

Spiritoso – Spirited and lively.

Strepitoso – Noisy and boisterous.

Tranquillo – Calm and peaceful.

Vigoroso – Vigorous and strong.

Vivace – Lively and brisk.

Vivacissimo – Extremely lively.

ARTICULATION & PERFORMANCE STYLE

Acciaccatura – A very short crushed grace note.

Appoggiatura – A grace note that leans on and steals time from the main note.

Cadenza – A brilliant solo passage, often near the end of a piece.

Detache – Notes played separately but smoothly (commonly in string playing).

Glissando – Sliding from one note to another.

Legato – Smoothly connected notes.

Legatissimo – Very smoothly connected.

Staccato – Short and detached.

Staccatissimo – Very short and sharply detached.

Tenuto – Held for full value.

Portamento – Gentle glide between notes.

Sincopato – Syncopated; accented off the beat.

Tremolo – Rapid repetition of a note or alternation between two notes.

Tasto solo – Play only the written bass note without chords.

VOCAL & INSTRUMENTAL TERMS

A cappella – Singing without instrumental accompaniment.

Basso primo – First bass part.

Basso secondo – Second bass part.

Canto – The melody or principal vocal line.

Cantor – A singer or leader of singing.

Chorus – A group of singers performing together.

Duet / Duetto – A composition for two performers.

Solo – A passage for one performer.

Soli – A section where several soloists perform.

Tutti – All performers play or sing together.

Obbligato – An essential accompanying part.

Recitativo – A speech-like style of singing.

STRUCTURAL & DIRECTIONAL TERMS

A tempo – Return to the previous tempo.

Da capo (D.C.) – Repeat from the beginning.

Dal segno (D.S.) – Repeat from the sign.

Fine – The end.

Segue – Continue immediately to the next section.

Bis – Repeat a passage.

Volte subito – Turn the page quickly.

Tacet – Remain silent.

STYLE & FORM

Cavatina – A short lyrical solo song.

Capriccio – A lively, free-form piece.

Fugato – A passage written in fugal style.

Siciliana – A slow pastoral dance in 6/8 or 12/8 time.

Canzonetto – A short light song.

Canticle – A sacred hymn or chant.

Corale (Chorale) – A hymn tune, often in simple harmony.

RECOMMENDED SOFTWARE

- MuseScore
- Finale
- Sibelius
- Dorico
- Logic Pro
- Cubase
- FL Studio

